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KYIV SAYS IT STRUCK AN OIL TERMINAL AND NAVAL BASE; MOSCOW SAYS IT SHOT DOWN 59 UKRAINIAN DRONES

Ukraine strikes St Petersburg as Russia hosts economic forum

Retaliatory strikes on Kyiv would continue: Kremlin

Reuters
St Petersburg, June 3

UKRAINIAN DRONES hit an oil terminal in St Petersburg and a warship in dry-dock at a nearby naval base, hours before Vladimir Putin's showcase economic forum got under way in the city, in a clear attempt to embarrass the Kremlin chief.

The attack on Putin's home city, location of his own 'Davos' - a glitzy annual economic forum designed to attract foreign investment - comes as both sides dial up strikes against each other in their more than four-year-old war with no imminent end in sight. The Kremlin said Russia would keep striking Ukraine systematically in response to such attacks, part of what it has described as a new "paradigm" in the conflict.

Unspecified "infrastructure objects" had been attacked in three districts of Russia's sec-



Smoke billows after Ukrainian drones hit an oil terminal in St Petersburg, Russia on Wednesday. REUTERS

ond-biggest city and home to over 5 million people, Alexander Beglov, its governor, said.

Air defences shot down 59 Ukrainian drones overnight, Alexander Drozdenko, governor of the surrounding Leningrad region, said. "Several facilities have been damaged. Clean-up operations are currently underway. Several people have been injured. There have been no

fatalities," Beglov said.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy confirmed his drones had struck the fuel terminal and said they had also targeted a military facility in Kronstadt on an island near the city where elements of Russia's Baltic Fleet and major shipbuilding and repair facilities are located.

Ukraine released a video which showed a drone striking

a Russian warship, the corvette Boiky, in what it said was a dry dock at Kronstadt.

Reuters was able to verify the location of the attack and the model of the vessel, but could not independently verify how seriously the ship or the oil terminal had been damaged.

Unconfirmed video posted to social media showed locals filming Ukrainian aeroplane-

style drones as they flew over parts of the city as fires appeared to rage at the export fuel terminal in the background.

What sounded like anti-aircraft fire could be heard as one drone flew on unhindered.

Given the importance of the event to Moscow, the Ukrainian attack is likely to raise questions inside Russia about how effective its own air defence capabilities are, a problem that Ukraine is also grappling with.

The location of the economic forum itself was heavily protected and there was no suggestion that Ukrainian drones had got close to the venue. A plume of grey smoke was visible from St Petersburg's historic city centre and Reuters correspondents reported hearing loud explosions on Wednesday morning.

The same explosions would also have been heard by hundreds of forum guests, some of whom had flown in ahead of the first day of discussion. Some of the most prominent guests this year are from Saudi Arabia, including Energy Minister Prince Abdulaziz bin Salman.

Drone strikes on Moscow lets Kyiv negotiate as equals: Zelenskyy

Reuters
Kyiv, June 3

UKRAINE'S STEPPED-up strikes deep inside Russia enable Kyiv to negotiate the end of the war on an equal footing, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said, after one of the barrages struck an oil terminal and naval base hundreds of kilometres away.

For months, Kyiv's troops have been conducting attacks on Russian fossil fuel industry sites, at times daily, aiming to cut Moscow's main funding source for the war and pressure the Kremlin for talks.

"Thank God that today we have security guarantees that allow us to end this war on equal footing with the Russians in any format of diplomacy," Zelenskyy told reporters in Kyiv, speaking alongside NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte.

Zelenskyy said it was "only a question of time" for Ukraine to increase the scale of the strikes, which forced some of the Russian refineries to suspend operations and boosted morale among Ukrainians, who have lived under constant threat of Russian drones and missiles for more than four years.

• BRIEFLY

THAILAND

Ex-PM Thaksin freed from prison after royal pardon



Former PM Thaksin Shinawatra after his release from prison on Wednesday. AP

THAILAND'S FORMER Prime Minister Thaksin Shinawatra formally completed all his obligations related to a prison sentence on Wednesday, when a royal pardon ended his four-month probation early. The 76-year-old billionaire populist, who was a dominant force in Thai politics for more than two decades, was released from a Bangkok prison last month to cheering crowds. There has since been speculation that he might continue to exert his strong influence over the Pheu Thai Party, which is part of the governing coalition. AP

INDONESIA

Officials held over free meals corruption case

INDONESIAN OFFICIALS arrested the recently dismissed head of an agency overseeing President Prabowo Subianto's flagship free meals programme on Wednesday along with two other former officials, hours after a raid put the agency's offices under lockdown. Less than 24 hours after his sacking by Prabowo, Dadan Hindayana, the National Nutrition Agency former chief, was arrested by Indonesia's Attorney General's Office on charges of causing state losses. REUTERS

ITALY

2 held for arson attack that killed 4 migrants

ITALIAN POLICE on Tuesday arrested two people accused in the deaths of four migrant farmworkers who were burned alive in a car, a gruesome attack captured on video surveillance cameras, police and news reports said. According to the video, which was broadcast Tuesday on RAI state television, assailants poured liquid into the back of the car and set it ablaze as it was parked at a gas station in Amendolara, near Cosenza in the southern Calabria region, RAI said. AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

Security forces kill 17 terrorists in Balochistan

PAKISTANI SECURITY forces have killed at least 17 suspected terrorists following a bomb attack on a shuttle train in Quetta city of the restive Balochistan province last week. According to the ISPR statement, security forces effectively targeted several terrorist hideouts in operations conducted in Mastung, Nushki, Zehri and Khuzdar districts. PTI

BANGLADESH

Govt exits IMF programme, seeks new deal

BANGLADESH HAS requested a new loan arrangement from the International Monetary Fund and is exiting its current \$5.5 billion programme, officials said on Wednesday. The officials said Dhaka will soon start talks with the IMF on a framework that would shape the design and conditions of the new lending programme. REUTERS

WHO says Ebola response catching up as confirmed Congo cases hit 344

Reuters
Geneva, June 3

THE WORLD Health Organization said on Wednesday that the world is "catching up" with the Ebola outbreak in Democratic Republic of Congo, where there have been 344 confirmed cases of the disease and 60 confirmed deaths, although challenges remain.

"The outbreak had a big head start, and we're still behind, but under the leadership of the government of DRC, we're catching up," WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said during a press briefing.

The outbreak, linked to the Bundibugyo strain of the virus, has spread to neighbouring Uganda where 15 cases have been confirmed, including one death, the agency said.

Access to testing has also improved, which is why hundreds of cases that were initially suspected as Ebola have now been ruled out, the WHO said. The most common tests used for Ebola do not detect the Bundibugyo strain causing this out-

“The outbreak had a big head start, and we're still behind, but under the leadership of the government of DRC, we're catching up”

GENERAL TEDROS ADHANOM GEBREYESUS
WHO DIRECTOR-GENERAL

break, which caused a backlog. "What the field team is

doing, is looking to clear the backlog. So the lab so far has done 1,445 tests that cleared almost all the backlog we had, and every day as the surveillance improves, there are new suspect cases," said Abdirahman Mahamud, WHO director of health emergency alert and response operations.

There are 116 suspected cases awaiting testing, he said.

He said a team is also working through the 220 suspected deaths to ascertain the likelihood of the deaths being caused by Ebola.

Six people have recovered in the DRC and two in Uganda, showing Ebola patients can survive if they have access to care and seek treatment as soon as possible, the agency said.

The outbreak response continues to face challenges in scaling up testing capacity and tracing contacts, while blanket travel restrictions imposed by some countries are disrupting supply chains and hampering efforts, the agency said.

Only about 45% of contacts have been followed up, and to stay ahead of the outbreak,

that figure needs to rise above 90%, Tedros said.

Tedros also said the outbreak may have started as early as January, and teams were still investigating that, but stressed that the focus now should be on trying to contain it.

That will cost WHO at least \$115 million over the next three months, of which around 35% is currently raised, the agency's emergencies head Chikwe Ihekweazu said, adding that a "lot more" would be required in funding for the duration of the response.

Hezbollah launches rockets at Israel, tests US-mediated deal

Reuters
Beirut, Jerusalem, June 3

THE ISRAELI military said it had intercepted rockets fired by Hezbollah into Israel on Wednesday, while Lebanese security sources said an Israeli strike hit a car near Beirut, testing a US-mediated deal that aims to get the sides to curb attacks.

Iran-backed Hezbollah said in a statement it had fired a rocket salvo at an Israeli troop position in northern Israel, the first time it had announced a cross-border missile attack since Monday.

Lebanon has emerged as a focal point of the regional crisis this week, with the risk of further escalation looming over efforts to seal a deal between Iran and the United States. Tehran insists Israel halt Lebanon attacks under any agreement.

Hostilities have continued in southern Lebanon since the U.S.-mediated agreement was announced on Monday, when President Donald Trump said he asked Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu not to carry out a major raid on Beirut,



Smoke billows from southern Lebanon, following Israeli strikes, as seen from Nabatieh on Wednesday. REUTERS

and that Hezbollah, through intermediaries, had pledged not to attack Israel.

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz said on Tuesday that Israel would strike the Hezbollah-controlled southern suburbs of Beirut if northern Israel was attacked.

The Israeli military said it had intercepted two rockets that crossed into Israeli territory from Lebanon.

"Only the successful interception by the IDF (Israel Defence Forces) prevented what could have been a deadly attack

on civilians, including children," said Michael Leiter, Israel's ambassador to Washington, in a post on X.

He said Israel agreed to refrain from striking Beirut on condition that Hezbollah stopped attacking Israel and that Wednesday's attack had been a "blatant violation of that understanding".

However, Netanyahu later said Israel was checking if Hezbollah had fired into Israeli territory. "If that happens, we will obviously respond," he told CNBC.

Three of crew killed in UK Navy helicopter crash

Associated Press
London, June 3

BRITAIN'S ROYAL Navy said Wednesday that three of its members died in a helicopter crash earlier in southwest England during a training exercise.

The helicopter went down in a field in the county of Devon in the early hours of this morning just before 4 am.

The navy's head General Gwyn Jenkins, said in a statement that he was "deeply saddened to share the news that three crewmembers onboard a Royal Navy Merlin Mk4 helicopter have died after it crashed in the early hours of this morning near Sourton, Devon."

He said probe is under way and updates will be provided later. It wasn't immediately clear what caused the incident.

The Merlin helicopter is primarily used for anti-submarine warfare and is used for search and rescue, cargo transfers and maritime patrol, according to the Royal Navy's website.

The Ministry of Defence said the families of the service personnel killed have been informed.

Man who took 10 hostage in California standoff has been shot, killed: Police

Associated Press
California, June 3

A MAN held 10 people hostage inside a California office building before the FBI shot and killed him early Wednesday, bringing the more than 15-hour standoff to an end, police said.

The hostages were found unharmed inside the downtown Bakersfield building that houses a bank and a school district office, the Bakersfield Police Department said in a statement.

Anthony Scott Searles-Harris, 41, was shot and killed around 4:20 am, according to Sid Patel, of the FBI's Sacramento field office. Patel said the suspect has a history of violence and is a registered sex offender.

The standoff began around 1pm Tuesday when officers responded to a call of a bomb threat at the Chase Bank building, a four-story office building with dark-tinted glass windows all around. Police said the man had barricaded himself inside with several people.

The department's crisis ne-



FBI agents at the site of incident in Bakersfield, California on Wednesday. AP

gotiation team talked with the suspect by telephone and eventually two hostages were released Tuesday night, police said.

Nearby buildings, including City Hall and the police headquarters that are just a block away, were evacuated and some roads were temporarily closed during the hostage situation. Bakersfield, a city of about 380,000 residents, is the seat of largely rural Kern County and is about 100 miles (160 kms) northeast of Los Angeles.

• THERE ARE ABOUT 450 ORANGE-FRONTED PARAKEETS LEFT IN THE WORLD; SUPER BREEDERS NACHO AND TRIxie ARE DOING THEIR BEST TO BOLSTER THE POPULATION

In the fight against extinction, two parakeets are doing the heavy lifting

Laura Chung
Sydney, June 3

TWO CRITICALLY endangered parakeets have been hailed as "super breeders" in New Zealand and after the pair produced 55 chicks in two years - increasing the population by more than 10%.

The native kākāriki karaka, or orange-fronted parakeet, was declared extinct in 1919 and 1965, only to be rediscovered both times in the depths of mountainous valley areas. It is the country's rarest parakeet. Now, there are only about 450 left in the wild and in captivity.

Conservationists are doing all they can to prevent the bird

from going extinct a third time by creating predator-free sanctuaries and running breeding programs. Giving them a large helping hand are Trixie and Nacho, two kākāriki karaka who live at the Isaac Conservation and Wildlife Trust in Christchurch, in New Zealand's South Island.

They were paired in 2024 and of the 55 chicks they produced, 33 alone hatched this season, which runs from December to April. In comparison, other pairs in the breeding program have produced between 10 and 15 chicks, according to Leigh Percasky, wildlife manager at the Isaac Conservation and Wildlife Trust.

Nacho and Trixie, one of eight pairs at the facility, chose each other. The staff had placed several compatible birds together and let them pick their mates, Percasky said in an interview. That process makes for better pairings, he said.

The two birds are "quite relaxed," he said, and have distinctive traits that set them apart from other pairs.

"Nacho especially is very inquisitive and is quite interested in what people are doing," Percasky said. He noted that Trixie is slightly larger than other females. "As a pair they produce bigger-than-normal-sized chicks," he said.

Many of Nacho and Trixie's



The orange-fronted parakeets Nacho (left) and Trixie have single handedly produced 10% of the total population left on planet. NYT

offspring have been released into the wild, he said.

These efforts are led by the



Department of Conservation and Te Rūnanga o Ngāi Tahu, the main Indigenous tribe of the

South Island. Together they manage a recovery program focused on monitoring and protecting the sites where the birds live and finding new locations where they can be introduced.

"It's a really good reason to get out of bed and go to work when you're trying to save a critically endangered species," said Wayne Beggs, the department's kākāriki karaka recovery program lead.

New Zealand is home to 206 breeding bird species, and 94 of them are found nowhere else in the world. Among them are the world's fattest parrot, the kakapo, and the kiwi, a small bird with a long bill that is the country's national icon.

Like many native birds, the kakapo and the kiwi are flightless, a trait developed because the country was isolated for millions of years and had no ground dwelling predators such as ferrets and rats until humans introduced them.

There are now five established kākāriki karaka populations throughout the island, with officials hoping to increase that to 10 in the next two decades, Beggs said. The biggest threats to the bird's survival are predators, habitat degradation, diseases and climate change.

The country's captive breeding program started in 2003, when conservationists took kākāriki karaka eggs from

the wild and gave them to foster birds to raise. Since then, hundreds of kākāriki karaka have been bred in captivity and released.

But the ultimate goal for conservationists is to see the wild bird populations thrive on their own so that captive breeding programs are no longer needed.

Until then, Nacho and Trixie have more work to do.

Percasky said his priority was making sure both birds remain well.

"We're keeping a pretty close eye on them and making sure that they seem like they are fit and healthy and it's not taking too much out of them. But they keep very busy." NYT

THURSDAY, JUNE 4, 2026



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Morning nightmare



Two foreign nationals hang from a window as fire engulfs the building in Hauz Rani area of South Delhi on Wednesday. AP

21 killed in hotel blaze, 12 foreign nationals; building had 26 rooms but permit only for 6

Most victims were patients seeking treatment in nearby hospitals, caregivers; hotel owner arrested

Alok Singh, Sakshi Chand, Pragynesh & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 3

TWENTY-ONE people, including 12 foreign nationals, were killed in a fire that destroyed a ground-plus-five-storey building operating as a bed and breakfast (B&B) establishment in Malviya Nagar in South Delhi on Wednesday morning. Police said the foreign nationals belonged to Liberia, Nigeria, and Mozambique in Africa, and Bangladesh. Most of them were medical tourists who had come to India for treatment, or were accompanying patients.

The hotel, called Flourish Stays B&B, is located in a narrow lane in Hauz Rani, diagonally across the street from Max Hospital in Saket. Senior police officers said there were 26 rooms in the establishment, more than four times the maximum permissible number of six.

Most or all rooms in the building are believed to have been occupied at the time of the fire. The building had only one entry and exit. It allegedly did not have a No-Objection Certificate from the Fire Department.

The tragedy, among the biggest fire disasters of the past few decades in Delhi, came four days after a building undergoing illegal additions collapsed

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Grieving family members at Max Hospital in Saket, South Delhi, on Wednesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Father in ICU, son rented rooms to be near him: 8 of extended family dead

Drishti Jain, Mishal Mussaddique & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, June 3

FOR HOURS at a stretch Wednesday, members of the Aggarwal family moved between hospital corridors and mortuaries, showing photographs on their phones and clinging to hope. Some waited outside the AIIMS mortuary. Others stood in the crowded corridors of Max Hospital and AIIMS Trauma Centre, refreshing their phones for updates that never came. By evening, their worst fears came true: eight from the extended family had perished in the hotel blaze.

The family had come to Delhi after Radhe Shyam Ag-

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



garwal, a man in his 70s, had been in the Intensive Care Unit of the Max Hospital in Saket for

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Bangladesh to Nigeria: Far from home, agonising wait and search

Drishti Jain, Divya A & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, June 3

THE DIFFERENCE was stark. Families and relatives crowded mortuaries and hospital corridors to try and identify their kin who perished in the Hauz Rani hotel blaze Wednesday morning, but very few showed up looking for the foreign nationals who died in the city they came to seek medical treatment.

Families of most foreign nationals — 12 died while others were said to have been injured — were far from Delhi, in Bangladesh and countries across Africa, some unaware of the incident.

Officials said identification of the dead and notification to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Expelled TMC MLA Ritabrata Banerjee addresses a press conference in Kolkata on Wednesday. PARTHA PAUL

MORE REPORTS, PAGE 6

TMC fault lines in the open: 58 of 80 MLAs back rebel as Leader of Opp

Ritabrata Banerjee says rebels want Mamata to advise and guide

Atri Mitra & Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, June 3

E. EXPLAINED

Is Delhi next?

The concern in the TMC now is that after the divide in the state, its parliamentary party, which is led by Abhishek Banerjee, could be next. The TMC has 28 Lok Sabha members and 13 Rajya Sabha members. A division there will help the BJP push through key pieces of legislation without any hitch.

with Mamata's leadership, they had nothing to do with her nephew and Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee.

"We are representing Trinamool Congress in the Assembly. We are a bloc of 60 MLAs. We request Mamata Banerjee to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

FULL COVERAGE

PAGES 4,5

●HOTEL HAD NO FIRE NOC: POLICE PROBE
●POLICE, CIVIC BODY, GOVT DEPTS ENGAGE

IN BLAME GAME
●FIVE FOREIGN NATIONALS ESCAPED BLAZE BY MINUTES

Happening today

●PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi and Venezuela's Acting President Delcy Rodriguez, who is on a five-day visit to India, are expected to discuss energy cooperation, among other issues, during their talks.

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NATION

PAGE 7



D K SHIVAKUMAR TAKES OATH AS KARNATAKA CM

3 MONTHS AFTER WORLD CUP WIN Suryakumar removed as T20 captain, may lose place in team too

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, June 3

THREE MONTHS after he led India to the T20 World Cup title on home soil, Suryakumar Yadav has been removed as the captain and is unlikely to find a place in the team for the shortest format. This comes ahead of the tours of Ireland and England starting later this month.

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), in consultation with the team management and selection committee, will appoint a new captain for the new cycle.

"The selection committee, BCCI and team management,



Suryakumar Yadav

in consultation with coach Gautam Gambhir, have decided that India should go with a new skipper from here on. Under Surya's captaincy, the team did win the T20 World Cup, but keeping his form and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Amid trade talks, US proposes fresh tariffs of 12.5% on India

Not final, remain engaged with US, says Govt; envoy Gor defends move

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Akash Mandal
New Delhi, Mumbai, June 3

THE TRUMP administration Wednesday proposed 12.5% tariffs on India and 53 other countries, including China, the UK and Japan, after a United States Trade Representative (USTR) trade investigation under Section 301 of the US Trade Act of 1974 declared that these coun-

tries have failed to impose a legal prohibition on "importation of goods produced wholly or in part with forced labour".

The proposed tariffs, which can come into effect by July, have been announced while US and Indian negotiators are in the midst of talks in New Delhi to finalise a bilateral trade agreement.

The USTR has proposed a lower rate of 10% on six countries — Pakistan, Canada, Ecuador, the European Union, Indonesia and Mexico — stating that they have demonstrated a commitment to addressing forced labour imports and have committed to imposing and enforcing a forced labour import

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

●ACTION DAYS AFTER CANDLELIGHT PROTEST, ADMINISTRATION DENIES LINK

UP crackdown: Three coaching centres sealed days before recruitment exam, student anxiety simmers



One of the coaching centres which faced action. MANISH SAHU

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, June 3

TWICE A day for the last two days, Priya Rajput, a young job aspirant from Uttar Pradesh's Gorakhpur, and Pankaj Singh from neighbouring Deoria have been making anxious trips to their coaching centre in Prayagraj, hoping to find its gates re-opened. Instead, they are met each time by locked doors and official seals pasted across the entrance.

Both are in their 20s and have left their hometowns to

prepare for the Uttar Pradesh Police Constable recruitment examination, which is scheduled for June 8-10 and will see nearly 28 lakh aspirants compete for just over 32,000 posts.

With just days to go, every hour of study matters. But the coaching institute where they had enrolled is among three prominent ones sealed by the Prayagraj Development Authority (PDA) on May 31, which claims the buildings were operating without completing mandatory formalities.

The action came days after the owners of the three institutes participated in a candlelight march in Prayagraj on May 29, held by aspirants for competitive examinations. Their demands: release of scorecards for the Uttar Pradesh Police Sub-Inspector examination held on March 14-15, whose results were declared on May 7; cancellation of the Lekhpal recruitment test conducted on May 21 over what they claim are irregularities; and greater transparency in recruitment processes.

The PDA, though, denied

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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New Delhi



On an average, the system generates 350 alerts or error tickets daily, says a senior IRCTC official involved in the operations. EXPRESS

IRCTC reinforces its AI monitoring system to ensure hygiene and quality of food in trains

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, June 3

TO MAINTAIN hygiene and quality of food supplied in trains, the IRCTC has expanded its AI-based monitoring system to more than 800 kitchens that prepare food for Indian Railways, using 2,394 cameras to bring down related complaints from passengers.

The AI-enabled system detects nine types of factors that are primarily responsible for unhygienic food in trains — hairnet compliance, transparent gloves detection, mopping, wiping, and presence of rodents, flies and cockroaches. IRCTC served about 60 crore meals in 2025-26 to train passengers.

“This system started around two-and-half years back and we are consistently expanding... bringing more kitchens and types of errors under this initiative. The cameras installed in the kitchens are supported by AI tools that quickly identify unhygienic practices and send alerts. The system can detect even an insect as small as 7-8 mm. As soon as it detects a problem, a message is sent to the kitchen manager concerned. If the issue is not resolved, it is escalated. Overall, action is taken against the person responsible within two hours,” said a senior IRCTC official involved in monitoring operations from the war room at the corporation’s headquarters in Delhi.

The official further said that not wearing hairnet is the most common hygiene-related viol-

ation detected in kitchens. On an average, the system generates around 350 alerts or error tickets every day. For instance, in the last one month, it generated 13,550 tickets, with the North Zone accounting for the highest number of tickets at 4,123, followed by East Zone (3,205), West Zone (2,687), South Central Zone (2,226), and South Zone (1,309).

“The most difficult period for kitchens is during seasonal weather changes. During this time, the quality of food can get affected, and we receive the maximum number of complaints. The system generates around 350 tickets a day and its effective error rate is about 10%. At times the system flags violations that are actually not there. For example, a cook may be wearing a hairnet, but if it is pushed slightly upwards, the AI system classifies it as a violation because it is programmed in that way,” the official said.

In a rare move, the Railway Ministry had fined the IRCTC Rs 10 lakh for serving poor-quality curd in Patna-Tatanagar Vande Bharat train. It also imposed a fine of Rs 50 lakh on the company supplying food in the train. According to the data submitted in Rajya Sabha by the ministry in July 2025, it received over 19,000 food-related complaints from passengers in the last five years. The fines were imposed in 3,137 cases. The data shows that while the number of cases has marginally reduced from 7,026 in 2023-24 to 6,645 in 2024-25, it is significantly higher than 253 complaints recorded in FY21.

Surat crash: Kin provide blood samples for DNA matching

Kamal Saiyed
Bardoli, Surat June 3

A DAY after seven persons, including four women, were killed and several injured after a bus caught fire following a head-on collision with another bus near Bardoli town in Gujarat’s Surat district on Tuesday, the police are facing another challenge — identification of the deceased.

As of Wednesday evening, only the body of Ghanshyam Raju Barkale, who was the driver of the bus that caught fire and hailed from Jalgaon in Maharashtra, could be identified. The

Maharashtra State Transport bus was bound for Surat from Jamer Bus Depot in Jalgaon.

With the bodies severely charred, the Bardoli rural police on Wednesday took blood samples of four individuals, who are relatives of people who were on board the bus and are missing, for DNA tests.

Bardoli police inspector VA Sengal said, “One family from Nandurbar in Maharashtra is travelling to Bardoli on Wednesday evening to give blood samples for DNA tests, as their relative travelling in one of the buses involved in the accident is missing.”

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

21 killed in hotel blaze

in Saidulajab, another urban village a couple of kilometres away, killing six people.

Wednesday’s death toll is the highest in a fire in Delhi since the May 2022 fire in Mundka in west Delhi in which 27 people were killed. Before that, 43 people were killed in the Anaj Mandi fire of 2019, and 59 died in the Uphaar cinema tragedy of 1997.

Late on Wednesday evening, police arrested the owner of the B&B, a resident of Saket named Luv Kesh Bajaj. The FIR has invoked the section relating to culpable homicide not amounting to murder.

The fire appears to have started around 8.30 am in the hotel’s kitchen in the basement of the building, and climbed rapidly to the upper floors. The ground, first, and second floors were affected by the heat and dense black smoke.

As tongues of fire shot out of windows and licked around the building’s walls, a number of hotel guests jumped through the smoke, eyewitnesses and rescuers said. Local people smashed windows of the hotel to allow them to escape, and spread mattresses on the road to cushion their fall.

“I was trying to help some of them, and their skin was just peeling off. It was horrifying.

They were screaming in pain,” 40-year-old Israr Khan, one of the first responders, said.

Another resident of the area, Wasim Raza, a security officer at Max Hospital, said he helped rescue at least seven people. “There were two rooms in the basement,” Raza said. Several people were trapped inside, and he, along with police personnel, had cut through an iron window grill to reach them, Raza said.

DCP (South) Anant Mittal said: “At 8.48 am, information was received regarding a fire at Flourish Stays B&B, Malviya Nagar. Local police staff immediately reached the spot and commenced rescue, evacuation, and relief operations.” Eight fire tenders were pressed into service, Mittal said. “Through the coordinated efforts of police, fire services, and other emergency responders, more than 40 persons were rescued and shifted to nearby hospitals,” he said.

The injured have been admitted to Max, Saket, AIIMS Trauma Centre, and Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya Hospital in Malviya Nagar.

In a statement, Max hospital said, “Of the 39 patients received, 18 were brought dead, 15 are admitted in ICU, including 8 patients on ventilator and in critical condition... Five patients

with minor injuries were treated and discharged following primary medical care. One patient was shifted to Safdarjung Hospital due to excessive burns. The deceased include both local and foreign nationals.”

Thirteen people have been admitted to AIIMS, officials said.

In the afternoon, Delhi Home Minister Ashish Sood ordered the summary sealing of any B&B that was found to be violating building plans and guidelines. “No need to issue any show cause notice or give time to such owners for explanation. Just seal all the B&Bs,” Sood said. The Minister also directed a high-level committee to inspect all B&Bs across the capital.

In the evening, Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra told *The Indian Express* that the government’s B&B policy had already been withdrawn “about a month ago”. “There were several gaps in it... We are working on a new policy...,” Mishra said.

The Department of Tourism published the draft of its Bed & Breakfast Policy, 2026 on May 26, and invited comments and suggestions from the public.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta met with all ministers, the chief secretary, and all stakeholder departments, and pledged firm and speedy action. “The lapses... will be examined with utmost seriousness, and accountability will be fixed wherever it lies. A Magisterial Inquiry has been or-

dered... A city-wide crackdown will be launched against illegal properties, unauthorised guest houses and establishments operating in violation of fire safety norms and building by-laws. Such premises will be sealed and prosecuted in accordance with the law,” the CM posted on X.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, President Droupadi Murmu, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, and Chief Minister Gupta condoled the loss of lives in the tragedy.

“The loss of lives due to a fire incident in Malviya Nagar, Delhi is tragic. My condolences to those who have lost their loved ones,” the PMO posted on X. The President described the loss of lives as extremely heartbreaking. The LG expressed his deep distress, and the CM said she was deeply saddened.

Malviya Nagar MLA Satish Upadhyay said: “Our immediate response was to activate the entire system. We contacted the Disaster Management team, the DM (district magistrate) of our area, SHO (station house officer of the local police station), the sub-divisional magistrate, and the deputy commissioner of the municipal corporation (MCD).”

AAP leaders and former Delhi Chief Ministers Arvind Kejriwal and Atishi expressed concern over the incident and hit out at the BJP government for the repeated incidents of fire in the capital.

Bangladesh to Nigeria

the next of kin will depend on co-ordination with embassies, a process that could take time.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said the “MEA is in touch with Embassies and is extending all necessary assistance”.

Two Nigerian nationals showed up outside the AIIMS mortuary in the evening, clutching photographs and identity cards of two missing compatriots. They went inside, only to rush out minutes later. Hailing an auto-rickshaw, they headed to Safdarjung Hospital where critically injured victims had been shifted.

They were searching for 36-year-old Chiemeka Emmanuel and 39-year-old Ndubuisi Ferdinand, both believed to have been staying in the B&B.

“We are from the same village in Nigeria,” one of them said. He showed a video clip of rescue personnel bringing out a man from the basement, administering CPR before being placed in an ambulance. He said the man appeared to be Ferdinand. “The doctors and police at AIIMS told me to check for Ferdinand at Safdarjung Hospital. We are going there. I don’t know about Emmanuel,” he said.

Among those missing were three Bangladeshi nationals — Md Nurul Amin, Md Chand Mia and Md Nur Mia — who remained untraceable until late Wednesday evening, according to the Bangladesh High Commission in New Delhi.

The High Commission also said six Bangladeshi nationals sustained injuries, with at least

two reported to be critical. “Due to the severe burn injuries... conclusively establishing their identities is currently not possible. Consequently, the exact number of Bangladeshi nationals among the deceased or missing remains unknown at this stage,” a Bangladesh High Commission official said.

According to officials, many of the Bangladeshi nationals were in Delhi either for medical treatment or accompanying family members undergoing treatment.

Among the injured are Mo-sharraf Hosain, admitted to Max Hospital, Saket; Omme Zahura and Rahana Akhter, admitted to AIIMS; and Umme Samiya Putu, admitted to Max Smart Hospital.

At AIIMS, three bodies were received at the Burns Emergency around 11.30 am. Two were estimated to be about 40 years old and had suffered 85 per cent and 70 per cent burns respect-

ively, while another male victim, also around 40 years old, had sustained severe flame burns and inhalation injuries.

By late evening, Fire department sources said two foreign nationals had died after being brought to AIIMS Trauma Centre: Roland, 40, a citizen of Liberia, and Tshipambaachil, 40, a citizen of Mozambique.

At Max Hospital, 18 people were brought dead. Hospital authorities did not specify how many had been identified, but sources said three to four bodies were charred beyond recognition. Some were suspected to have died of asphyxiation and were believed to be foreign nationals. Separately, Fire department sources said that as many as 12 victims at Max Hospital remained unidentified. An unidentified foreign national, the sources said, was admitted to the Burns Ward in Safdarjung Hospital.

TMC

be our adviser and guide us. We will play the role of a constructive Opposition,” Ritabrata said.

While there was no response from the former CM, the TMC’s organisational command, stunned by the defiance of the MLAs, dissolved all party committees and frontal organisations with immediate effect.

“The party will undertake a comprehensive exercise of introspection, performance review and organisational assessment at every level. Based on the findings of this exercise, the organisational structure of the parent body and all frontal organisations will be reconstituted and announced in due course.

The party remains committed to strengthening its organisation,” it said.

The new LoP, meanwhile, drew a distinction between the dissidents and the party’s organisational leadership, indicating that his group has no links to Abhishek, considered the number 2 in the party hierarchy. “Abhishek Banerjee has no connection with the legislature party,” Ritabrata said.

Other rebel MLAs said they had no problem with Mamata Banerjee but would never accept Abhishek’s leadership.

The comments illustrate a widening gap between the MLAs and a section of the TMC leadership, a faultline that has deepened since the election setback last month.

While a handful of MLAs re-

main with Mamata — including Kunal Ghosh, Madan Mitra, and Sovande Bhattacharyay, who was chosen as the LoP but whose name the dissidents rejected — one of her oldest associates, Firhad Hakim, is set to resign as Kolkata mayor in the coming days, sources said. Hakim is learnt to have sought Mamata’s permission and received the TMC chief’s approval.

This crisis marks the culmination of a revolt that began with allegations of forged signatures on a letter proposing Chattopadhyay as LoP and snowballed into an open challenge to the leadership. Asked about the signature controversy and Abhishek’s alleged link to it, Ritabrata said, “We have complained to the Speaker... He may write to the Lok Sabha Speaker. They will de-

cide if he will remain MP or not.”

He said the party would continue to take on the BJP and would not “cede one inch of land” to the ruling party.

Echoing him, TMC’s new Chief Whip Akhruzzaman said, “We will fight against the BJP and if this government does not take steps against post-poll violence, we will not spare them in the coming Assembly session.”

The BJP, meanwhile, maintained the developments were an internal matter of the TMC. “Trinamool will break, as it should,” said minister Tapas Roy, while state BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said his party would not accept leaders from the TMC. “Trinamool-isation of the BJP will never happen. Our doors are closed to the TMC,” he said.

UP coaching centres

any connection between the crackdown and the protest, insisting the action was based solely on compliance-related violations.

For aspirants gathered outside the shuttered centres, though, the timing has raised difficult questions. “The examination is next week, and our study is blocked,” said Pankaj Singh, who is enrolled at Super Climax Coaching, one of the three institutes.

The other two are Target On Coaching and Examपुर Coaching, among Prayagraj’s most prominent institutes. All three institutes have been operating for several years from rented premises leased by their owners.

“My family has dreamed of seeing me become a police constable,” Rajput, who stays on rent in Prayagraj, said. “I have worked hard and stayed away from home to prepare. Days before the exam, we don’t know how to complete our preparation, where to meet our teachers and get our doubts cleared.”

Many students linked the sealing to plans announced by aspirants and coaching operators for a protest march in Lucknow on June 12 if their demands weren’t addressed. Vineet Tiwari, a government job aspirant from Chandauli district, claimed, “We believe the pur-

pose is to discourage participation in the June 12 march.”

Simultaneously, police have booked Pankaj Pandey and Ashutosh Pandey, two prominent figures in the ongoing stir, on charges of breach of peace. Both are in judicial custody. However, a senior police officer said the action against the two was not linked to the student protest, and that they “have been booked in a separate, unrelated case”.

Pankaj and Ashutosh are co-founders of the Joint Competitive Students’ Hunkar Forum, a platform that emerged recently after demonstrations by government job aspirants over paper leaks and alleged irregularities in recruitment exams.

A candlelight protest, and what followed

On May 29, Prayagraj saw a candlelight march that started from Manmohan Park and was scheduled to end at Azad Park. But participants alleged that police stopped the procession near the Hindu Hostel. The aspirants regrouped at Azad Park, where they held a public meeting, raised slogans and once again pressed their demands for transparency and accountability.

The protest drew not only students but also owners and teachers of several coaching institutes, including the three

centres in question.

“The idea was to register our demands in a peaceful and constructive way,” said Arvind Maurya, 24, an aspirant from Azamgarh district. Maurya said the protesters were demanding a fresh examination for Lekhpal recruitment and the publication of detailed scorecards for the Uttar Pradesh Police Sub-Inspector exam so that candidates could verify their performance.

The first demand was linked to reports on social media alleging irregularities at a centre in Lucknow. “The examination was supposed to be held from 10 am to noon, but we were told that some candidates came out of the centre in Lucknow around 2 pm,” Maurya claimed.

The examination was conducted by the Uttar Pradesh Subordinate Services Selection Commission (UPSSSC). A senior UPSSSC official said it was conducted in accordance with established procedures and security protocols. “The examination was held with complete integrity and all necessary safeguards,” the official said. “Claims of a paper leak are false.”

The official added that the commission had reviewed reports from centres and relevant authorities and found no evidence of malpractice or irregularities. The official noted that protests had emerged primarily in Prayagraj and not in other parts of the state. Regarding allegations that candidates at one

centre in Lucknow left the premises nearly two hours after the test officially ended, the official said the delay was due to routine inquiries by administrative and police teams.

Addressing demands for the release of scorecards for the Sub-Inspector recruitment examination, whose results were announced on May 7, a senior official of the Uttar Pradesh Police Recruitment and Promotion Board said the recruitment process has not yet concluded, as candidates must still undergo physical efficiency tests and document verification.

“Until the entire recruitment process is completed and the final results are declared, scorecards cannot be made public,” the official said.

‘Uncertainty for students and teachers’

On June 1, a day after the sealing action, when some aspirants gathered at the Circuit House in Prayagraj to meet Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh and voice their concerns, the AAP leader said the meeting was interrupted by the district administration and the police.

“Even in closed rooms, permission to discuss the future of millions of students is denied; the administration has arrived to stop even talk of paper leaks,” he claimed on X. He also shared a video purportedly featuring Vivek Kumar, the owner of Exam-pur Coaching,

8 of family dead

several days. His son Vivek Aggarwal, a Gurgaon resident in his late 40s who had worked as a director at a multinational company, rented rooms at Flourish Stays, a bed-and-breakfast in Hauz Rani, just minutes from the hospital. Vivek stayed there with his mother Premalata, his wife Tarjani and their two daughters, Jeeviska and Waria.

“They chose the hotel because it was near the hospital,” said Prem Bansal, Vivek’s father-in-law. “The family wanted to be nearby all the time. We were hoping he (Radhe Shyam) would be discharged soon.”

One of Vivek’s daughters had flown in from Bengaluru to visit her grandfather, according to Vijay Aggarwal, Vivek’s cousin. What began as a short family visit soon turned into a tragedy.

In the early hours of Wednesday morning, Vivek managed to make a frantic call to a relative in Delhi’s Kotla area. “*Yahan pe aag lag gayi* (There is a fire here),” he reportedly said. It was the last message many family members would hear from him.

As news spread, nearly 40 relatives rushed to Max Hospital, fearing that Vivek and the four family members staying with him were among those trapped inside the B&B facility.

But the tragedy stretched beyond Vivek’s immediate family. Also staying at the hotel were Vivek’s maternal uncle, Ashok Goyal from Kishangarh, and his mother’s sister Kamla and her husband Jimir.

“The doctors had said that Radhe Shyam’s health had worsened. That is why all the close relatives had come,” said one of the relatives.

By Wednesday afternoon, six maternal cousins had gathered outside the AIIMS mortuary while Ashok Goyal’s son travelled from Kishangarh to Delhi to help identify the dead.

By evening, the family’s worst suspicions were confirmed — eight from the extended family had perished. Inside Max Hospital, Radhe Shyam Aggarwal remained in intensive care, unaware of the tragedy.

US tariffs

prohibition through a formal Agreement on Reciprocal Trade (ART) with the US.

The new set of Section 301 tariffs assumes significance as it could serve as the legal basis for the trade deals which were signed by the Trump administration. The trade deals lost legal standing after the reciprocal tariffs were declared invalid by the US Supreme Court in February.

While India has agreed to an agreement, a formal signing is due. The ongoing four-day talks are expected to iron out pending issues.

The Commerce and Industry Ministry, meanwhile, said India remains engaged with the US on the matter as a part of Section 301 proceedings. India is also simultaneously engaged with the US for finalisation of a framework agreement, as was announced on February 2, and in accordance with the joint statement released on February 7.

“The proposed tariffs are not yet final, and stakeholders can submit requests to participate in public hearings by 22 June 2026. Written comments can be submitted until 6 July 2026. Public hearings will be held on 7 July 2026. The USTR will consider the comments and testimony received before taking a final decision on the proposed measures,” the Ministry said.

Responding to questions at Citi’s 2026 India Conference in Mumbai, Sergio Gor, US Ambas-

sador to India, said any tariff actions undertaken by the US administration are applied globally and are not targeted towards specific regions or countries such as India.

“Look, the reality of it is that the tariffs that were applied were applied around the world. So these weren’t tariffs that were picked at India. These were tariffs that were applied to everybody, from the EU to Canada to Mexico, to literally almost every other country in Asia, including Japan and North Korea,” he said.

Gor said 99% of the negotiations have been wrapped up, with just a few technical and legal sticking points left to iron out. “It’s that 1% that we are striving to get across the finish line so that the leaders can have a signing and put that in stone and in law. And so we’re hopeful that it will get accomplished over the next weeks, or maybe several weeks, but it’s not going to be years,” he said.

“One of the reasons this deal is tough is because for many years India has held the line on so many items that the US was not able to get in here. That’s why it took 19 years for the EU to crack that trade deal. And a lot of it (of the remaining 1%) is frankly technicalities. Part of it is when does something kick in, and that’s a lot of legal language that we’re hopeful that they’ll get there,” he said.

He said the talks will continue this week, with US negotiators slated to meet Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal Thursday.

Suryakumar

future in mind, they felt it’s time to move on,” a top BCCI official told *The Indian Express*. “He won’t be considered for selection, and the decision will be conveyed to Surya soon,” the official said.

The Indian team will be

playing two T20Is in Ireland, and then five in England.

Surya’s form with the bat was a big concern -- he has endured a prolonged run of poor form over the last two years, including in the 2026 IPL season. While he finished the season with a half-century against the Rajasthan Royals, Surya only managed 270 runs in 13 innings, averaging 20.76 this IPL.

teachers, and caters to thousands of aspirants preparing for competitive examinations.

Ahmed said many of their students have secured positions in the police and other government services. “Our selection record speaks for itself,” he said. “If you visit police stations across the region, you are likely to find officers who once studied here.”

According to Ahmed, the institute currently teaches around 5,000 students through offline programmes conducted in three shifts, and a much larger audience through online classes.

Target On, the third coaching institute whose premises have been sealed, is located in Prayagraj’s Katra neighbourhood and has been operating from a rented accommodation for the past six years. Its director, Ravi P Tiwari, said he had participated in the candlelight march because it was “a legal manner to support students’ concerns”.

Tiwari said Target On has around 3,000 students enrolled in classroom programmes, while its online courses reach many more across states. He said the closure had disrupted the preparation of thousands of aspirants at a critical point in the examination calendar.

The three institutes are among an estimated 400 spread across Prayagraj, which has long been regarded as one of north-east India’s most important hubs for competitive exam preparation.

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Eviction row: What happens to us, ask 700-odd people who work at Delhi Gymkhana Club

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 3

FOR 36-YEAR-OLD Nitesh Kumar, the Delhi Gymkhana Club was never a symbol of privilege or power. It was the place that gave him the confidence to take a home loan of Rs 30 lakh and buy a flat in Dwarka.

When he took out the loan five months ago, he was counting on his job as a bartender at the Club to help him pay his EMIs over the next 30 years.

But his dreams were dashed on May 22 when the Delhi Gymkhana Club was asked by the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs to hand over its premises, as the 27.3-acre plot on Safdarjung Road -- on which it stands -- is required for "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure".

"When we got to know about this, I broke down in front of my son," Kumar says. "I did not eat or drink water for a day. I had counted on this job to pay back the loan in 30 years."

Not being able to pay his EMI is not the only concern he has today though. While he is looking for a new job, he also has to find a place for his family to live.

Kumar is among the hundreds of jhuggi dwellers who have been asked to vacate their homes near the Prime Minister's residence on Lok Kalyan Marg and shift to DUSIB (Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board) flats in Savda Ghevra.

He had no plans to shift to Savda Ghevra as he had already bought a flat in Dwarka.

Kumar is one of the around 700 staff members who work at the Club. While around 260 among them are permanent employees, 120 are contractual workers and the rest are daily wages.

In a representation to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Delhi Gymkhana Employees' Union has said that nearly 3,500 family members are directly or indirectly dependent on such people who work at the



(Clockwise from top) At Delhi Gymkhana Club; Amit Acharya; Nitesh Kumar. GAJENDRA YADAV

Club. "Most employees also have home loans, education loans and other financial obligations. If the functioning of the club is disrupted, these employees and their families could face severe economic and social hardship," the appeal said.

Nitin Kumar Tamta (39), who works as a cook at the Club on a daily wage basis, has reluctantly begun to look for a new job. He is yet to hear from the places he has approached for a job. "I have been working here for more than 10 years. I am now emotionally attached to other people who work at the Club," he says.

Recalling that he had become unconscious in the kitchen a few years ago, Tamta says, "The staff rushed me to a hospital and took care of everything." His immediate concern though is his mother, who suffered a paralysis attack recently. "If the Club closes and I do not get another job, buying medicines for her will become difficult," he adds.

In-charge of takeaway food orders, Amit Acharya (41) has

spent more than two decades at the Club and knows exactly how some members like their Butter Chicken prepared and how others prefer their tea with toast.

His immediate concern -- how is he going to fund his daughter's cochlear implant.

"My daughter has complete hearing loss. I was going to take a loan from the Gymkhana Janata Co-operative Society, which gives us staff members loans at just 1% interest rate. How will I get her treated now?" he asks. Santosh Kumar (50), who works as a helper at the Club's library, also wanted to take a loan from the co-operative society since one of his four daughters wants to learn Japanese. He is also wondering how he will fulfil her wish.

While the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs has maintained that the process of resuming leased land would continue, the Club has approached the Delhi High Court. The court has since recorded the Centre's assurance that no eviction would take place without following due process.

Cabinet nod for Rs 9,585-cr scheme to replace old trucks, buses in Delhi-NCR

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 3

TO CONTAIN vehicular emissions, which remain one of the biggest contributors to air pollution in Delhi-NCR, the Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a two-year 'cleaner mobility' scheme with an outlay of Rs 9,585 crore to replace old trucks and buses, officials said. The scheme will seek to incentivize owners of trucks and buses that are complying with older emissions norms such as BS-IV to replace their vehicles with BS-VI or stricter emission-compliant vehicles or electric vehicles, as per an official government statement. However, government vehicles are excluded from the scheme.

As per officials, state governments will waive registration fees and grant up to 100 percent motor vehicle tax concessions for new vehicles and 50 percent for used vehicles for 10 years. State governments will also waive off pending liabilities on the old vehicles participating in the scheme, they added.

The Centre will provide 5 percent interest subvention on loans for five years, monthly fuel vouchers worth up to Rs 4,800 depending on vehicle category, and lump-sum benefits for EV purchases or certificate of deposit trading. Of the Rs 9,585 crore outlay Rs 5,041 crore will be from Centre, while an estimated Rs 1,601 crore in tax concessions will come from the participating states.

The scheme will be funded through the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB) under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs and will be implemented in collaboration with participating states and union territories of Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh, officials said.

The move assumes significance as the transport sector contributes 14 percent of PM 2.5 pollution, 40 percent of carbon monoxide and 63 percent of nitrogen dioxide emissions in Delhi-NCR.

Within the transport sector, trucks and buses account for 36 percent of PM 2.5 emissions with only 3 percent of total fleet. "It is estimated that a single pre-BS heavy-duty vehicle emits as much as 14 BS-VI compliant vehicles. Even a BS-IV vehicle emits 2.7 times more than a BS-VI counterpart," the official statement said.

It is estimated that 2.07 lakh (1.91 lakh trucks and 16,329 buses) owners are present in Delhi-NCR. However, the scheme will not benefit those owning BS-III or older vehicles. Scrapping of such vehicles will be mandatory at the registered vehicle scrapping facilities,

while BS-IV vehicles may either be scrapped or sold outside NCR in non-National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) cities or towns, officials said. Non-NCAP cities refers to areas where pollution levels are compliant with National Ambient Air Quality standards.

"Owners must then purchase and register a BS-VI or stricter norms compliant or electric vehicle within NCR. However, in Delhi, Light Goods Vehicles purchased under the scheme must be electric, while buses must be BS-VI CNG (Compressed Natural Gas) or electric only," the government statement added.

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ONGC, Western Region, Ahmedabad Asset seek applications from eligible **retired executives of ONGC** for engagement as **Junior/Associate Consultants** for period of two years for posting as **Competent Persons in Shift / General Shift on Charter Hired and O&M operated Work Over Rigs of Ahmedabad Asset** for supervision of **Work-over Operations**. Interested retired ONGC executives of **Production/ Drilling/ Mechanical/ Electrical/ Instrumentation discipline (E1 to E5 and E6 level)**, with in line experience in respective operations and with relevant qualification within age limit of 64 years as on date of advertisement may apply. For detailed advertisement and Bio-data format please visit at ONGC portals i.e. ongcindia.com

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Industry 4.0 Innovation Centre, a Society established for commissioning and operation of a CPSE-led Hi-Tech Tool Room & Service Bureau at Guwahati (Assam), invites applications from eligible candidates for appointment to the following position:

Position	Scale of Pay (IDA)	Vacancy Date
Director	₹1,50,000/- -- ₹3,00,000/-	01-07-2026

The Industry 4.0 Innovation Centre has been established pursuant to the Union Budget FY 2026-27 for promoting Industry 4.0 and Frontier Technologies through collaboration with CPSEs, MSMEs, Industries, Startups, Academic Institutions and National/International Agencies. Details regarding eligibility criteria, age, experience, pay scale, application process and other terms & conditions are available at www.i4icenter.com, www.i4icenter.org, www.nrl.co.in. **Last Date for Receipt of Applications:** 30th June 2026 (up to 1600 Hrs) Applications along with supporting documents should be submitted to:

Secretary
Industry 4.0 Innovation Centre
NRL Centre, 122 A, G.S. Road, Christian Basti, Guwahati-781005, Assam
Email: manipranjal.saikia@nrl.co.in

Sd/- Secretary
Industry 4.0 Innovation Centre

Advertisement No. : 06/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
APPLICATION FOR REGISTRATION OF THE RESIDENTIAL COLONY UNDER NILP NAMELY "PRIVANA ENCLAVE" SITUATED IN SECTOR 76 & 77, GURUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY M/S. DLF LIMITED

It is for the information of the general public that an application dated 25.05.2026 for registration of the project under Section 4 of the Act of 2016 is submitted in the Authority for the project namely "PRIVANA ENCLAVE" by M/s DLF Limited.

The Department of Town & Country Planning, Haryana granted license no. 219 of 2023 dated 25.10.2023 measuring 116.2962 acres to M/s DLF Limited and Others in collaboration with M/s DLF Limited for setting up of a Residential Colony under NILP (after migration of 103.05625 acres from license no. 27 of 2012 and fresh area admeasuring 13.24 acres) in sector 76 & 77, Gurugram.

The promoter has obtained the revised demarcation cum zoning plan and phasing plan approved from Department of Town and Country Planning, Haryana vide memo no. ZP-1895-Vol-III/PA(DK)/2025/16536 dated 06.05.2025. The entire project of 116.2962 acres comprises of 10 phases. Now, the promoter has obtained the revised demarcation cum zoning plan approved from Department of Town and Country Planning, Haryana vide memo no. ZP-1895-III/PA(DK)/2026/5351 dated 13.02.2026 and layout plan approval vide memo no. ZP-1895-VI/PA(DK)/2026/16039 dated 08.05.2026.

Phase I (25.148 acres), Phase VI (12.572 acres) and Phase VIII (17.701 acres) of the project are already registered in the Authority vide RC no. 116 of 2023, 46 of 2024 and 57 of 2025 respectively.

The current application pertains to the registration of Phase VII of the project namely "PRIVANA ENCLAVE" admeasuring 4.66 Acres out of total area 116.29625 acres.

The relevant application and related documents are available in the office of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram which can be seen by any concerned on any working day during office hours upto 18.06.2026. Also, if anyone wishes to appear, may appear before the Authority on 22.06.2026 at 11:00 am during the hearing.

Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal.

Sd/- Secretary
Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 04.06.2026

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12329/1000/EX/0046-2021

Morning Nightmare

THURSDAY, JUNE 4, 2026

4

No fire NOC, B&B had 26 rooms against permit for 6

Alok Singh, Sakshi Chand & Pragynesh
New Delhi, June 3

OPERATED 26 rooms against a permit for 6, no fire NOC (No Objection Certificate), flammable decor — this is what police and fire authorities have found in their initial probe into the blaze that broke out at a bed and breakfast (B&B) in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar on Wednesday morning, claiming 21 lives.

When *The Indian Express* visited the spot, it found that two B&Bs, Flourish Stays and Micasa Inn, ran from one building, separated by a wall.

Sources in the police said the fire started around 8.40 am from the ground floor of Flourish B&B, where its kitchen and cafeteria were located, and spread to other floors.

According to a senior official, the government has sought a report from the Tourism department — responsible for granting permissions to set up a B&Bs in the city — on who approved the facility.

"An order has been issued to the department seeking a report on who gave permission for the Malviya Nagar B&B. The six-storey building, comprising a basement...was allowed only six rooms....," said the official.

While the Delhi Police has registered an FIR under the section of culpable homicide not amounting to murder against unknown persons, a Delhi Fire Service (DFS) official said the hotel owner, Luv Kesh Bajaj, had installed multiple wooden and plastic frames inside as well as outside the building as part of its decor, increasing the combustible load.

According to DFS officials, the owner had never applied

for a fire NOC. The hotel also lacked adequate fire-safety equipment, they added.

Police said that a probe has found out that the license of the establishment was obtained in the name of one Jai Mishra. The hotel's water and electricity connections were also registered in Mishra's name, officers said, adding that he will soon be questioned.

According to the police, the B&B had guest rooms in the basement as well as on the upper three floors of the building, with the basement housing a storeroom and two guest rooms.

"The blaze quickly spread across the ground and first floor, blocking access routes to the terrace, while thick smoke engulfed the premises. Worsening the rescue efforts, the building's lift also stopped functioning, trapping guests who were unable to use either the lift or the staircase to escape," an officer said, adding that many guests were asleep when the fire broke out.

Police said the fire primarily affected the basement, first, and second floors of the building, which housed 26 rooms.

"Around seven to eight people had to jump from the second and third floor of the building to save themselves. Some managed to reach the terrace, but the terrace door was initially locked," an eyewitness told *The Indian Express*.

Sources said the hotel was a much sought-after place to stay for foreign nationals from African countries who came to Delhi on medical visas.

It was located near three major medical establishments: AIIMS, Max Hospital in Saket, and Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya Hospital.



At the site of the fire in Hauz Rani area of South Delhi on Wednesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

'Owner only applied for Tatkal licence for tea stall': Police, MCD, govt depts shift blame onto one another over lapses & approvals

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 3

THE BLAZE at a bed and breakfast (B&B) in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar that claimed at least 21 lives on Wednesday follows two other major fire tragedies in the Capital earlier this year: the Palam and the Vivek Vihar incidents. Even as a blame game has started — with the police, the civic body, tourism and fire departments pointing fingers at one another — the common people are questioning the authorities over alleged gaps and lapses.

According to the Delhi Police, The Flourish Stay had the permission to operate only six rooms under a B&B module. The owner, however, was allegedly operating 26 rooms.

Government departments are blaming the police and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), saying it was their responsibility to pass the building plan and approvals for the restaurant; and to file reports on the guests staying at the B&B.

The MCD claimed it "had no role to play" as the B&B was a 'Lal Dora' property and thus exempt from municipal building norms. "All buildings falling under 'Lal Dora' areas and constructed before 2014 are protected... Therefore, MCD cannot take action against such buildings," said a senior MCD official.

The Flourish Stay had a restaurant on the first floor and a kitchen in the basement.



People run for cover as fire at the hotel in Malviya Nagar spreads on Wednesday morning. AP

The civic body said it was not aware of the restaurant at the B&B because the owner had only applied for a 'Tatkal' licence for a tea stall on the ground floor for which physical inspections are not mandatory. According to a document, "The House, The Flourish Stay, located at H.No. 269-C-2, Hauz Rani, Malviya Nagar, is owned by Jay Mishra and was registered for six rooms (three rooms on the first floor and three rooms on the second floor) under the Silver Category of The National Capital Territory of Delhi (Incredible India) Bed & Breakfast Establishment (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007, by the Department of Tourism, Government of NCT of Delhi."

A senior official from the Delhi Tourism department told

The Indian Express, "Under the BnB scheme, a licence is issued for three years, after which it is renewed on the owner's request. The licence, issued in 2024, was valid till 2027. Before issuing the licence, a team comprising three to four officials/members from the Tourism department, DTTDC (Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation), Delhi Police and the Tourism Ministry conducts an inspection. Then a report is submitted."

"As per the Bed and Breakfast Act, we are only required to check if the premises has rooms, beds, sofas, mattress, washroom, (maintains) proper hygiene etc. The Tourism department does not grant the fire NOC (No Objection Certificate), building plans and other per-

missions....," the official said.

"The building had three rooms on one floor and three on the other. An approval was given for that. As per the rules, the owner of a B&B must reside in the building and can operate only two-third of the total number of rooms, with a cap of up to six....," the official added.

"Our records show that the police had submitted in writing that the family who applied for the B&B licence, was staying there since 2021," the official, also highlighting that an owner is required to submit a report to the local police every 15 days on guests staying at the B&B. The official said it is the job of the police to keep track of guests to ensure illegal activities are not being carried out from the premises.

"The police are expected to

maintain regular oversight of guest records and occupancy details," said the official.

"The Tourism department plays a role at the time of licence renewal unless a complaint is received. As per the rules, the department can cancel a licence if any malpractice comes to light, and impose penalties on the owner for about three months," said the official.

Officials, meanwhile, said that the Tourism department neither conducts regular inspections, nor is it required to do so as per the B&B Act.

Asked about the restaurant at the facility, the senior MCD official said, "You can apply for a Tatkal licence by paying a requisite amount... physical inspections are also not needed. This was introduced for the

ease of doing business. So, the owner (of The Flourish Stay) must have got this licence by misrepresenting facts. The only inspection done was by the Tourism department. Besides, as it is a guest house-cum-BnB set-up, the MCD cannot interfere, especially when it is a Lal Dora property. Also, when foreign nationals were staying here, various regulations come into play and the police do have a role to play."

Officials said only 400-500 people who own houses in the Lal Dora area have applied for building plan sanctions and approval for fresh construction over the years. Officials said that houses that fall under Lal Dora area, built before 2014, come under a special provision act and the MCD gives permission for construction and sanctions building plans only when the owner demolishes the house and starts a fresh construction. "Largely, this is criminal negligence by the owner. The only permission he had taken was for a tea stall, but he was not running one. He was running a kitchen and a restaurant. We never went inside the premises, so we did not know anything," the senior MCD official said.

"We will take necessary action against such establishments. Action will be initiated against any such official found responsible. Buildings and restaurants violating norms will be sealed," another official told *The Indian Express*.

Owner of hotel, Luv Kesh Bajaj, arrested

Sakshi Chand & Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 3

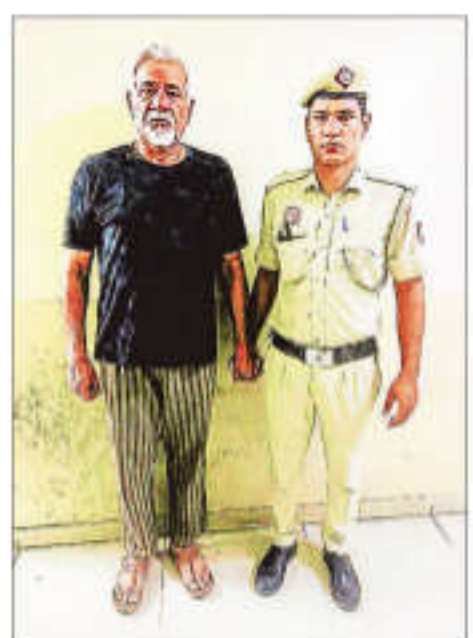
LUV KESH Bajaj, who was on the run after a blaze at a hotel owned by him — Flourish Stay B&B in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar — left 21 people dead, was arrested by the police late Wednesday.

Earlier in the day, the Delhi Police had issued a Lookout Circular (LOC) for him.

Police said Bajaj, who is 60 years old, runs a chain of hotels and guest houses across Delhi. While Bajaj lives with his wife in Saket, his two children live in the US, they added.

Sources in the police claimed that he was also booked in 2024, under Section 188 (violation of prohibitory orders) of the IPC, for not following security norms of installing CCTV cameras in the hotel premises.

The B&B is located in a narrow lane in Hauz Rani, diagonally across the street from



Luv Kesh Bajaj after his arrest on Wednesday. ANI

Max Hospital in Saket.

The building, which had only one entry and exit, did not have a No Objection Certificate from the Fire department. It comprised a basement and six floors. While the restaurant was on the first floor and the kitchen in the basement, the other floors had rooms.

Seal all B&Bs violating norms, says Sood; CM orders magisterial inquiry

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 3

DELHI HOME Minister Ashish Sood on Wednesday said that all B&Bs violating building plans and set guidelines are to be sealed.

"No need to issue any show-cause notice or give time to such owners for explanation. Just seal all the B&Bs," he said. The directions came on a day when a fire at a building in Malviya Nagar claimed 21 lives, prompting Chief Minister Rekha Gupta to order a magisterial inquiry into the incident.

"The lapses that culminated in the tragic fire at a guest house in Malviya Nagar will be examined with utmost seriousness, and accountability will be fixed wherever it lies. A Magisterial Inquiry has been ordered and an FIR has been registered against the owner of the property. A city-wide crackdown will be launched against illegal properties, unauthorised guest houses and establishments operating in violation of fire safety norms and building by-laws. Such premises will be sealed and prosecuted in accordance with the law," she posted on X.

Those responsible for this tragedy will be held account-



Minister Ashish Sood at the site of the fire. SHREYA SINGHAI

able, the CM added.

Sood, meanwhile, also directed that a high-level committee be constituted under the chairmanship of the District Magistrate South to inspect all B&Bs across the Capital.

Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, along with Sood, chaired an emergency meeting in which directions were issued that concerned departments are to launch a month-long drive beginning Thursday to check compliance of fire safety norms in all hotels, lodges, inns, nursing homes, coaching institutes, restaurants and other vulnerable commercial establishments.

Delhi Police, MCD and

Tourism department were also directed to jointly call meetings of all hotel associations. Further, authorities were directed to shut all rooms of hotels, lodges and inns that have additional rooms than what is permitted, the LG office said in a statement.

Beginning Thursday, for the next 15 days, meetings will be held with representatives of these premises regarding their fire safety equipment and water supply system.

Land owning agencies, Delhi Fire Service and Delhi Police were directed to conduct accessibility survey to identify the bottlenecks for fire tenders to reach any area in a colony.

Sohini Ghosh, Devansh Mittal & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, June 3

LESS THAN 12 hours after the devastating blaze at the Flourish Stay bed and breakfast (B&B) at Hauz Rani in Malviya Nagar, many hotels and guest houses in the area closed their shutters, removed all signage and asked their guests to leave.

In a narrow lane of Hauz Rani, multiple properties run guest houses, homestays and B&Bs right across the street from Max Hospital Saket, where medical tourists — patients and their attendants — come to stay, owing to the proximity to the hospital.

Several of these properties are crammed into dingy alleyways, the buildings less than 10 feet wide, with single entry and exit points.

Around 8 pm, barely a few hundred metres away from the B&B where the blaze killed 12 foreign nationals and 9 Indians, 46-year old interpreter from Democratic Republic of Congo, Ben alias Benedict, was seen lugging his suitcase out of Flourish Inn Guest House. With the reception on the first floor



(From left) Groww Moon Inn had downed its shutters and evacuated all its guests by early evening; guests leave Urban Suites and Micasa Homes locked from inside. EXPRESS

shuttered off, he was among the last to leave the guest house.

"Around 4 pm, the hotel manager told us 'you have to leave today or there will be trouble'. I am now headed to East of Kailash," he said.

"I had a patient (for whom he acted as a translator), Sita Beatrice, at the B&B that caught fire. She died in the fire. Another of my patients was also there. He was able to escape, and he had a flight back to

Congo today via Mumbai. I think he missed the Mumbai flight," he claimed.

"The owner (of Flourish Inn Guest House) is not around," Ben added.

A police personnel from the Hauz Khas police station, deputised at the spot, said that while the police have not ordered the shutting down of the hotels, all such properties will be checked for necessary permits.



Until this morning, Urban Suite Oasis Rooms had a 'Rooms Available' board hanging on the door. By evening, the hotel had emptied out its guests, removed all signage, and locked its doors.

Dilshad, a local resident, said, "They were open but then the police started making rounds... The staff is still inside... You won't get any room today at Hauz Rani, you have to look elsewhere. They all have

thrown out their guests."

Around 8.30 pm, Alauddin Ali (54), a driver, was waiting outside Micasa Homes — different from Micasa Inn located next to the B&B that caught fire — waiting for an Iraqi couple he had dropped off earlier in the day. "They have been told to leave the hotel. They are now going to a guest house at Chhat-tarpur," he said.

Micasa Homes, barely 200 m from the site of the blaze, had locked its door from inside and turned off the lights at the reception. Local residents claimed that Micasa Homes and Micasa Inn were both run by the same owner.

A few metres away, another B&B, Star Light Suites, had two of its staffers stationed outside. Pat came the reply for an inquiry for a room for a night — "There is no room, everyone is leaving... we are closing."

Meanwhile, at Max Hospital, Ankita Agarwal (34) from Gorakhpur is at his wits end. His brother is being treated at Max Hospital Saket for a hip issue.

"Hotels near the hospital are not taking bookings anymore, so we don't know what to do," he said.

Morning Nightmare

THURSDAY, JUNE 4, 2026

5



SCREAM FOR HELP: A foreign national at the window of the burning hotel calls out for help to people below. AP



RESCUE AFTER JUMP: Another foreign national is carried to safety by local good samaritans after she managed to escape the building. AP

Five foreign nationals escaped blaze by minutes

Pragnesh & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, June 3

FOUR OF them had stepped out for routine errands. One had returned for a quick shower. All five narrowly escaped after a fire tore through a bed and breakfast in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar on Wednesday morning, killing 21 people.

Among them was Bah Trimdijou. The Guinea national had come to Delhi two months ago with his father, Bahsoun, who is undergoing treatment for cancer at Max Hospital in Saket.

He was to return to Flourish Stays B&B on Monday with his father, but doctors advised them to stay back at the hospi-

tal. On Wednesday, he decided to pop by the hotel for a quick shower — only to find that a fire had broken out.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Bah said he was staying in Room No. 402 on the fourth floor. Every day, he would return to the hotel in the morning, take a bath, and then go back to the hospital. "This morning, I came back to take a bath and found it burnt," Bah said.

He said many of his friends were inside at the time, including a woman and a child, and he has no idea whether they are alive. "My friend, Mansadave from Nigeria, was on the ground floor. I don't know where he is now. Is he alive?" he asked.

At least four other guests had left the hotel shortly before



(From left) Bah Trimdijou, Kammy, Miraz Hassan



the fire swept through the building around 8.40.

Michael, a US citizen of African origin, said he and his wife were headed to Max Hospital for her treatment when they learned about the blaze.

"Around 8.40 am, I learnt that a

fire had broken out at our hotel. We rushed back and saw it engulfed in flames. Three of my friends who had come with me were inside." He claimed the hotel had only one entry and exit, which may have hampered rescue operations.



Brothers Miraz Hassan, 36, and Minhazul, 26, said they are lucky to be alive.

Miraz, a marine engineer from Dhaka, Bangladesh, had been in Delhi for a week now with Minhazul and their mother Salina, 63. They had checked

into Flourish Stays on May 27 for their mother's surgery.

"My mother had knee surgery before, but one more surgery was needed. It was scheduled at Max hospital. Yesterday, we admitted her to the facility," said Miraz, who is visiting India for the first time.

On Wednesday, about 8.30 am, the brothers locked their room — 403 on the fourth floor — and went to the hospital.

Thirty five minutes later, they got a call from the international patient desk. "They were asking if we were safe. They said a fire broke out at the hotel," recalled Miraz.

By evening, he realised that most of their luggage — including passports, clothes, and \$300 — was locked in the room.

He was later contacted by a police officer, who took him and his brother to Malviya Nagar police station.

Standing there with a sling bag over his shirt, he said, "We escaped by minutes. We had checked several hotels and found this one to be the best."

"We cannot take another hotel in this area; most are shut. We will find somewhere else... Someone from the Bangladesh embassy met us. We are still lucky to be alive," said Minhazul.

Another guest, Kammy, originally from Mauritius and now based in the United Kingdom, had been in India for nearly a year for treatment related to retinal detachment.

On Wednesday, she left Mi-

casa Inn around 7.30 am to visit a nearby temple. The day also happened to be her birthday.

When she returned, she was confronted with a devastating scene: Micasa Inn and Flourish Stays were engulfed in flames and people were searching desperately for relatives, friends, and fellow guests.

Standing outside the hotel, with just a small bag containing a prayer mala, a coconut, and a handkerchief, she said all her belongings were in the room — her money, phone, and passport. The only contact information she had was her driver's phone number on a piece of paper. She spent hours trying to find someone who could help her get in touch with him. "The mandir saved me," she said.

'Didn't wait for protective gear': 10 cops injured during rescue op

'Had they waited for equipment, many more may have died'

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 3

AROUND 10 policemen have been admitted to the AIIMS Trauma Centre after they sustained injuries during the rescue operation carried out on Wednesday following the fatal blaze at a bed and breakfast (B&B) facility South Delhi's Malviya Nagar, Delhi Fire Services officials said.

The injured officers have been identified as Head Constable Kartar (32), Constable Deepak (38), Constable Vikram (34), Head Constable Dinesh (35), and Constable Rampal (30) of Malviya Nagar police station; and Constable Sandeep (30), Head Constable Hargyan (40), Head Constable Premchand (40), Head Constable Jitendra (40) of Neb Sarai police station; along with Constable Raviranj (26). These officers and local



An ambulance arrives as people throng the area. GAJENDRA YADAV

residents were among the first responders.

According to a statement by the Delhi Fire Services, the officers were initially in the 'Red Zone' of the AIIMS Trauma Centre, but are now stable and under observation.

Rakesh Kumar, a local resident who was also involved in the rescue operations undertaken after Wednesday's blaze, said that officers from Malviya Nagar police station were the first to reach the spot.

"They did not care about

safety equipment or protective gear as such. Had they waited, many more would have died. They almost burnt themselves while trying to find a way to the first floor," said Rakesh.

Officials, meanwhile, said that the policemen, with the help of locals, broke the locks at the entries to the basement and the roof to make way for the people stuck in the building. They also arranged mattresses onto which people jumped in a desperate bid to escape, officials added.

'In touch with embassies': MEA after 12 foreign nationals killed

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, June 3

CONDOLING THE deaths of 21 people, including 12 foreign nationals, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Wednesday said the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) is in touch with foreign embassies.

In a post on X, he said that the Ministry is also extending all necessary assistance to the victims. "Express my deepest condolences at the loss of lives, including of foreign nationals, in the tragic fire incident in Malviya Nagar, New Delhi. Pray for the speedy recovery of the injured," Jaishankar posted.

"MEA is in touch with Embassies and is extending all necessary assistance," he said.

The Bangladesh High Commission also offered condolences to the bereaved families affected by the tragedy, and said so far five Bangladeshi nationals could be traced as injured. In a post on X, it said three Bangladeshi nationals are being treated at Max Hospital, Saket, while two are recuperating at Safdarjung Hospital.



(From top) Forensic officials inspect the spot; guests leave after the incident on Wednesday. GAJENDRA YADAV/VIVEK PRAKASH KRISHNA

PAST INCIDENTS OF FIRE IN CAPITAL



In 1997, Uphaar fire tragedy claimed 59 lives. FILE

1997: A fire at Uphaar Cinema in Green Park, triggered by transformer malfunction, killed 59 and injured more than 100. Investigations found serious safety lapses, including blocked exits.

2011: 14 people died in a tent fire during a religious congregation in Nand Nagri.

2018: 17 people were killed in a blaze at an illegal firecracker and packaging unit in Bawana.

2019: 17 guests lost their lives in a fire at a hotel in Karol Bagh. Investigators found violations linked to an illegally constructed kitchen.

2019: A fire at an illegal manufacturing unit in Anaj Mandi killed 43 workers who were asleep inside the building. The structure lacked proper fire clearances and emergency exits, while narrow lanes delayed rescue operations.

2022: A fire at a four-storey electronic items manufacturing unit in Mundka claimed 27 lives. Officials pointed to fire safety lapses.

2024: A massive blaze at a baby care hospital in Vivek Vihar killed

seven newborns after oxygen cylinders exploded.

2024: 11 workers were killed in a blaze which broke out at a paint factory in Alipuri.

2025: Three people, including two children, died after a fire broke out at a duplex flat on the 10th floor of a residential society in Dwarka Sector 13. The victims died after jumping from the balcony while trying to escape.

March 2026: Nine members of a family, including three children, were killed in a fire at a four-storey building in Palam. Inflammable material in the basement, a single staircase, traffic congestion were among the key operational challenges faced by firefighters.

May 2026: A fire at a residential complex in Vivek Vihar killed nine members of three families, including an infant. Findings suggested a short circuit in an air-conditioner led to the fire. Probe underlined lack of multiple exits, locked terrace door, and iron grills on the rear side.

FIRST RESPONDERS SAY EFFORTS HAMPERED BY LOCKED DOORS AND WINDOWS

'We spread mattresses so they could jump': Local residents raced to save lives

Pragnesh, Alok Singh, Devansh Mittal & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, June 3

AS FLAMES tore through Flourish Stay B&B in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar on Wednesday, chaos erupted as guests began jumping from upper floors to escape the inferno. Outside, local residents rushed to help, breaking locked windows and laying out mattresses on the road.

Mansoor, a local resident who runs a construction business in the area, said the fire appeared to have started on the first floor. "People started jumping from the first floor. Then they began jumping from the second, third and fourth floors. We brought mattresses and placed them below so they could land on them," he said.

Mansoor added that he

threw a rope from his house toward the building in an attempt to help those trapped inside. "A woman tried to catch it, but she couldn't hold on and fell to the ground," he said.

Ishrar Khan, 40, described the horrifying scene. "I was helping some of the victims and their skin just peeled off. It was horrifying. They all were screaming."

Rescue efforts were also hampered by locked doors and windows, he claimed. "The windows wouldn't slide open, so we used hammers to break them and rescued seven people from the basement..." he added. Ishrar said he then got into the building and helped move guests to the roof, from where they jumped onto mattresses.

Wasim Raza, a resident of Hauz Rani in Malviya Nagar, said several people were trapped in the basement and



First responders Mohammad Afzal, Waseem Raja, Mohammad Shoaib, Amir Khan; (right) during the rescue operation on Wednesday. EXPRESS/AP

he, along with Delhi Police personnel, helped cut through an iron window grill to reach them. "There were two rooms in the basement," he said.

Inside the building, he said the scenes were harrowing. "We pulled out the charred body of a young woman. There was also a person in a wheel-

chair," Raza said.

"In a ground-floor bathroom, I found a foreign couple lying motionless, the woman's head resting on her husband's shoulder. I gave CPR to around 10 people during the rescue. Anyone I saw lying on the floor, I tried to help. The scenes were heartbreaking," he added.



Raza said he found several Nigerian nationals unconscious inside bathrooms on the first and second floors and helped bring them out of the building.

A security staff member at Max Hospital, Raza sustained

injuries during the rescue operation. He said his feet were cut after he stepped on shattered glass.

Armaan, 27, owner of Munsoorel Cottons, provided mattresses and bedsheets for the

rescue effort. "I gave 20 mattresses and 24 bedsheets. Locals wrapped the victims in double-layer bedsheets and got them out," he said.

Two other residents, Advocate Mohammad Afzal, 35, a

lawyer at Saket court, and Amir Khan, 31, who runs a water supply shop, said they reached the spot around 9 am.

"The fire had spread by then... we started spreading mattresses so that people could jump," they said. At the same time, they called Max Hospital for ambulances and medical assistance.

The men eventually managed to get inside the building and said no one survived on the ground floor. "The moment we entered the building, we came across two bodies," said Afzal.

"Everything was charred on the first floor too. The second and third floors escaped damage but people had died of smoke... There was a lot of smoke... and glass everywhere," they said.

The men carried the victims on their shoulders and administered CPR to 10 people.



Finding Founder

NOW THAT a full-fledged Cabinet is in place, one of the top priorities of the Suwendu Adhikari-led government in West Bengal seems to be delivering on BJP's ideological commitment. The Adhikari government is all set to renovate the Asutosh Mookerjee Memorial Institute, built in memory of Syama Prasad Mookerjee's father in Bhowanipore (the CM's constituency). There is also a plan to lay the foundation stone for a 125-foot statue of Syama Prasad Mookerjee at a key spot in Kolkata on July 6, his birth anniversary. In order to pay rich tributes to the Bharatiya Jana Sangh founder, the Bengal government is expected to launch various schemes named after him, sources said.

Share & Care

DAYS AFTER Prime Minister Narendra Modi gave a call for reducing fuel consumption, three Union ministers chose to carpool to Wednesday's Cabinet meeting at Seva Teerth. Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil, who resides at 2 Safdarjung Lane, drove to Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan's residence at 12 Safdarjung Road, where Coal and Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy was already waiting. The three ministers then travelled together to the meeting venue. It is learnt that during the previous Cabinet meeting, the PM had asked ministers how many of them had carpoled to attend the meeting.

SC Collegium picks 7 advocates for HCs

New Delhi: The Supreme Court Collegium has recommended the appointment of seven advocates as judges of the high courts of Karnataka and MP.

The collegium on June 2 recommended appointment of six advocates as judges of Karnataka HC. It also approved the appointment of one advocate as a judge of the MP HC. Separately, it recommended two additional judges as permanent judges of Punjab & Haryana HC. PTI

'All are welcome': CJP sticks to plan for June 6 sit-in at Jantar Mantar

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 3

IMMEDIATELY AFTER landing in Delhi on June 6, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke will proceed to seek permission for a sit-in against Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan at Jantar Mantar, the group announced on Wednesday.

Addressing a press conference at the Constitution Club hours after being announced as its chief spokesperson, journalist and social media activist Saurav Das said people "of all political shades" were welcome to join the protest.

The announcement comes a day after activist Sonam Wangchuk pledged support to Dipke's proposed sit-in. "Abhijeet Dipke ji will land at the Delhi airport at 8am on June 6; he has called upon his supporters to come to the airport... Along with all those who will be there, including Wangchuk ji, we will go to the Parliament Street police station and seek permission for a protest at Jantar Mantar," Dass said. "Jantar Mantar is a designated protest site... We invite everybody from all political shades to come and be part of this movement."

'Can't accept Abhishek anymore': Inside TMC, the revolt after defeat

Atri Mitra
& Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, June 3

A MONTH since getting voted out of power in West Bengal, the TMC is staring at a split, a rapid disintegration for a party that won 41% of the votes in the elections. The rumblings had started on May 4 itself as it became clear that the party was set to lose, with some party leaders appearing to criticise the leadership.

But it was still not a full-throated revolt yet. The first signs of dissent came two days later at a meeting at party chief Mamata Banerjee's residence, when the former CM asked all the MLAs present to stand up and give a standing ovation to her nephew and second-in-command Abhishek Banerjee. "Mamata Banerjee was not ready to accept defeat. When she asked us to stand up, many senior MLAs did not do so, but they also said nothing," said one MLA. There was also unease over the leadership's decision not to act against its Falta strongman Jahangir Khan, seen as close to Abhishek, after he withdrew his name from the repoll in his constituency without consulting the party.

"Not only that, the leadership, especially Abhishek Banerjee, was so arrogant. Even after such a humiliating defeat, when asked about what the party was doing about Jahangir Khan, he just said, 'See the party's tweet.' Mamata Banerjee also announced she would not resign as CM. After that, the seeds of the rebellion were laid," said a senior TMC MLA. TMC sources said that is when the rebel MLAs started coordinating and laying the groundwork for the revolt. At the centre of the plot was Uluberia Purba MLA and former Rajya Sabha MP Ritabrata Banerjee, who has been recognised by the



TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee and party's national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee. EXPRESS FILE

Speaker as the LoP.

The plan gathered momentum last week after Ritabrata visited Delhi, where he met Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, a source said. "After Ritabrata returned from Delhi, the plan gathered pace. Ritabrata convened one meeting after another at the MLAs' hostel and in a private hotel of Kolkata. All the MLAs started receiving calls to unite against leadership that had largely been mum and not proactive. However, our main target was Abhishek Banerjee. We are not against Mamata Banerjee, but we can't accept Abhishek's leadership anymore," said a rebel MLA.

Things came to a head during the signature forgery controversy. While the TMC leadership submitted a letter to the Speaker's office designating Sobhabdeb Chattopadhyay as LoP, Nayona Bandyopadhyay and Ashima Patra as Deputy LoPs, and Firhad Hakim as Chief Whip, on June 1, Adhikari added fuel to the fire, saying Ritabrata and fellow TMC MLA from Enataly, Sandipan Saha, had complained that their signatures had

been forged while MLAs Arup Roy and Baharul Islam had admitted to the CID, which was probing the matter, that they too had not signed the letter.

"We are against Abhishek Banerjee and have no problem with Mamata Banerjee's leadership," another rebel MLA said. "I did not attend any meeting. But I talked to the CM once and had a meeting with Ritabrata Banerjee once." Another MLA, who belongs to the minority community, said, "Mamata Banerjee is not ready to understand that we are not against the party. We can't go with the BJP and in the fight against BJP, we need Mamata Banerjee."

Targeting Abhishek and political consultancy firm I-PAC, which the TMC second-in-command had brought to the state to handle the party's election strategy, a senior MLA said, "We were humiliated by what Abhishek Banerjee did in the signature controversy. Senior MLAs are not ready to accept that. We have no problem with Mamata Banerjee, but we will not allow Abhishek or any agency to interfere in the functioning of the party."

The TMC's MLA from Kulpi

in South 24 Parganas, Barnali Dhara, told *The Indian Express*, "We have no other option other than going with this group. I am not a political person as such and became MLA to work for people. I thought I could do that if I went with this group. Our workers are facing violence and we are not receiving help from the administration. On Wednesday, the CM sat with us after the administrative meeting and assured us that he would talk to the administration. I think I will get help from the administration as well if I remain with this bloc."

The TMC on Monday promptly expelled Ritabrata and Saha on grounds of "anti-party activities" and sent a letter to the Speaker communicating its decision. Meanwhile, Mamata Banerjee too alleged publicly that a conspiracy had been hatched in Delhi to break her party. In a Facebook Live, the TMC chairperson said, "Someone who earlier was with the CPM (Ritabrata Bandyopadhyay) is doing it all. We gave him a ticket by depriving others. My apologies to those who were deprived; 2,500 of our party offices vandalised, thousands of

ED summons Abhishek

Kolkata: The ED on Wednesday summoned TMC national general secretary and MP Abhishek Banerjee, asking him to appear before it on June 15 in connection with the primary school recruitment irregularities case.

On Wednesday evening, a team of ED officers reached Banerjee's Kalighat house to summon the Diamond Harbour MP. Abhishek was not at his house at the time. Sources said Abhishek was attending a meeting at TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee's residence, where senior leaders Chandrima Bhattacharya and others were present.

As he was unavailable, the officers handed the summons to a representative of Abhishek. According to ED sources, the agency wants to question Abhishek as it found "more evidence" in the case. ENS

workers have been arrested. The police are threatening our MLAs, asking them not to step out of their homes. The police are asking MLAs to support a person whom we have expelled (Ritabrata Banerjee), and break our party."

Now, with the party hamstrung in Bengal, the speculation in the TMC is that a split in the parliamentary party may occur within a week. "BJP leaders will not sit idle after breaking our legislature party. Abhishek Banerjee will be cornered even in Parliament as well. We are expecting two-thirds of our MPs will revolt very soon. That will be the last nail on the TMC's coffin. Like Eknath Shinde and Ajit Pawar, rebel TMCs will get the rights to the symbol and the party name," said a senior TMC MP.



West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari during the launch of Annapurna Yojana for women, at Nabanna on Wednesday. EXPRESS

As crisis in TMC deepens, BJP eyes 'larger prize' beyond Bengal

Liz Mathew

New Delhi, June 3

IN THE West Bengal Assembly, where the BJP enjoys a two-thirds majority and enjoys absolute dominance, the party is keenly watching signs of division unfolding in the 80-member TMC. The reason, BJP leaders say, is the "larger political prize" in Parliament, where the NDA lacks the numbers required for the smooth passage of key Constitutional amendments.

"In West Bengal, the BJP does not need support. Our priority is to get MPs. Once the TMC gets fragmented, its MPs could form a separate group and the BJP can benefit from their support for the numbers required for our ambitious legislation," a senior BJP leader said.

Signalling possible trouble for Banerjee, Ritabrata Banerjee — a former CPI(M) leader who joined the TMC in 2018 but was "expelled" earlier this week for "anti-party activities" — was recognised as the Leader of Opposition on Wednesday. Even as Mamata had backed veteran TMC leader Sovande Chattopadhyay for the post, Ritabrata staked claim to it claiming the support of 58 of the party's 80 MLAs. He later said there were at least 60 MLAs in the dissident camp. "The ongoing tussle within the TMC, in the name of democracy and over democratic functioning, is expected to culminate in a vertical split. The BJP stands to gain because a separate Opposition bloc could support the NDA government in Parliament," a BJP MP said.

Within BJP circles, the developments in Bengal are being compared to splits in the Shiv Sena and the NCP, which helped the party form the government in Maharashtra in 2022 and the recent split in the AAP, which saw seven of its 10 Rajya Sabha MPs led by Raghav Chadha move to the BJP, taking the NDA's strength in the 245-member Upper House to 141. "Like what happened in the Shiv Sena, NCP, and AAP, one group will be with the BJP in Parliament. That would erase the blemish we have carried since the 2024 Lok Sabha polls," a BJP leader said, referring to the party's failure to secure a majority on its own despite expectations of a stronger mandate.

The NDA government recently suffered a setback when the Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty First Amendment)

Bill, or the Delimitation Bill, which seeks to redraw electoral boundaries and increase the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha from 545 to 850 seats, fell short of the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha in April. *The Indian Express* reported on June 1 that the government was considering reviving the legislation and also bringing forward the One Nation One Election Bill before the 2029 Lok Sabha polls. With the TMC and the DMK suffering setbacks in the recent Assembly polls, the BJP leadership has also initiated outreach to the DMK, which, according to sources, has indicated a willingness to consider issue-based support to the Centre.

Sources said the DMK, shaken by its defeat and by ally Congress's decision to join the C Joseph Vijay-led TVK government, could negotiate support for the BJP on specific legislative measures. Sources said the Home Ministry was preparing a revised draft of the Delimitation Bill, with key concerns raised by regional parties such as the DMK expected to be addressed. When the Bill came up in the Lok Sabha in April, the INDIA bloc voted as a united front, with 230 MPs, including those from the Congress, DMK and TMC, opposing it. The NDA's tally stood at 298. In the Lok Sabha, DMK has 22 MPs while TMC has 28. Opposition parties had objected to linking the expansion of the Lok Sabha with the implementation of Women's Reservation Act, and raised concerns that delimitation could reduce political weight of southern states.

"If the DMK agrees to support the Bill — whether on simultaneous polls or any other Constitutional amendment — the NDA will need only 42 more votes for a two-thirds majority in the full House of 543. A separate TMC bloc, whether comprising 15, 20 or 25 MPs, will take the BJP significantly closer to that threshold," said a senior MP involved in the party's floor management.

A split in the TMC could also ease the BJP's efforts to secure passage of the One Nation One Election Bill, which seeks to synchronise Lok Sabha and Assembly elections. The legislation is currently under examination by a 39-member Joint Parliamentary Committee chaired by BJP leader P P Chaudhary. Sources said the government wants the Bill passed at the earliest so that its phased implementation can begin before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

Ritabrata, the face of the rebellion against Mamata

Atri Mitra
& Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, June 3

IN FRESH trouble for former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and the TMC, "expelled" party MLA Ritabrata Banerjee on Wednesday reached the Assembly with a letter of support from 58 of the party's 80 MLAs, for the post of Leader of Opposition (LoP).

The rebel MLAs have submitted a letter — on a white pad, not on the party's letter pad — naming Mamata as the party leader, Ritabrata as the LoP, and Seuli Saha, Javed Khan and Sabina Yeasmin as deputy leaders in the House. Ritabrata, one of the two TMC MLAs "expelled" for "anti-party activities" on Monday, was once one of the CPI(M)'s young guns seen as a future leader of the Left party. But his quick rise stalled because of his expulsion from the Left party after a scandal and an explosive interview. He joined the TMC in 2018 and went on to claim that Mamata is the real Left leader.

The Mamata-led camp in the TMC removed Ritabrata shortly after CM Suwendu Adhikari named him and Sandipan Saha while saying two TMC MLAs

had complained to the Assembly Speaker that their signatures were forged in the party's communication endorsing Sobhabdeb Chattopadhyay as the LoP.

Quick rise and fall

An alumnus of Kolkata's South Point High School and Asutosh College, Ritabrata came to the limelight as a student leader in the early 2000s. He was named the All India general secretary of CPI(M)'s student wing SFI and led the organisation for eight years. Known to be close to Left veteran and CPI(M)'s former general secretary, the late Sitaram Yechury, Ritabrata's rise in the CPI(M), then known to shy away from projecting young faces, was quick. At 34 years old, the CPI(M) chose him for a Rajya Sabha seat. Three years after his entry, this rapid climb up the ladder of power would meet a setback. In 2017, the CPI(M) suspended and later expelled him.

A lifestyle alleged to be inconsistent with the party's ideals — Ritabrata was spotted with an Apple smartwatch — and "anti-party activities" were cited as reasons. At the time, the expulsion was also seen as a fallout between the tussle between the Prakash Karat and Sitaram Ye-



Expelled TMC MLA Ritabrata Banerjee addresses the media on Wednesday. PARTHA PAUL

chury camps within the CPI(M). Days before the expulsion, Ritabrata made explosive remarks in an interview, saying his fight was against top party leaders Prakash and Brinda Karat and former MP and CPI(M)'s current state secretary Mohammed Salim. Later that year, a research scholar accused him of rape, alleging that he had exploited her on the false promise of marriage. He accused the woman of blackmail and extortion. Visuals from a personal video call went viral, and the once young, dynamic

leader was now a castaway.

The switch

Following his expulsion by the CPI(M), Ritabrata joined the TMC and went on to head the party's trade union arm. In 2021, he told *The Telegraph* in an interview that his then-boss, Mamata, was the real Leftist leader. In 2024, the TMC nominated him for a Rajya Sabha seat after the resignation of former MP Jawhar Sircar. In the recent polls, Ritabrata successfully contested as a TMC candidate from the Uluberia Purba Assembly seat despite the BJP's sweep of Bengal, in which many seasoned Trinamool leaders were trounced.

Shortly after the win, however, he became a talking point, not to the amusement of the TMC leadership. A video of him crossing paths and exchanging pleasantries with CM Adhikari at Delhi's Banga Bhaban went viral. He later told the media that it was "courtesy" and asked if he should have ignored the CM's greetings. He said he did not believe in "that kind of politics".

The crackdown

On Monday, CM Adhikari said Banerjee and Saha had informed Assembly Speaker Ra-

thindra Bose that they had not signed the TMC's communication naming Chattopadhyay as the LoP. Soon after, the Trinamool issued statements, expelling Ritabrata and Saha.

"It has been brought to the notice of the All India Trinamool Congress through its competent authority that, despite having been elected as a candidate nominated by the AITC, you have repeatedly failed to attend meetings convened by the authorised leadership of the party and have made yourself involved in anti-party activities," a communication addressed to the MLAs said.

Without naming Ritabrata, Mamata told the media, "Someone who was earlier with CPI(M) is doing it all. We gave him a ticket, depriving others. My apologies to those who were deprived." On Tuesday, Mamata again alleged that there was a conspiracy hatched from Delhi to break the party.

For Ritabrata, this marks a new chapter in his journey with the TMC. For a leader who jumped from the Left to the TMC, and served as a member of the Rajya Sabha and the Assembly within a decade, the possibilities are many.

Committed to BJP, oppose Dhillon as Punjab party chief: Capt Amarinder

Manraj Grewal Sharma
Chandigarh, June 3

FORMER PUNJAB Chief Minister Capt Amarinder Singh on Wednesday said he had no plans to leave the BJP, despite his continuing opposition to the appointment of Kewal Singh Dhillon as the party's Punjab president.

Speaking on the day Dhillon — whom he called a "good friend" — formally took charge, Amarinder said his reservations were based not on personal differences, but on the "requirements" of political leadership in Punjab. Notably, both Amarinder's daughter, Jai Inder Kaur, and his wife, Preeten Kaur, have pledged their support to Dhillon.

"I am not leaving the BJP. Every day somebody says I am off to the Congress or that I have met somebody. It is all nonsense.

I have not met anyone. I have not talked to anyone," Amarinder said. "I have known (Dhillon) for years and he is a friend. But when you are in politics, you have to assess whether a person can carry Punjab, formulate policies, sell those policies to the people and provide leadership."

The former CM remained unconvinced that Dhillon possessed the political drive required to expand the BJP's footprint in the state. "I may be wrong, I may be right. Time will tell. But my feeling is that he does not have the push in him that is needed in this game," he said. Amarinder also questioned the argument that the BJP required a Sikh or Jat Sikh face to lead the party in Punjab. "I do not believe in this business of looking for a Sikh or any other face. Religion and caste should not matter. We need capable

leadership," he said, adding that after six decades in politics, one does not wake up one morning and decide to switch parties. "I want to make a success of where I am, which is my own party."

He reiterated his long-held view that the BJP should consider rekindling the alliance with the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD). "If you want to stabilise your party for the future, that is one thing. But if you want a stable government now, there is no other way of forming a government except with the Akali Dal," he said, arguing that Punjab's present circumstances demanded immediate leadership rather than long-term political experimentation. "We are in a bad way economically. We are sitting on the border with Pakistan. Every day drones are coming in with drugs and other things. Punjab needs leadership



Former Punjab Chief Minister Captain Amarinder Singh at his residence in Siswan, near Chandigarh, on Wednesday. JASBIR MALHI

today, not tomorrow," he said.

Amarinder painted a picture of a fragmented political landscape, noting that the Congress had multiple contenders for leadership, the AAP was struggling to retain public confidence, and the Akali camp itself

stood splintered. He was particularly critical of the AAP government, saying he had never seen a state government being run by people from another state. "The sad part is for my state. If you have confusion and instability, Punjab will be the

loser. I want stability. I don't know how it's going to come, but for the sake of my state, I hope we get a stable government."

On Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh, the chief of the Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De) who remains detained under the NSA, Amarinder questioned the usefulness of his ongoing incarceration. "I don't know what the government has on him. But frankly speaking, I don't see the point of putting people in jail. What are you getting out of this by keeping someone in prison?" he asked.

Referring to claims of Amritpal's open support for Khalistan, Amarinder argued that the state should not respond to political sentiments through prolonged detention. "If you travel down the GT Road and see pictures of Bhindranwale on vehicles, are you going to

lock everyone up? That is not the way to deal with it," he said.

He sought to draw a distinction between fringe rhetoric and mainstream public sentiment, emphasising that the "mature Punjabi" wants peace, stability, development, and jobs rather than religious or separatist politics. He was equally critical of the growing culture of electoral freebies. "There should be an end to this now because states are getting ruined. We just do not have the money. All parties should sit together and decide not to do this," he said.

While acknowledging that he too had introduced welfare measures during his tenure, Amarinder concluded that Punjab's finances no longer allowed competitive populism, and that scarce resources should instead be directed towards development and governance.

Shivakumar takes oath as CM, Parameshwara is his deputy

Siddaramaiah son Yathindra among 13 in new Cabinet

Express News Service Bengaluru, June 3

D K SHIVAKUMAR, 64, was sworn in as the 24th Karnataka chief minister, along with 13 ministers, including Deputy CM G Parameshwara, at a ceremony attended by the Congress top brass, CMs of three states where the party is in rule and outgoing CM Siddaramaiah, here on Wednesday. Siddaramaiah's son Yathindra Siddaramaiah was among the 13 ministers who were administered oath by Governor Thawarchand Gehlot.

Shivakumar had been waiting in the wings to be the CM of Karnataka since the state Congress party won the state elections in 2023 under his leadership with a clear majority of 135 seats in the 224-member House.

He ascended to the position of the CLP leader on May 30 after the Congress central leadership asked Siddaramaiah on May 26 to step down on the back of the party completing three years in office on May 20. The move is seen as the fruition of a power-sharing pact that was informally sealed by the leadership after the 2023 poll victory.

Shivakumar took his oath in the name of his spiritual guru "Gangadhar Aija", while holding a copy of the Constitution.

The first batch of 13 Cabinet picks were essentially ministers from the Siddaramaiah cabinet with the two excep-



Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi greets Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar during the swearing-in ceremony in Bengaluru on Wednesday. PTI

tions being Yathindra, who is an MLC, and former Assembly speaker U T Khader.

The Cabinet picks indicate that the Congress party is attempting to retain its caste base and balance despite the change of guard from a popular OBC CM to a dominant Vokkaliga CM. Two other Vokkaligas — Ramalinga Reddy and Krishna Byregowda — are also part of the Shivakumar Cabinet.

There are three Dalits — G Parameshwara; Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's son Priyank Kharge and veteran K H Muniyappa.

There are three ministers also from the dominant Lingayat community — veteran M B Patil, Eshwar Khandre and Sharan Prakash Patil. Byrathi Suresh and fresher Yathindra Siddaramaiah are two from the OBC Kuruba community of ex-

CM Siddaramaiah. There is one

Christian, one Muslim and one ST minister in the form of K J George, U T Khader and Satish Jharkiholi, respectively.

There was no woman minister in the first batch of inductions. The swearing-in ceremony was restricted to around 3,000 guests following advice by the Congress leadership against putting up a massive show. Public viewing of the swearing in was, however, arranged at locations like bus stands and the Congress offices in Bengaluru.

The guest list for the swearing in at Lok Bhavan featured the elite of Bengaluru from different walks and was unlike the ceremonies in the past attended by cheering and whistling supporters. Karnataka HC chief justice Vibhu Bakru also attended the ceremony.

In the audience were film stars Shivaraj Kumar and Dha-

nanjay; former Congress leader and actress Ramya, Infosys founder Narayana Murthy and his wife Sudha Murthy; renowned heart doctor Devi Shetty, and former cricketers Anil Kumble and Venkatesh Prasad.

Earlier, before taking oath as the CM, Shivakumar said he was heralding a new era of youth leadership in Karnataka. He also thanked the Gandhi family for reposing faith in his leadership. "The Gandhi family had faith in me. They gave me various opportunities. From Rajiv Gandhi to now, I have been very loyal to the family," he said.

"I am very committed to the trust and confidence placed in me and I will work very hard to fulfil everyone's expectations. The path is not easy... I will do my job with great honesty and dedication," Shivakumar said.

Hariprasad is new Karnataka Congress chief

Express News Service Bengaluru, June 3

ENDING SUSPENSE on who will succeed Karnataka CM D K Shivakumar as president of the state unit of the Congress, the AICC on Wednesday appointed senior leader and MLC B K Hariprasad for the post.

Hariprasad, who is an OBC leader from the Billava community, has been associated with the Congress since the late 80s. He is a four-time Rajya Sabha MP, starting from 1990 and his last election to the Upper House was in 2014.



Senior leader and MLC B K Hariprasad

Subsequently, he was elected to the Karnataka Legislative Council in 2020. He was

picked for a second term in the Council from July 2026 by the Congress leadership earlier in the day. He is also a permanent invitee to the CWC.

A leader close to the Gandhi family, Hariprasad courted controversy last October when he dubbed RSS as 'Indian Taliban'. He, along with Karnataka minister Priyank Kharge, had consistently attacked RSS over the last few months calling for the organisation's registration and its source of income to be revealed to the public.

Hariprasad's choice for the post is also seen as a counter

for Shivakumar, due to his careful 'soft Hindutva' stance as evidenced during the swearing-in ceremony.

Shivakumar had kept an image of his family deity at the swearing-in stage, which he bowed to seconds before taking oath as CM.

Picking the OBC leader of Billava community, who form a deciding factor in several constituencies of coastal Karnataka, is also seen as a move to attract the caste group - voters of which have aligned largely with the BJP in recent decades.

GREAT NICOBAR ISLAND PROJECT

Ramesh reiterates need for detailed impact assessment

Nikhil Ghanekar New Delhi, June 3

CONGRESS MP Jairam Ramesh said on Wednesday that he was glad Minister of Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav admitted that the environmental clearance for the Great Nicobar Island (GNI) Project was not based on comprehensive environment impact assessment (EIA) studies of three seasons' primary data but on a single seasonal cycle integrated with historical datasets and reiterated his appeal to conduct detailed impact assessment surveys.

"Is it not prudent to conduct comprehensive EIA studies over three seasons to account for seasonal variations?" Ramesh asked. He also pointed out that faced with "incontrovertible evidence of its hugely adverse ecological impacts", the Union government is now emphasising the GNI project's "supposed strategic rationale".

The Rajya Sabha MP's assertions were made in his June 3

letter to Yadav, in response to the minister's May 27 letter. Ramesh said that "secondary data is just not a substitute for primary data collection and project-specific studies".

In a letter to Yadav on May 10, Ramesh had flagged "inadequate EIA studies" and had alleged that they fell short of legal requirements as they were based on baseline data collected during a single seasonal cycle.

Yadav, though, had rejected this charge and said in his May 27 response that "while primary field data were collected over a single seasonal cycle, the analysis was integrated with long-term historical datasets maintained by reputed institutions", which possessed decades of ecological research experience in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. Yadav had also stated that concerns raised on environmental impact assessment and biodiversity impacts have "already been examined in detail during the statutory appraisal and subsequent judicially mandated review process".

Panchayats from 5 southern states bag 18 of 42 national awards

Harikishan Sharma New Delhi, June 3

PANCHAYATS FROM the five southern states of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Telangana and Tamil Nadu bagged 18 of 42 National Panchayat Awards 2025, while those from the Hindi heartland states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar could manage to win just one each.

The awards, conferred by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj annually, recognise outstanding local rural bodies across the country for their contribution towards the Localisation of Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and excellence in grassroots governance. The performance of the local bodies is assessed through the Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI), which evaluates panchayats across governance, infrastructure, livelihoods, social justice, environment, and women empowerment indicators.

This year, 42 panchayats from 17 states and union territories were selected for the

two categories of awards — Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (DDUPSPV) and Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (NDSPSPV).

The awards were presented by Union Panchayati Raj Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh 'Lalan' and his deputy SPSingh Baghel. Out of the 42 panchayats, the maximum 6 were from Karnataka, followed by Andhra Pradesh (5), Kerala (4), Telangana (2) and Tamil Nadu (1). Odisha also stood among the best performers, with 5 panchayats from the state winning the awards.

Panchayats from the North-eastern states also performed well with three each from Assam and Tripura winning the awards. One each from Sikkim and Mizoram also won the awards. However, the performance of panchayats from the Hindi heartland states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar remained poor, with only one panchayat each from both the states winning the award.

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अब चूकें नहीं! कुछ ही दिन शेष

अलीगढ़ की सबसे बड़ी मल्टी लेवल कार पार्किंग एंड कमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स में दुकान लेने का सुनहरा अवसर

आवेदन पत्र प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि 05.06.2026

आवेदन पत्र प्राप्ति एवं जमा करने का स्थान: कार्यालय अलीगढ़ स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड, सातवां तल, कल्याण सिंह हैबिटेड सेंटर, अलीगढ़

आवेदन जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि: 10.06.2026 (अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक)

सार्वजनिक नीलामी सूचना

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श्रेणी	क्षेत्रफल (sqm)	मासिक किराया (जीएएसटी0 अतिरिक्त) (₹)	प्रीमियम (₹)
A	19.13	GF: 13,814 FF: 12,872	GF: 25.27L FF: 23.29L
B	18.57	GF: 13,413 FF: 12,499	GF: 24.53L FF: 22.62L
C	17.95	GF: 12,965 FF: 12,081	GF: 23.72L FF: 21.86L
D	20.61	GF: 14,882	GF: 27.22L
E	27.83	GF: 20,097	GF: 36.76L
F	18	GF: 13,003 FF: 12,110	GF: 23.78L FF: 21.91L
G	19.08	GF: 13,782 FF: 12,843	GF: 25.21L FF: 23.24L
H	19.74	GF: 14,253 FF: 13,281	GF: 26.07L FF: 24.03L
I	18.16	GF: 13,115 FF: 12,221	GF: 23.99L FF: 22.11L

शुद्धि पत्र (CORRIGENDUM) **New** **संशोधित नियम लागू**

(1) एक फर्म से आवेदक केवल एक दुकान के लिए ही आवेदन कर सकता है।
(2) आवंटित/किरायेदार द्वारा अनुबंध अवधि के प्रथम 05 वर्षों के भीतर किसी भी कारण से अनुबंध समाप्त किये जाने की स्थिति में जमा प्रीमियम धनराशि जब्त की जायेगी। 05 वर्ष पूर्ण होने के उपरांत यदि आवंटित/किरायेदार स्वेच्छ से दुकान/अनुबंध समाप्त करता है, तो जमा प्रीमियम धनराशि बिना किसी ब्याज के वापस की जायेगी।
(3) बारहद्वारी कॉम्प्लेक्स में आवंटित हुई दुकानों के लिए मल्टीलेवल कार पार्किंग की सुविधा हेतु O&M/ रखरखाव करने वाली फर्म द्वारा तय किये गये शुल्क देय मान्य होंगे।
(4) दुकानें आवंटित होने के बाद अनुबंध के पश्चात हैण्डओवर प्रक्रिया पूर्ण होते ही किराया देय होगा।
(5) 20 साल बाद आवंटित/किरायेदार द्वारा अनुबंध को आगे बढ़ाना चाहे तो अलीगढ़ स्मार्ट सिटी लि. द्वारा तदसमय लागू शासकीय नीतियों के अनुसार ही कार्यवाही अमल में लायी जाएगी।
(6) पहली नीलामी पूर्ण होने के बाद दूसरी नीलामी के दौरान अगर आवेदन करने वाले आवेदकों को किसी तरह का लाभ दिया गया तो ऐसी स्थिति में पहले हकदार हुए किरायेदारों को भी उसका लाभ दिया जाएगा।
(7) यदि किसी कारणवश वास्तविक आवेदक नीलामी में भाग लेने के लिए उपलब्ध नहीं हो पाता है तो आवेदक को अन्य व्यक्ति को बोली में हिस्सा लेने के लिए Authorization Letter / प्राधिकार-पत्र द्वारा Authorise अधिकृत किया जा सकेगा।
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Patna’s ‘Khan Sir’ coaching institute vandalised, pelted with stones; three arrested

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, June 3

THE DIRECTOR of a Patna-based coaching institute is among three people arrested in connection with an attack at Khan Global Studies Coaching Institute in the city’s Musal-lahpur area, police said on Wednesday. The coaching centre that was vandalised is run by educator and YouTuber Faizal Khan, popularly known as ‘Khan Sir’.

“The FIR names Raushan Anand, director of Gyan Bindu Coaching Institute, along with Prince, Abhishek and Gaurav, and also includes 15 to 20 unidentified persons,” Rajesh Ranjan, City Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP)-1, said. The named accused have been arrested and are being produced before the court for judicial custody proceedings.

On the motive behind the incident, he said “no specific allegation” had been made by the complainant. However, preliminary information suggests tensions may have arisen between the two coaching institutes following recent claims about candidates’ success in the Bihar police constable recruitment examination.

Ranjan said Khan Coaching had reportedly claimed that a large number of successful candidates had been trained at the institute and had recently organ-



Police personnel try to pacify students protesting outside the coaching institute of ‘Khan Sir’ in Patna on Wednesday. ANI

ised a celebratory feast for successful aspirants. “It is being suggested that there may have been some resentment or jealousy between the two coaching institutes over these developments. Further investigation is underway, and action will be taken based on the facts that emerge,” Ranjan said.

Khan had also linked the incident to the recent Bihar Police recruitment examination results, claiming that thousands of students from his institute had been selected. He said a felicitation programme had been organised for the successful candidates and alleged that, afterwards, some individuals came to the institute and threatened that it would be “blown up” within two days.

The incident took place around 10.10 pm on June 2 under the jurisdiction of Kadamkuan police station. Initial information indicated stone-pelt-

ing, vandalism and firing had taken place at coaching centre.

CCTV footage from the institute and nearby locations, as well as conversations with local residents, however, did not provide evidence of any firing.

Police said the footage showed 15 to 20 individuals allegedly associated with Gyan Bindu Coaching Institute involved in the attack.

Ranjan said the group allegedly damaged a hoarding installed by Khan Coaching Centre at a street corner near the institute and hurled bricks and stones towards the premises.

Police said the footage shows the coaching centre’s guard being physically assaulted and struck with a brick. “A guard employed at the centre was assaulted. He sustained a head injury and was sent to PMCH for treatment...” Ranjan said. FIR sections pertain to attempted murder, rioting, mischief, wrongful restraint, voluntarily causing hurt, acts endangering life or personal safety, intentional insult to provoke breach of peace, criminal intimidation and criminal conspiracy.

OFFSITE REVIEW MEETING

NC decides to hold protest in Delhi for J&K statehood

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, June 3

AFTER A day-long meeting of the National Conference legislative party at the Dachigam National National Park in Srinagar, the party has decided to hold a protest demonstration in the national capital on the first day of the monsoon session, seeking the restoration of statehood and J&K’s “constitutional guarantees.”

On Wednesday Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah shuttled all NC MLAs away for a day long off-site. A review meeting of the legislators was scheduled to be held at the chief minister’s residence at Gupkar Road. However, after assembling at the venue, the MLAs boarded caravans to spend the day at the Dachigam National Park, on the outskirts of the city.

After the meeting ended, party chief spokesperson Tanvir Sadiq said: “The NC has decided that on the first day of the monsoon session, the NC legislative party will travel to Delhi and protest for our demands that include restoration of statehood and our constitutional guarantees.”

Sadiq said that the leadership of the party feels that this is the right time to take these issues to Delhi and “secure what has been snatched from us.”

Amid speculation on new members being inducted into the Omar cabinet and undercurrents of discontent among some of the elected MLAs with regard to public works, the chief minister gathered the MLAs to Dachigam with a view



Vehicles carrying Jammu and Kashmir MLAs and MPs arrive at Dachigam National Park for a meeting of National Conference leaders chaired by CM Omar Abdullah in Srinagar on Wednesday. PTI

to address their concerns. Sadiq said that other issues concerning J&K, whether developmental or societal, were discussed during the meeting led by the chief minister.

Party sources told *The Indian Express* that the purpose of the retreat was an “opportunity for all MLAs to speak their minds and air their complaints”.

Taking to social media, the NC vice-president posted photos with the party MLAs stating that the group will spend the day taking stock of the last 19 months, “the good, the not so good & everything in between.”

He also dismissed conjecture that the meeting was moved last minute, adding that it was always his intention to conduct this meeting off-site and “all arrangements have been made, days in advance, at the location

originally chosen by me.”

Meanwhile, Leader of the Opposition, BJP’s Sunil Sharma termed the party meeting a “floor test” stating that “he thinks that his MLAs are leaving him, hence this picnic.” He added that the people of J&K are concerned about basic issues of water, power, roads, “the CM has whisked away his MLAs for a picnic.”

Ahead of the meeting, there was speculation regarding the NC discussing strategies for restoration of statehood. On Wednesday, the LoP underscored that “statehood is BJP’s agenda, not theirs”.

Stating that the biggest achievement of the central government has been a lack of civilian deaths in the valley, Sharma added that “If Omar had law and order more than

150 young men would have died. Other than Pahalgal, there have been no civilian deaths. This is our biggest achievement.”

He also said that peace is not possible overnight and “until such time, statehood cannot be restored.”

Describing the NC’s decision to take their protest to New Delhi a “damp squib” People’s Conference president Sajad Lone said that this is “yet another attempt to divert attention from their failures. Try to divert attention from the lies of the election manifesto.”

In October last year, just after taking oath of office, the Omar Abdullah led cabinet had passed a resolution unanimously for restoration of statehood of Jammu and Kashmir “in its original form”.

FRAUDULENT APST CERTIFICATES AND WEAK ILP CHECKS FUEL NEW FEARS

Why ‘illegal immigration’ spectre is now resonating in Arunachal

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 3

THE TALK of “illegal immigration” is now resonating in Arunachal Pradesh, with demands to further tighten its Inner Line Permit (ILP) regime that regulates the entry of non-locals into the state and that is already among the strictest in the country.

Last week, following discussions with various local organisations, Chief Minister Pema Khandu announced the formation of a high-powered committee led by a Cabinet minister to examine and recommend measures for strengthening the ILP framework and a review of the guidelines issued earlier this year.

He also announced three other high-powered panels to look into interlinked concerns: a re-verification of Arunachal Pradesh Scheduled Tribes (APST) certificates; the status of children born of APST mothers and non-APST fathers; and “illegal infiltration”.

The anxieties

The wave of recent protests demanding a re-look at the existing system have largely been spearheaded by the Arunachal ST Bachao Andolan Committee. According to its general secretary Millo Ambo, their attention shifted to the ILP when they took up the issue in 2024 of non-APST persons “fraudulently” acquiring APST certificates.

In Arunachal, an APST document helps avail reserved quotas in government jobs and education institutions, land ownership, and special state



Arunachal CM Pema Khandu

government schemes.

“While we were carrying on that campaign and trying to identify people who had wrongfully acquired such certificates, we realised that if there had been proper records of ILP entry, it would have been much easier. So then, our focus went towards tightening of the ILP,” Ambo says.

He also identifies a new set of guidelines issued in March this year for enforcement of the ILP in Arunachal as the trigger for the recent protests. Among the guidelines’ clauses that the ST Bachao Andolan Committee calls contentious include the Secretary (Political), Government of Arunachal Pradesh, being authorised to issue a temporary or work ILP “to any person, valid for any period”.

The Committee has also questioned special provisions allowed to heads and officials of “mega projects” – that is, projects worth Rs 500 crore and more – such as for sponsorship of work ILPs of up to 200 labourers at a time, and a provision to extend these work ILPs to up to two years from a person’s date of

entry into the state.

Pointing to major projects such as Arunachal Frontier Highway and Siang mega dam that are in the works, and the state’s reliance on labour from outside the state for construction work, Ambo says: “If all this is implemented without strengthening the process of monitoring and tracking ILP holders, especially whether they exit after the expiry of the permit or not, this might have an effect on the demography of our state.”

The DIG of the Itanagar Capital Range, Tumme Amo, admits some limitations to the enforcement of the ILP. “There is a need for digital intervention because it is currently difficult to trace someone if they stay beyond the valid period. There are no means to track them,” he says.

Eid row

With these anxieties swirling, the spectre of “illegal immigration” – which is one of the pet concerns of the BJP, which is in power in the state – has now entered the picture. The main voice in this is the Arunachal Pradesh Indigenous Youth Organization, which called a bandh recently on Bakrid to protest against “illegally constructed mosques” and “illegal immigrants”.

DIG Amo says the claims of migrants entering illegally from outside the country – Arunachal borders Myanmar, Bhutan and Tibet – is not supported by facts. “Over the course of all of 2025, we identified around 7,000 people in the Itanagar capital region without valid ILPs during detection drives. None of them were migrants from another country.

Punjab to cap private school fee hikes at 5%

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, June 3

IN A bid to curb alleged exploitation by private schools, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Wednesday vowed to bring a tough new law limiting annual fee hikes to 5 per cent and cracking down on arbitrary increases, following the alleged death by suicide of a 17-year-old Class 12 student in Amritsar.

The announcement came during a press conference where Mann highlighted complaints from parents about fee-related harassment, including denial of roll numbers, exam certificates, and public humiliation of students. He described the issue as a “school mafia” and directed immediate action by the education department. Addressing the broader issue, CM Mann said he received multiple calls from distressed parents about schools withholding roll numbers before exams, denying certificates without a “no dues” clearance, and forcing students to stand in corners as punishment.

The key measures announced include a cap on fee hikes. The annual increase has been limited to 5 per cent on all cumulative fees, not just tuition, covering various charges imposed on parents. “Schools that hiked fees by more than 15 per cent in the last three years must refund the excess amount immediately,” said Mann.

The CM said a stringent ordinance will be brought in the next one or two days, to be passed in the upcoming Vidhan Sabha session. Violations will lead to cancellation of school affiliations, audits, and penalties. The law may extend to private colleges and other private institutes when it takes final shape.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Ref: i) Tender Notice No. 72/2025-2026 dated 16/12/2025 (Sr. No. 08)
ii) Tender No. 15225019B due on 09/07/2026.
01. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 09/06/2026 to 09/07/2026. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.
The Corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.
1889/2026

SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LIMITED
e-Procurement Tender Notice (Paper Notification)
TGSPDCL intends to float tender for procurement of (a) 15 Mtrs/500 Kgs Spun Poles to Various circles of TGSPDCL (b) New Transformer Oil (c) 11 KV 3C35 sq.mm TR-XLPE UG Cable (d) Polycarbonate seal bits (Yellow) (e) 33KV 3x400Sqmm Heat shrinkable straight through Jointing kits (f) 11 KV 3x300Sqmm Heat shrinkable outdoor end termination kits (g) 1-Ph (5-30A) Electronic Energy Meters DLMS & IRDA Port with and without PP Box (h) 11 KV 315 KVA DTRs (i) 11 KV 500 KVA DTRs on e-procurement platform. For further details of each item above, please visit www.tgspowerdistribution.com www.tender.telangana.gov.in www.auction.telangana.gov.in Phone:040-23431360, 1033, 1035, 1028 Sd/-CHIEF ENGINEER (P&MM) TGSPDCL, Hyderabad
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कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग सम्भाग भरतपुर
क्रमांक: अमुअ/भरत/स.स./2026-27/बी-469 दिनांक: 01/06/2026
संशोधन पत्र अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या 02/2026-27

इस कार्यालय के पत्र क्रमांक एसई/बीटी/निविदा/2026-27/बी-386 दिनांक 19.05.2026 से जारी अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या 02/2026-27 भरतपुर संभाग के अधीन जिला धौलपुर में कुल 01 सड़क निर्माण कार्य के लिए, जो कि एसपीपी पोर्टल पर **NIB NO. PWD2627A0620 & UBN NO. PWD2627WSOB02807** से प्रकाशित हुई है, को निविदों में विमानानुसार संशोधन जारी किया जाता है जो वेबसाइट www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in एवं www.sppp.raj.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है

विवरण	पूर्व प्रकाशित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
ऑनलाईन निविदा फार्म मिलने की तारीख	दिनांक 20.05.2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 01.06.2026 सांय 06.00 बजे तक	दिनांक 20.05.2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 04.06.2026 सांय 06.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा फार्म जमा कराने की तारीख	दिनांक 20.05.2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 01.06.2026 सांय 06.00 बजे तक	दिनांक 20.05.2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 04.06.2026 सांय 06.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन तकनीकी निविदा खोलने की तारीख	कार्य के सम्मुख अंकित कार्यालय में 02.06.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।	कार्य के सम्मुख अंकित कार्यालय में 05.06.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

निविदा की शेष शर्तें यथावत रहेगी। हस्ता/-
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता
सर्निवि संभाग भरतपुर
DIPRC/9718

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Daulat Ram S/o Sh. Laxmi Narayan R/o A-272, Mangolpuri, Phase II, Delhi-110045 also at A-304, Mangolpuri, Phase II, Delhi-110045**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Case Reg. No. 3909/2018, U/S 138 NI Act, PS North Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Daulat Ram** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Daulat Ram** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Daulat Ram of Case Reg. No. 3909/2018, U/S 138 NI Act, PS North Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.07.2026**.
By Order,
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-West. Court No. 107, 1st Floor
DP/7097/RD/2026(Court Matter)
Rohini Court, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE
FOR HIRING OF PRIVATE LAB
Sealed Quotation are invited by Medical Superintendent Civil Hospital Narnaul for Lab Test under Ayushmaan Bharat yojna in Civil Hospital, Narnaul 123001 for financial year 2026-27.
Quotation will be accepted up to 11:00 A.M. on 19-06-2026 and will be opened on same day in office of Medical Superintendent Civil Hospital Narnaul 123001.
1. The firm must be a GST Registered and having a Valid Licence.
2. All rights for acceptance & rejection of Quotations are reserved with Medical Superintendent Civil Hospital Narnaul 123001.
3. Quotaion Rate is Valid upto Financial year 2026-27 or Valid for 01 Year From Date of Finalization
4. Quotation must be properly signed and stamped.
5. The Lab Test detail can be obtained any working day from 0/0 Medical Superintendent Civil Hospital, Narnaul 123001.
6. Deduction of TDS and GST as per Government Rule.
Sd/-
Medical Superntendent
Civil Hospital Narnaul 123001
No. 45861/HRV

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM
The Tender Notice called vide this office NIT No. PW/SRJ/TA/Publication/2026-27-826-30 dated 22.04.2026 for online Tenders and further extended vide this office corrigendum No. PW/SRJ/TA/Publication/2026-27-1299-1301 dated 29.04.2026, 1536-38 dated 14.05.2026 and 1792-94 dated 21.05.2026. The tender would have to be opened on 10.06.2026. Now these tenders are hereby canceled due to Administrative/Technical reasons.
Executive Engineer,
HPPWD Division Seraj at Janjehli
No. 0829/2026-2027/HP

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM
The Tender Notice called vide this office NIT No. PW/SRJ/TA/Publication/2026-27-1140-43 dated 27.04.2026 for online Tenders and further extended vide this office corrigendum No.- PW/SRJ/TA/Publication/2026-27-1344-46 dated 04.05.2026, 1486-88 dated 11.05.2026, 1539-41 dated 14.05.2026 and 1795-97 dated 21.05.2026. The tender would have to be opened on 10.06.2026. Now these tenders are hereby canceled due to Administrative/Technical reasons.
Executive Engineer,
HP PWD Division Seraj at Janjehli
No. 0828/2026-2027/HP

संचालनालय
खेल और युवा कल्याण
टी.टी. नगर स्टेडियम, भोपाल, मध्यप्रदेश
ई-निविदा सूचना
संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण, मध्यप्रदेश, द्वारा “प्रदेश के विभिन्न खेल परिसरों में सिविल निर्माण/सुधार कार्य तथा विद्युत सामग्री/उपकरण प्रदाय/स्थापना हेतु” पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र व निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें www.mptenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध हैं। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरांत निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-टेंडर पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा।
म.प्र. माध्यम/126166/2026 **संचालक**

OFFICE OF THE COMMANDAT:
13TH BATTALION NATIONAL DISASTER RESPONSE FORCE, LADHOWAL, LUDHIANA (PUNJAB)
13TH BATTALION NATIONAL DISASTER RESPONSE FORCE (GOVT OF INDIA)
PO - Ladhowal, District - Ludhiana (Punjab)
PIN-141008, Ph. No. 0161-2921308 | E-mail jk13.ndrf@gov.in
No. 13th BN/NDRF/Q-Engr/Publication/2025-26/335 dated 02 June 2026
ACCOMMODATION REQUIREMENT ON RENT
Commandant 13th Battalion, NDRF, P.O. Ladhowal Ludhiana, (Punjab) -141008 invites application within 10 days, from the date of publication of this notice from willing Private College/School, Flat/House/Building owners for hiring of approximate Built up Area of 35135 square feet with open area approximate 15000 square feet for parking of vehicles and 10000 square feet open area for physical training activities for establishment of Battalion Headquarter of 13th Battalion National Disaster Response Force. This facility is required in Samba District of Jammu and Kashmir. The assessment of rent will be carried out by CPWD. The payment of rent will be made to owners as per the assessment and terms and conditions of the Lease Agreement. Contact number is 0161-2921308.
Sd/-
(Biju K Sam)
Commandant
Commandant13th Bn NDRF
DIP/J-3105/26, Date: Jun 3 2026

THE HARYANA CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR MILL LTD.,BHALI ANANDPUR, ROHTAK
Email: rtk.sugar@gmail.com website: www.rohtaksugars.com
Contact No. 01258-250641, 250800
नोटिस
मै० आर.ए. कान्ट्रेक्टर के अधीनस्थ ठेकेदारों/कर्मचारियों को सूचित किया जाता है कि यदि किसी ठेकेदार/कर्मचारी का भुगतान/वेतन मै० आर.ए. कान्ट्रेक्टर की तरफ बकाया है और उन्होंने अपने बकाया भुगतान/वेतन बारे अभी तक अपना लिखित प्रार्थना-पत्र मिल्स प्रबन्धकारिणी को प्रस्तुत नहीं किया है तो वे इस बारे अपना लिखित प्रार्थना-पत्र मिल्स प्रबन्धकारिणी को एक सप्ताह के अन्तर्गत प्रस्तुत करना सुनिश्चित करें।
हस्ता/-
मुख्य अभियन्ता
कृते: प्रबन्ध निदेशक
No. 45855/HRV

भारतीय खाद्य निगम
Food Corporation of India
Headquarters New Delhi-110001
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER THROUGH GEM PORTAL FOR APPOINTMENT OF SERVICE PROVIDER FOR CONTAINERIZED BULK TRANSPORTATION OF FOOD GRAINS ON END TO END BASIS FROM PROCURING SILO TO CONSUMING SILO OF FCI UNDER HUB AND SPOKE MODEL
For and on behalf of the FCI, online Bids in the prescribed RFP documents are invited from interested and eligible agencies for appointment of service provider for containerized bulk transportation of food grains on end to end basis from Procuring Silo to Consuming Silo of FCI under Hub and Spoke model. The bid documents & other detailed terms & conditions of the Selection Process can be seen at the Food Corporation of India website www.fci.gov.in (for reference only) as well as at Government E- Marketplace (GeM) Portal (<https://gem.gov.in>) (for reference and online bidding). The last date/time for the online submission of application through GeM Portal is 25th June 2026 up to 04:00 PM.
Sd/-
General Manager (Silos)

85k vehicles in a weekend: Shimla cops issue route advisory for tourists

Express News Service
Shimla, June 3

WITH THE onset of the tourist season and thousands of visitors from the plains heading towards Himachal Pradesh’s popular hill destinations, Shimla police Wednesday advised tourists travelling from the Chandigarh-Solan side to avoid entering Shimla city if their destination lies beyond the state capital.

The advisory aims to reduce traffic congestion in Shimla and ensure a smoother journey for tourists visiting high-alti-

tude destinations such as Kufri, Mashobra, Naldehra, Narkanda, Hattu Peak, Fagu, and Tattapani.

Additional Superintendent of Police (ASP), Shimla, Abhishek, said tourists travelling towards these destinations should take the Mehli-Dhali bypass route from Shoghi instead of passing through the congested roads of Shimla city. “Tourists coming from the Solan-Chandigarh side and intending to visit high-elevation tourist destinations situated beyond Shimla should take the right-hand diversion from

Shoghi. The Shoghi-Mehli bypass road is approximately 33 kilometres long and connects travellers directly to Bhattakuf-far and Dhali, allowing them to avoid the heavy traffic rush within Shimla city. As people, especially tourists, are not aware of this route, the bypass mostly has less traffic rush”, he said.

The ASP added that Bhattakuffar-Dhali serves as the gateway to several major tourist destinations, including Kufri, Mashobra, Tattapani and other popular hill stations located in the upper reaches of Shimla district.

LOAN FRAUD CASE

Anil Ambani's former aide sent to CBI custody until June 5

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 3

A SPECIAL court on Wednesday remanded Amitabh Jhunjhunwala, a former top executive of the Reliance-ADAG group, to CBI custody till June 5 in connection with a probe into an alleged bank loan fraud case.

He was produced before a special court designated under the CBI Act presided over by Judge J.P Darekar. On Monday, the special court had allowed the CBI to formally arrest Jhunjhunwala. He was sent to judicial custody at Arthur Road Jail in Mumbai until the arrest formalities were completed. The court had directed jail authorities to provide him with “proper bedding, care and medical treatment, if required, as per rules”.

Earlier, he was lodged in Tihar Central Prison in Delhi in judicial custody in a money laundering case and was brought to Mumbai on a production warrant.

NHRC takes cognizance of Indian Express report on 53 maternal deaths in MP's Sidhi, issues notice

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, June 3

THE NATIONAL Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has taken suo motu cognizance of *The Indian Express* report which found that 53 women died before, during or after childbirth in Madhya Pradesh's Sidhi district between April 2025 and March 2026, and has issued a notice to the state's Chief Secretary seeking a detailed report within two weeks.

In a statement issued Tuesday, the NHRC said it had taken cognizance of the report about the deaths "during pre and post-delivery in the Sidhi district... primarily due to lack of awareness and medical facilities".

"The Commission has observed that the contents of the media report, if true, raise a serious issue of violation of human rights. Therefore, it has issued a notice to the Chief Secretary, Government of Madhya Pradesh, seeking a detailed report within two weeks."

The NHRC noted that Sidhi had "consistently ranked among the bottom three districts in the Community Maternal Health League grading conducted by the State Health Department".

Referring to the findings in the report, the NHRC said that out of the 53 maternal deaths, the average age of the deceased women was 26 years and most were first- or second-time mothers. "The news report has also revealed a lack of basic infrastructure, including doctors and technical experts at Community Health Centres, Primary Health Centres and the District Hospital, due to which patients are referred to higher medical facilities in the faraway Rewa District, risking life in transit," the NHRC said.

It further noted the trans-

Indian killed, over 60 injured as Iran drone strikes Kuwait airport

MEA condemns attack, renews call for end to violence

PTI & ENS
Dubai, New Delhi June 3

AN INDIAN national was killed in an Iranian drone attack on Kuwait International Airport that left more than 60 injured, officials said on Wednesday. India condemned the attack, while renewing calls for an end to violence and urging strongly not to target civilian population and civilian infrastructure.

"We condemn the attack on the Kuwait International Airport today in which an Indian national has died and several of our nationals are injured," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said in a statement. "Since the onset of the conflict in West Asia, we have strongly urged that civilian population and civilian infrastructure must not be targeted. We again



Kuwaiti Defence Minister Sheikh Abdullah Ali Abdullah Al-Salem Al-Sabah visits an injured person at a hospital in Kuwait. REUTERS

call upon parties to cease such attacks," it said.

In a post on X, the Embassy of India in Kuwait said it is "closely coordinating" with the Kuwaiti authorities to extend all possible support and assistance to the bereaved family as

well as those injured in the incident.

"The embassy of India in Kuwait expresses its deepest condolences at the tragic demise of an Indian national due to an attack on the airport in Kuwait today," it said.

This latest death brings the total number of Indian fatalities to at least 10 since hostilities broke out between Iran and the US on February 28.

The attack came amid escalating tensions between the US and Iran.

In a statement, the Kuwait Army said the Iranian strikes resulted in the death of an Indian expatriate and injuries to several individuals. "We extend our sincere condolences and sympathies to the family of the deceased and his relatives, and we wish a speedy recovery to all the injured," said Colonel Saud Abdulaziz Al-Otaibi, the official spokesman of the Ministry of Defence.

Kuwaiti Interior Ministry spokesperson Brigadier General Nasser Bousleeb said that the passenger terminal (T1) at the airport was subjected to an attack by several hostile drones. "The attack resulted in the death of one traveller and injuries to several workers and travellers," he said, adding that the airport's facilities and operational infrastructure suf-

fered serious material damage.

Kuwait suspended air traffic and flights were diverted to nearby airports until further notice, Directorate General of Civil Aviation spokesperson Abdullah Al-Rajhi was quoted as saying by the state-run KUNA news agency.

Dr Abdullah Al-Sund, the official spokesperson for Kuwait's Ministry of Health, said that seven hospitals have received 63 injured so far following the attack targeting the airport. He added that seven cases have undergone urgent major surgical procedures, in addition to several minor surgeries. He said that the injured included civilians, airport workers, and travellers.

The Kuwaiti foreign ministry later summoned the Charge d'Affaires at the Iranian Embassy and handed him an official protest note regarding the attacks. Two members of the Iranian diplomatic mission have been declared persona non grata and asked to leave Kuwaiti territory within 24 hours, KUNA reported.

BRIEFLY



The Dalai Lama was formally presented the Grammy Award at his residence on Wednesday. X/ @DALAILAMA

HIMACHAL PRADESH

Dalai Lama presented Grammy Award at Dharamsala residence

TIBETAN SPIRITUAL leader, the Dalai Lama, was formally presented the Grammy Award at his residence here on Wednesday by Sarod maestro Amjad Ali Khan. The Dalai Lama, Tenzin Gyatso, won his first Grammy in the category of best audio book, narration, and storytelling recording for his spoken-word album, *Meditations: The Reflections of His Holiness the Dalai Lama*. The 90-year-old's spoken-word album combines his teachings with music by acclaimed artistes, and seeks to spread messages of peace and compassion to a global audience. The album features the Dalai Lama's teachings on peace, compassion, mindfulness, and universal responsibility with musical compositions. PTI

70-yr-old man, wife found 'murdered'

A 70-YEAR-OLD man and his wife were found murdered at their residence in a village in Chhattisgarh's Sakti district, police said on Wednesday. The victims, Purushottam Khunte and his wife Goharini Bai (55), were residents of Seduras village under Malkharoda police station limits. According to police, a neighbouring woman visited the couple's house in the morning and found them lying dead inside. She alerted local residents, following which the police were informed. PTI

Search for missing student continues

A MASSIVE search operation was underway for a 23-year-old MBA student who went missing under mysterious circumstances five days ago during a trek to Uttarakhand's Dayara Bugyal, officials said on Wednesday. Police filed a case and detained her two travel companions for questioning following a complaint by her family. Authorities suspended the registration of the trekking agency, Pro Mountain, after it was found that the group was sent on the trek using a "forged permit". PTI

362 illegal Bangladeshi immigrants identified in Gujarat, says govt

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, June 3

THE GUJARAT government identified 362 "illegal" immigrants from Bangladesh living in the state, said Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi on Wednesday evening. The action came after raids were carried out across the state earlier in the day.

"A total of 6,200 people were under investigation, but police detained only those who were most suspicious. After verification, 362 individuals were confirmed to be illegal immigrants from Bangladesh (by Wednesday evening). Meanwhile, an investigation of more than 780 people is still underway, and [the raids] will continue through the night," Sanghavi said at a press conference in Gandhinagar.

Earlier in the day, joint commissioner of police (Ahmedabad City) Sharad Singhal confirmed that they identified 166 illegal immigrants out of 300-odd suspects during the raids that were named 'Operation Delta Hunt'. However, these numbers were likely to increase.

Sanghavi confirmed that most of these illegal immigrants from Bangladesh were found to be living in the districts of Ahmedabad, Surat, Vadodara, Rajkot, and Bharuch.

Sanghavi also said that they had caught some alleged illegal immigrants attempting to flee during the state-wide raids in the early hours of June 3 (Wednesday). "Check posts were established at railway stations, bus stands and highways during the raids to catch those trying to flee. The police apprehended another 18 people who were trying to escape the raids he said.

The deputy CM went a step further and said that action would also be taken against those found to have given shelter to the illegal immigrants. "A special police team is now investigating the people who gave them (the immigrants) shelter and jobs. We had previously said that nobody is to employ or give residence to anyone without document verification. If someone does so, they will also be booked. Industries that may have employed them sans police verification will face strict action."



Delcy Arrives on 5-day Visit

Venezuela Acting President Delcy Rodriguez being received by officials in New Delhi on Wednesday. Rodriguez, who is on a five-day visit, is scheduled to hold talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday. Besides energy, the two sides are also set to explore ways to shore up cooperation in areas of trade and investment, pharmaceuticals and technology. PTI

British Foreign Secy to meet PM today

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 3

BRITISH FOREIGN Secretary Yvette Cooper will meet Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Thursday.

Cooper, who is scheduled to arrive in India late Wednesday on her first official visit to the country, will meet Jaishankar on Thursday where both ministers will discuss closer collaboration between the UK and India to minimise economic shocks from ongoing conflicts, preserve global stability, and ensure freedom of navigation.

The visit of Cooper, who will arrive here after visiting China, comes at a time when the war in west Asia has disrupted energy security and maritime security.

"The Foreign Secretary's trip sets an ambitious path for engagement with India, a top



BRITISH FOREIGN Secretary Yvette Cooper

priority partner for the UK. It builds on the visit by Business and Trade Secretary Peter Kyle earlier this week to bring the landmark UK-India Free Trade Agreement into force as soon as possible," the British High Commission said in a statement.

Together with Jaishankar, the Foreign Secretary will undertake a formal review of delivery under the UK-India Vision 2035 to date, highlighting the UK's priorities for the year

ahead across economic growth, technology and innovation, defence and security, climate and education. "The annual review ensures our partnership remains dynamic, aligned, and responsive to rapid global change," the British statement said.

Lindy Cameron, British High Commissioner to India, said: "The UK-India partnership is a bulwark against rising global uncertainty. Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper's visit this week, her first visit in the role, is another important opportunity to build on that partnership."

"Since our Prime Ministers unveiled their shared vision for a modern UK-India partnership last year, the UK has been driving forward collaboration with India as a priority.

"From the Technology Security Initiative where we are shaping the technologies of to-

morrow to our landmark trade deal that will help make trade cheaper, quicker and easier – the UK-India partnership is delivering where it matters most to people in both countries."

In New Delhi, the British Foreign Secretary will welcome new Indian investment into the Technology Security Initiative throughout her programme. She will interact with AI health tech entrepreneurs and join a special programme at the British Council to hear how UK-India partnerships on education and growth are delivering real results on shared priorities, the British High Commission said.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer joined Prime Minister Narendra Modi last year to unveil Vision 2035, a shared ambition for how the UK and India partner together to unlock the huge potential of this partnership.



A member of the Senem Nirem Farmer Producer Company Limited in Jharkhand. AGRICULTURE MINISTRY

Sahkari Samiti based in Khunti district of Jharkhand, said that

members of her FPO are planning to sow pulses and millets.

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, June 3

WITH THE Union Agriculture Ministry stepping up preparations to tackle the challenges of a potentially weak southwest monsoon rainfall triggered by the El Nino conditions, several Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) have emerged as torchbearers of promoting drought-resistant crops and climate-resilient farm practices.

According to officials, the ministry has prepared a list of FPOs which are cultivating drought-resistant crops like millets and are using climate-resilient farm practices including mulching for moisture conservation, drip irrigation

and mixed cropping system. The ministry has been holding webinars to promote natural farming everyday in one state and is now planning to host a series of webinars in the coming days to promote climate-resilient farm practices like mulching for moisture conservation, the officials said.

Over 63 lakh farmers are members of 10,000 FPOs across the country and the ministry plans to use their network to reach out to farmers to adopt climate-resilient practices to counter the challenges of weak monsoon, added the officials.

"Promoting mulching for moisture conservation is one of the simplest and most effective ways. By covering the soil

surface with crop residues or other organic materials, evaporation losses can be reduced significantly, while it also suppresses weeds and improves soil health," said an official.

The FPOs such as Torpa Mahila Krishi Bagwani Swawlambi Sahkari Samiti Limited and Senem Nirem Farmer Producer Company Limited in Jharkhand have adopted natural mulching using straw and gunny bags.

"These low-cost interventions help retain moisture in the soil for longer periods, enabling crops to withstand dry spells more effectively," said the official.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* over phone, Etwary Devi, director of Torpa Mahila

The samiti has about 4,000 members.

According to Devi, most of these farmers used to plant paddy during kharif season but this year, they are planning to opt for pulses including moon, urad and kulthi (horse gram) and ragi, which requires less water.

They are also encouraging other farmers to plant crops which require less water, Devi said.

Devi, s an acre of land and takes farm land on lease, has been using mulching for moisture conservation. Mulching, using straw and old gunny bags, helps saving water and also prevents weeds, she said.

The move to shift from

paddy to millet crops in Jharkhand is significant as the state is located in the Monsoon Core Zone (MCZ) consisting of most of the rainfed agriculture areas in the country.

Apart from Jharkhand, the MCZ consists mainly — Maharashtra, Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka, Telangana and Odisha.

The officials said promoting drought-resistant crops can help farmers reduce production risks under uncertain rainfall conditions.

Millets, in particular, are naturally resilient, require less water, and can perform well in marginal environments where other crops may struggle, said an official, adding that an en-

couraging example comes from MVM Baghima Palkot Farmer Producer Company Limited, Jharkhand, which is promoting millet cultivation among its members.

According to the IMD, the monsoon (June-September) rainfall for the country as a whole during 2026 is likely to be 90 per cent of the Long Period Average (LPA) with a model error of ± 4%. The LPA of the seasonal rainfall over the country as a whole based on data of 1971-2020 is 87 cm.

The southwest monsoon seasonal rainfall over the Monsoon Core Zone (MCZ) consisting of most of the rainfed agriculture areas in the country is most likely to be below normal (<94% of LPA).



Capital tragedy, national shame

THE DEATH of at least 21 people in a fire in South Delhi’s Malviya Nagar is part of an ongoing national tragedy. The fire in Palam, Delhi that killed nine people in March; the conflagration in a Cuttack medical college and hospital that claimed 12 lives in the same month; the fire that broke out in a Kolkata hotel in April, killing 14: These incidents, all from the last six months alone, frame a pattern of norms breached and rules circumvented, of overcrowded structures with narrow exits and exposed wires or ageing electrical systems, of lack of basic equipment and wilful ignorance of protocols. The pattern reveals the shockingly low priority accorded to safety in urban governance in a country where more and more people now live in cities.

The causes of the fire in Malviya Nagar will be confirmed after an investigation. But it is not hard to guess the factors that might have turned the site into a tinderbox. The area is a busy spot of commerce and leisure, brimming with eateries, paying-guest accommodations and shops. Given its proximity to three major hospitals, it sees a large number of out-of-town patients and medical tourists from other parts of the world occupying the tiny, windowless rooms available on rent. Buildings sit cheek-by-jowl — the fire began in the basement kitchen of one bed-and-breakfast and spread to the next — and the lanes are too congested for timely help and rescue. As noted in the report “Fires in India: Learning Lessons for Urban Safety” (2020) by the National Institute of Disaster Management, it is this complex web of vulnerabilities that leads to the vast majority of urban fires.

According to a recent working paper by the PM-EAC, India’s “hidden urbanisation” phenomenon has meant that far more Indians live in urban clusters than most estimates suggest; going by the satellite data from the Global Human Settlements Layer, India was already 63 per cent urban in 2015. The National Building Code does have extensive directions to prevent fire mishaps, and most states, too, have fire safety guidelines. What is needed is strengthening supervision, enforcing regulations and empowering municipalities — the tier of governance responsible for fire-safety operations. Not long ago, in the wake of the collapse of a building in the nearby area of Saidulajab, which led to the death of six people, municipal officers promised an audit of unsafe buildings. Tragedies like these may be a wake-up call, but they must be followed by sustained attention, apart from demands for accountability.

India, Myanmar and a shifting balance

IN HIS first official overseas trip since being elected president earlier this year, Min Aung Hlaing concluded a five-day state visit to India this week, as part of an effort to rectify Myanmar’s diplomatic isolation. Following the coup he led in February 2021 — which resulted in the house arrest and eventual conviction of then-head of government Aung San Suu Kyi on trumped-up charges — Naypyidaw lost much of its political legitimacy, a perception it did little to improve with the stage-managed elections this year that propelled the USDP, a junta proxy, to power. Set against the backdrop of a devastating multi-front civil war between the military, pro-democracy forces and ethnic militias, Myanmar’s instability increasingly carries transnational repercussions and a Chinese footprint that India can ignore at its own peril.

Reportedly, talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Min Aung Hlaing covered cooperation across security, trade, rare earths, healthcare, and connectivity projects, among other areas. Security is arguably the most pressing of these, given that the two countries share a 1,600-km border — militancy, ethnic ties, and constant cross-border movement mean that instability on one side spills over to the other. The civil war has underscored this reality as thousands of refugees, many from the Chin community, have sought shelter in Mizoram and Manipur. Further, the military has weaker control over areas that border India. Myanmar also serves as the land bridge underpinning India’s Act East Policy.

There is little doubt that the junta has committed atrocities against its own people over the past decade — first against the Rohingya, then against supporters of democracy. Even as the civil war grinds on, it also retains a firm grip on critical urban centres and institutional power. As much of the West has shunned the Min Aung Hlaing establishment, China has steadily widened its influence and thrown its weight behind the military leadership, driven by its own interests, not least the protection of its oil and gas infrastructure. New Delhi’s challenge, therefore, is to balance engagement with Naypyidaw and non-state actors who control stretches of the border. Until stability returns to Myanmar, a flexible approach is critical to India’s neighbourhood policy.

It’s ok, cinema is alive and well

IN 1929, in an interview with Gladys Hall in *Motion Picture Magazine*, Charlie Chaplin said, “[Talkies] are spoiling the oldest art in the world — the art of pantomime. They are ruining the great beauty of silence.” Years later, after making several talkies himself, he admitted, “I was obsessed by a... fear of being old-fashioned.” The 21st century, too, has had its share of Chaplins amid the ruptures caused by the information age and an isolating pandemic. Many wonder: Is cinema dying? If recent box-office numbers are anything to go by, however, the answer is no — the talent is just finding new ways to break through.

In the US and many other markets, the top two films this week are Kane Parsons’s *Backrooms* and Curry Barker’s *Obsession*. Both filmmakers are among a growing number who found their start on YouTube and first created the stories they told on the big screen in the digital format. Barker co-founded the sketch comedy/horror duo (and YouTube channel) That’s a Bad Idea; *Weapons* director Zach Cregger did the same with *The Whitest Kids U’Know*. (Bo Burnham was one of the first on this scene). Many in the industry have been blaming “attention-deficit kids today” for the dwindling numbers in theatres. While there may be some truth to the allegation, the problem lies elsewhere: No one behind the traditional camera seems to quite “get the kids” today. Barker and Parsons’s successes underline an old truth about show business: If you tell the right story, and do it well, the audience will find you.

These creators have, in a lack, found an opportunity to articulate the fears of their generations. No wonder many of their films focus on horror, anxiety, politics. The artists and the audiences can breathe easy, and the gatekeepers can step back: Cinema is alive and well, it’s just evolving, and the kids are in the room.

Dear Gen Z, join the system. Change happens in mundane politics



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

DEAR GEN Z Indians who signed up to the “Cockroach Janta Party”: It is impossible to look at the current landscape of India — the headlines, the stories emerging from exam centres, and the raw, unfiltered conversations flooding social media — without feeling the immense weight of the collective frustration gripping your generation.

On May 16, Abhijeet Dipke posted an invitation to join the “Cockroach Janta Party”. Five days later, he had 20 million Instagram followers. His satirical movement has captured the imagination of Gen Z and others like you, frustrated by the inadequacies of our political system and its failure to meet your needs. Instagram is your town square. But it is not a ballot box.

To those of you feeling lost, angry, and disillusioned: Your pain is seen, and your anger is heard. The reasons you signed up for the CJP are valid. When you dedicate years of your life to preparation, sacrificing sleep, social connection, and mental well-being for a dream, the news of paper leaks and system failures is not just a news headline — it is a betrayal of your time, your effort, and your future. The tragic news of stu-

dents losing their lives in despair is a devastating reminder that the “rotten system” isn’t just an abstract concept; it has real, human consequences that cut to the core of our society. But there is a danger in mistaking an outlet for your frustration as the solution to your problems. It is not.

The emergence of movements like the CJP offers a powerful, albeit heartbreaking, piece of political theatre. It captures the visceral feeling of being treated as disposable by a system that seems unresponsive to the struggles of ordinary citizens. It seems a safe space for those of you dealing with the crushing weight of unemployment, the rising cost of living, and the narrowing of the pathways to quality education. But while venting and finding solidarity in this movement is necessary for emotional release, there is a danger in stopping there. History shows us that while rage can ignite a fire, it requires a steady hand and a clear strategy to build a structure that endures. Instagram alone doesn’t do it.

If you want more than just temporary attention, you must channel this energy into something that forces the system to bend. That is why working within the system you feel has failed you and pushing against the existing system so that it serves your needs is the most effective path forward.

First, as an MP myself, let me tell you that you can make your representatives accountable. The system is not a monolith; it comprises people who are, at least in theory, beholden to you. Flood the offices of your local MLAs and MPs with structured grievances and demand they take it up with the authorities. Use the

If all else fails, take your case to court. But for that, you need to have a case, not just a set of slogans or memes expressing your frustrations

India’s approach to US trade deal needs an urgent rethink



ABHIJIT DAS

THE INDIA-US Interim Agreement for trade is back in the spotlight. Sergio Gor, the US Ambassador to India, has said that the deal is 99 per cent complete. Officials are ironing out a few issues and are reportedly finalising the deal this week.

On February 6, the two countries had issued a joint statement announcing that they had reached a framework under which the US would reduce reciprocal tariffs on India from 25 per cent to 18 per cent, while India had committed to reducing or eliminating tariffs on most US agricultural and industrial exports. As part of the bilateral trade agreement, India may also be required to align its economic policies and laws, including those in the digital sector and intellectual property rights, with US interests.

Much, however, has changed over the past four months.

On February 20, the US Supreme Court declared reciprocal tariffs to be illegal, thereby undermining the basis for the 18 per cent reciprocal tariffs. Subsequently, the US imposed 10 per cent tariffs across the board on most countries. As these tariffs are due to lapse on July 24, the US has already proposed a tariff of 12.5 per cent against India for labour issues under Section 301 investigations. These illegal tariffs could go even higher after the investigations on excess capacity are concluded.

In this negotiating environment, India could be compelled to accept an interim agreement that, in reality, may not be balanced and equitable. Further, if any action of India, including the purchase of Russian oil or any other policy decision, is perceived by US President Donald Trump to be against American interests, he may not hesitate to impose higher punitive tariffs, thereby undermining tariff predictability.

Then there is the rapid depreciation in the value of the rupee, with the widening trade deficit being one of the triggers. The India-US joint statement requires India to purchase \$500 billion of US goods and services over the next five years. This would further exacerbate the depreciation crisis.

Das is an international trade expert. The views expressed are personal

ports resulting from the interim agreement may not be sufficient to offset this.

The case put forth by some commentators is that the interim agreement will boost India’s exports from labour-intensive sectors such as textiles and clothing to the US and create employment. This may well be true, provided India faces a tariff in the US that is substantially lower than that faced by its competitors, including Bangladesh, China and Vietnam. However, concessions by India in the area of agriculture are likely to push a far greater number of farmers out of employment, including through tariff concessions on almonds, apples, apple juice, cotton, orange juice, red sorghum and soybean oil among other products, and other concessions.

An important demand of Washington is that its partner countries mandatorily allow imports of dairy, meat, and poultry products from the US if they are accompanied by health certificates from the relevant American authorities. If India agrees to this, its farmers will be adversely impacted by low-priced and subsidised imports of these products. Finally, the livelihood of millions of Indian farmers of rice and wheat would be jeopardised if the US leverages the interim agreement and secures changes in India’s minimum support price scheme, an objective that it is pursuing aggressively at the WTO.

A golden rule at the negotiating table is “let us never negotiate out of fear, but let us never fear to negotiate”. If India’s continued bilateral trade engagement with the US is premised mainly on avoiding ever-increasing and illegal tariffs on labour-intensive products, then we must be prepared to face the adverse consequences of a deal that is likely to be substantially tilted against the country. At a time when many countries are seeking to diversify their export destinations, by firmly tethering its economic policies and prospects to the political and commercial interests of the US, India runs the risk of narrowing its options. An urgent rethink of India’s approach to the interim agreement is called for.

Das is an international trade expert. The views expressed are personal



SHASHANK JOSHI & SHAMRAT SAMAJDAR

ADHIK MAAS

Adhik Maas, the sacred extra month in the Hindu calendar, comes like a divine pause button. It reminds us that life also needs adjustment. Just as the calendar needs correction, our inner life also needs correction. For the youth, Adhik Maas says: Ambition is good, but comparison can burn the mind. Success is beautiful; ego can destroy it. Social media may give applause, but it can also create restlessness. Dream big, but do not lose yourself in the race.

For the middle-aged, it says: Responsibility is noble, but constant anxiety is not. Earning is necessary, but endless greed is not. Caring for family is sacred, but forgetting the self is not wisdom. For the elderly, it says, memories are precious, but bitterness is heavy. Experience is a gift, but attachment to control can disturb peace. Bless more, complain less, and become a shelter of calmness for the next generation. Kazi Nazrul Islam reminds us that no one’s condition remains unchanged forever. Today’s king may become tomorrow’s seeker. Power, youth, wealth, fame and beauty all move like clouds. His poetic vision teaches us that arrogance is foolish because time is stronger than all crowns.

Rabindranath Tagore offers another deep lesson. He suggests that sometimes, when life does not give us everything we desire, it may actually be saving us. Denial is not always punishment. A closed door may be protection. A delay may be preparation. A loss may be purification. A limitation may save us from excess. History, scripture and poetry, therefore, speak the same language. Ravana had knowledge, power and prosperity, but arrogance made him blind. The Kauravas had strength and privilege, but pride made them unjust. Bali had generosity, but even generosity needed surrender before the divine. Adhik Maas is not asking us to reject life. It is asking us to refine life. Eat, but not with indulgence. Work, but not with obsession. Love, but not with possession. Give, but not with pride.

Joshi is a Mumbai-based endocrinologist. Samajdar is a clinical pharmacologist and diabetes and allergy-asthma therapeutics specialist in Kolkata

40 YEARS AGO June 4, 1986



Akali rebels organise

FORMER PUNJAB chief minister Parkash Singh Badal, will head the organisational wing of the new party the Akali dissidents propose to form. A consensus to this effect has been reached among the breakaway group’s senior leaders, and it was in accordance with this understanding that Captain Amarinder Singh, who resigned from the Barnala cabinet in protest against the police entry into the Golden Temple complex, was elected leader of the dissident Akali legislators.

All-party meeting in Sri Lanka

SRI LANKAN President JR Jayewardene announced his government’s acceptance of a

proposal to convene a conference of all registered political parties to discuss the island’s ethnic crisis. The suggestion was made by the Sri Lanka Mahajana Party (SLMP) and subsequently endorsed by the ruling United National Party’s working committee. Addressing ruling party MPs, Jayewardene said the government had agreed to the proposal.

India’s dismay at China’s claim

INDIA EXPRESSED dismay at China’s renewed claim to 90,000 square kilometres of Indian territory in the eastern sector. Although the statement by Chinese Vice-Foreign Minister Liu Shuqing merely reiterated the position taken by the Chinese delegation during border talks in New Delhi the previous

November, its timing — just weeks before the next round of negotiations in Beijing — created difficulties for India.

6 children die in grenade blast

The lure of scrap metal from discarded ammunition led to the deaths of six children and prompted criminal proceedings against their parents in Bhandara village near the Babina Army firing range, about 42 kilometres from Jhansi. According to official reports, the children had picked up an unexploded hand grenade along with several empty shells. While attempting to break open the shells inside a hut, they struck the grenade, which exploded, killing all six children, aged between six and 10, and setting the hut on fire.



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Great Nicobar task: Pursuing national security with ecological responsibility



D K JOSHI

STATE that does not secure its frontiers, alliances and trade routes cannot secure its future.” Kautilya’s lesson, written into the grammar of statecraft centuries ago, has returned with unusual force in our time. Nations today are again being tested not merely on the size of their economies or the strength of their armies, but on their ability to read geography, anticipate the future and act before opportunity turns into vulnerability. Great Nicobar is one such test for India.

Located close to some of the most important seaways of the Indo-Pacific, Great Nicobar is one of India’s most important strategic windows to the world. That is why the proposed development cannot be understood merely as an infrastructure project. It is a strategic test of whether India is prepared to convert a rare geographical advantage to further bolster its Comprehensive National Power.

For centuries, the Indian Ocean shaped India’s destiny, carrying our trade, ideas, civilisational influence and, at times, our vulnerabilities. Yet, for much of the post-Independence period, India’s strategic imagination remained heavily continental.

Great Nicobar is one of the largest islands in the archipelago, with an area of about 910 sq km. The total project area of 166.10 sq km is only about 2 per cent of the total area of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, of which 130.75 sq km, approximately 1.82 per cent of the total forest area of the islands, is proposed for diversion. Great Nicobar lies close to Southeast Asia and sits near major global sea lanes.

Its importance becomes clearer when viewed from the strategic lens of the high seas. Imagine the ships moving from the Gulf of Aden towards the Malacca Strait, energy cargo sailing from West Asia and Africa towards East Asia, container traffic connecting Asia, Africa and Europe, naval assets, surveillance platforms and logistics

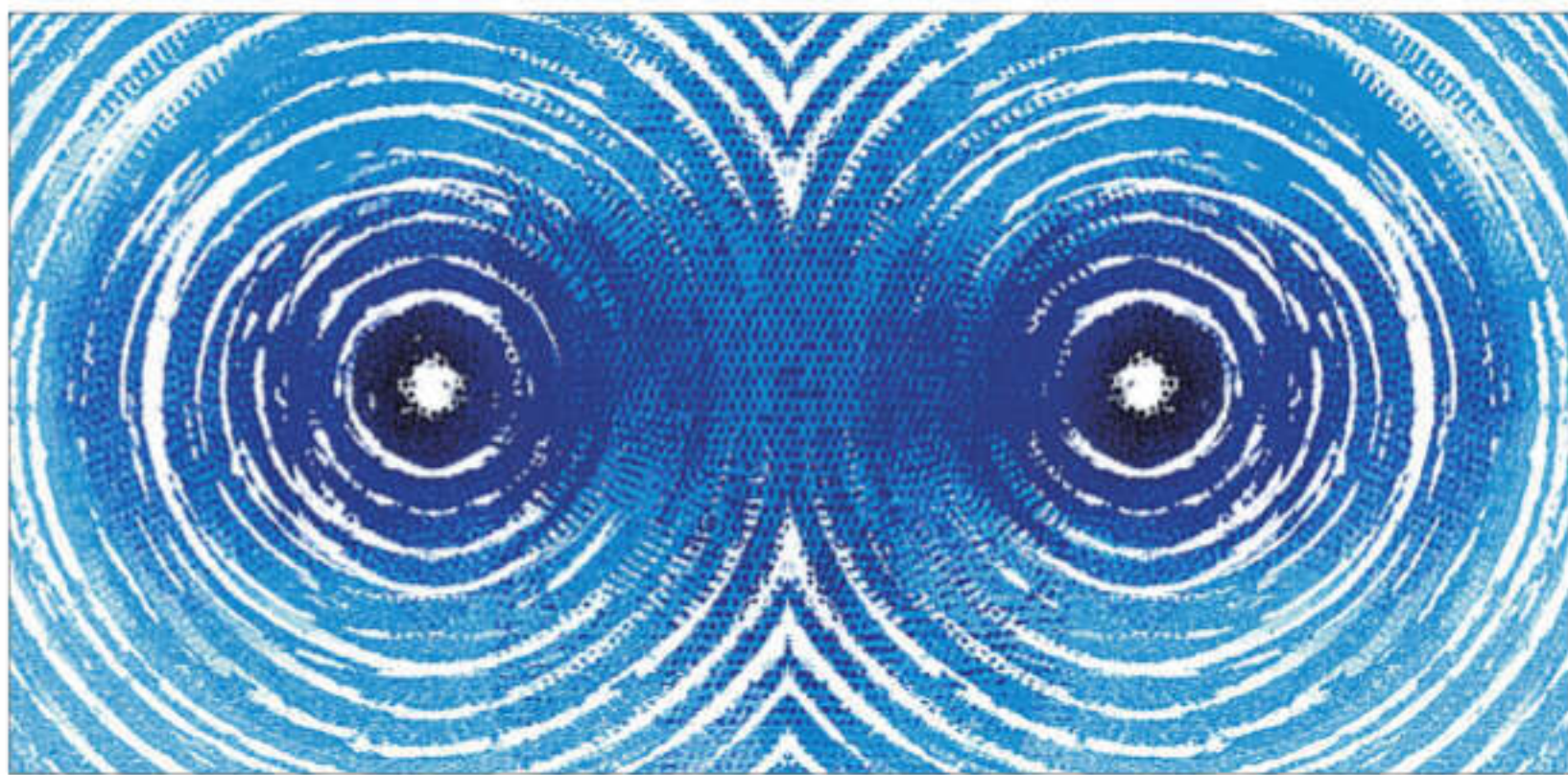


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

chains moving through these waters.

The Indian Ocean is increasingly becoming a crowded strategic arena. Energy flows, container traffic, naval deployments, island facilities, undersea cables and maritime surveillance are now part of a larger contest that is decisive for the future of nations. Recently, Thailand shelved a decades-old proposal for a canal connecting the Andaman Sea to the Gulf of Thailand. Instead, an overland 90 km multi-modal land bridge connecting two newly designed deep-sea ports along the 10th parallel — one in Ranong on the Andaman Sea and another in Chumphon on the Gulf of Thailand — along with dual-track high-speed rail, multi-lane roads, energy pipelines for oil and gas and an air-digital grid, is pending final approval. All these factors redefine the Indo-Pacific trade route and shift the economic centre of gravity to the Andaman basin.

The Strait of Malacca is among the world’s most important chokepoints. It connects the Indian Ocean with the Pacific and carries energy (oil and LNG) and commerce of enormous value. Great Nicobar’s Galathea Bay is about 45 km from the Six Degree Channel, which connects the Malacca Strait with routes leading towards Africa, the Middle East and Europe. Around 1 lakh ships pass annually through the Ma-

Across the IOR, powerful countries are expanding their presence through ports, naval assets, surveillance systems and economic corridors. India’s answer must be strategic consolidation

lacca Strait-Six Degree Channel route. The island’s proximity to the Malacca, Sunda and Lombok chokepoints gives India a significant strategic advantage.

Across the IOR, powerful countries are steadily expanding their presence through ports, logistics arrangements, maritime access facilities, naval assets, surveillance systems and economic corridors. India’s answer must be strategic consolidation. Sovereignty is strengthened when territory becomes connected, inhabited, serviced, productive and strategically usable. The International Container Transshipment Port, greenfield airport, township and power plant will together create the ecosystem needed for India to maintain a credible, sustained and multidimensional presence at a decisive maritime location.

The National Green Tribunal, after due diligence and consideration of observations, acknowledged the project’s great significance not only for the economic development of the island and the surrounding areas of strategic location, but also for defence and national security.

Singapore did not become a great maritime hub merely because it was well located. It built capacity around that location. Location gave it the opportunity, and its infrastructure converted that opportunity into influence. Diego Garcia offers another lesson from the Indian Ocean. It shows how a remote

island, when equipped with logistics and operational infrastructure, can acquire outsized strategic significance.

Great Nicobar allows India to do this in a balanced and distinctly Indian way. It can support trade and strengthen national security, reduce dependence on foreign transshipment hubs, enhance India’s maritime reach and serve as a gateway to Southeast Asia and a platform for the wider Indo-Pacific. A transshipment port at Great Nicobar can reduce dependence on foreign ports, improve supply-chain resilience, attract investment, generate employment and give India greater certainty over the movement of its own cargo.

Of course, Great Nicobar is environmentally sensitive. Any project of this scale must be implemented with ecological care, legal compliance, scientific monitoring and genuine mitigation. But ecological sensitivity cannot become a permanent veto on strategic thinking. The challenge is to pursue national security with ecological responsibility.

The real question is whether India wants to responsibly develop a strategic island, or whether it will leave that island under-connected at a time when the entire Indo-Pacific is being reorganised. India is both a continental and maritime power. For too long, the continental mind overshadowed the maritime one. The Great Nicobar project is, therefore, not extravagance, but strategic foresight. A nation’s destiny is shaped not only by the threats it faces, but by the opportunities it recognises in time. Great Nicobar is one such opportunity. To neglect it would be to leave geography unused and vulnerable to being shaped by others. To develop it wisely would be to turn geography into a strength.

India does not need to apologise for thinking strategically. It only needs to act responsibly, decisively and with a clear sense of national interest. In the Indo-Pacific century, Great Nicobar is not the edge of India. It is India’s watchtower at the gateway of the future.

The writer is Lieutenant Governor of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands and vice chairman of the Islands Development Agency. He is a former chief of the naval staff and was commander-in-chief of the A&N Command during 2009-10

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Women in JEE

THE SURGE in the number of girls qualifying for JEE Advanced reflects what sustained policy support and social change can achieve (‘Girls rewrite JEE script. Campus must keep pace’, *IE*, June 3). The introduction of supernumerary seats in IITs in 2018, along with targeted STEM outreach, has clearly widened access. Yet participation alone is not enough. A 2023 UNESCO report noted that women continue to face barriers in research funding, leadership, and retention in STEM careers globally. India must now focus on mentorship, safer campuses, maternity support, and equal research opportunities.

Havya Garg, Chandigarh

Integrity of evidence

THE TWISHA SHARMA case highlights a systemic problem that extends well beyond a single investigation (‘When a distorted autopsy denies justice’, *IE*, June 3). Forensic protocols for unnatural deaths — particularly those occurring within seven years of marriage — must be standardised and made non-negotiable. Private hospitals conducting autopsies need direct regulatory oversight, along with mandatory documentation standards and third-party audit mechanisms.

Abbharna Barathi, Chennai

Remarkable talent

FOR A Gen-X listener like me, the song ‘Zindagi Imtihaan Leti Hai’ from the blockbuster film *Naseeb* instantly brings back memories of Suman Kalyanpur’s soulful singing (‘In and as Suman Kalyanpur’, *IE*, June 3). Kalyanpur was one of the finest voices in Hindi film music, yet she spent much of her career in the shadow of the Mangeshkar sisters. By repeatedly referring to her as the “other Lata”, the music industry failed to accord her the independent recognition she deserved in the pantheon of great playback singers.

Nawal Thorat, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar



MRINAL PANDE

IT WAS the dismal October of 1987, the year of the stock-market meltdown in the US, when a French fashion designer, Christian Lacroix, launched a “luxe” collection at a society gala on Wall Street. It was not an accident. The fashion industry had already dubbed this genius the “messiah”. So, while the ardour for fashion was plunging along with the stocks, he rescued the fashion and beauty industry in that best of years, the worst of years.

Fast-track to the recent Cannes red carpet extravaganza, held against an even bigger global economic and political breakdown. As the world saw images of the starving and severely wounded from Asia and Africa, India’s mainstream as well as social media and the beauty industry saw nothing wrong in joining the gala event in France, streaming images of models and Hollywood/Bollywood beauties of yesteryear.

Feminism had long warned women against the beauty industry sneaking its agenda into their worldview. In the 20th century, when global beauty contests began to seem passé, the industry mined feminist phraseology to push products for the “liberated woman”. The advertising world used all sorts of clichés to push back against old-school feminists who had been berating expensive gals and holding up real-time data about working-class women.

The next real wave of liberation will have to be rooted in a collective idea of self-esteem among women of all ages, classes, castes, and communities



NIRBHAY RANA

AS NORTH India braces for another stretch of 45-degrees-plus temperatures, the country’s heatwave response remains familiar. Alerts are issued, school timings adjusted, outdoor work restricted. Citizens are advised to hydrate and stay indoors. Within this framework, one system remains almost entirely unexamined: Clothing. This is not a question of fashion, but of physiology.

The human body cools itself primarily through the evaporation of sweat. For this to work, heat and moisture must escape efficiently from the skin. Clothing governs this exchange. It can enable cooling — or trap heat, restrict airflow, and increase thermal

A feminist future cannot rely on past language

In 2026, threatened by recession and job losses, promoters of fashion and beauty products were forced to look for a “messiah” to lift up their sagging bottom lines. An erstwhile beauty queen, a model-turned-actor from Bollywood, rose as a natural symbol for promoting the idea of “ageless beauty”. A media blitzkrieg followed the 24th consecutive appearance of the Chosen One at Cannes as proof of how a real beauty ages naturally.

Like Psyche, the mythical Greek figure forever navigating doubt and questioning appearances, this old-school feminist commented on the phenomenon of agelessness being possibly based on cosmetic enhancement. All hell broke loose. The first reaction ascribed the comment to “envy”; clichés like “a woman is a woman’s worst enemy” were then brandished.

No ideology can claim to give you terminologies for a lifetime. Feminism is no exception. At 80, I can see more and more younger women rushing to claim a so-called feminist future. But theirs is built on phrases emanating from past activism and gender politics, co-opted by both politicians and the fashion industry. The daily reports of dowry deaths and simultaneous calls for “Beti Bachao Beti Padhao” make for uneasy partners, as do the linking of beauty-enhancement creams with “self-esteem”. This has produced massive misunderstandings over older feminist concepts. Cosmetic surgery,

injecting botox or silicone gel to lift sagging skin, is now labelled professional beauty enhancement. If it fails to hide what was to be hidden, it is described as beauty’s defiance of patriarchy. All this is creating what two octogenarian feminists had foretold: “Tyrannies of social expectation” (Gloria Steinem) and “the chrysalis of conditioning” (Germaine Greer).

The term “ageism” was originally coined to mark the social value denied to women past their prime. It surfaces frequently at these global galas. But truth be told, how many women past 60 figure in media-led feminist discourses on fashion and beauty? How much do we get to hear of their fear of disease and dependency after crossing 70?

The next real wave of liberation will have to be rooted in a collective idea of self-esteem among women of all ages, classes, castes, and communities. It’s time branded concepts of *shakti*, ageism, and *saas/bahu* attitudes were replaced with new phrases created out of fresh insights. When beauty contestants and all women past their prime feel free to talk collectively about ageing, the fears of not retaining their looks eternally, and how much it has cost them throughout their lives, a truly new power base will be created. Who knows, it may go on to spur a new socio-political movement towards equality. Some may lose their present power and constant media attention, but all of us stand to gain.

The writer is former chairperson, Prasar Bharati

Missing in India’s heat action plans: What to wear

stress. In extreme conditions, this is not about discomfort. It is about bodily strain.

India’s heatwaves are becoming longer and more intense, and temperatures remain elevated after sunset. This matters because the body depends on cooler nights to recover from daytime heat exposure. When that recovery window disappears, heat stress accumulates. Under such conditions, what people wear shapes how much strain the body absorbs. Yet clothing is almost entirely absent from India’s heat action plans.

This gap is especially visible in institutional settings. Schoolchildren wear uniforms. Factory workers follow dress codes. Delivery personnel, security guards, and construction labourers operate in standardised clothing systems shaped by cost, durability, and visibility. In these contexts, fabric

and design are rarely chosen for thermal performance. They can intensify exposure.

Over the past two decades, mass clothing systems in India have become increasingly dependent on synthetic fibres, particularly polyester blends. They are cheap, durable, and easy to maintain. But these materials are often less breathable than natural fibres and can trap heat and moisture, especially in humid conditions where evaporative cooling is already compromised.

India is one of the world’s largest textile producers. Yet in the sectors where heat ex-

The question now is not only how we cool our cities, but how we enable the human body to endure

posure is most acute — schools, informal labour, public-facing work — clothing systems remain disconnected from climatic realities.

This is a policy gap. Policy frameworks rarely engage with clothing as a factor in heat exposure. There are no widely enforced guidelines for summer-appropriate school uniforms. Occupational safety protocols emphasise hydration and rest breaks but seldom incorporate fabric performance. Public procurement prioritises cost and durability, with little regard for breathability.

This omission is increasingly untenable. Heat stress already reduces labour productivity. As temperatures rise, these losses will deepen. There is also an energy cost. As clothing fails to support natural cooling, reliance on air conditioning increases, placing additional strain on power systems.

A more responsive approach would begin by recognising clothing as part of climate adaptation infrastructure. School uniform policies can incorporate breathable fabrics and climate-responsive design. Occupational standards can include textile performance in heat exposure guidelines. Public procurement can factor in thermal comfort alongside durability and cost. Textile innovation can be directed towards heat-resilient garments for mass use.

The question now is no longer only how we cool our cities, but how we enable the human body to endure. In that equation, the first layer of adaptation is not air conditioning. It is the fabric on the skin.

The writer is associate professor and programme coordinator for fashion design at IILM University, Gurugram

There’s a fire in my neighbourhood, and a world away



AAKASH JOSHI

THERE IS a fire in my neighbourhood. But is it really my neighbourhood? The Hauz Rani *gali*, where at least 21 people have already died, is across the road from Saket, from Press Enclave, where I was born and live. The hotel that caught fire is next to where our general store was, where Babli *bhalya* would give us an extra chocolate, or candied cigarettes on credit. About 20 metres down the street is Adam’s Hair Salon, where Rashid *bhai* takes a razor to my throat once a week, as we discuss our life and times. It is where, after a game of cricket, we would get either bread-omelette or pastries. And where, as teenagers, we took furtive drags from our first clandestine cigarettes (not made of candy, but just as sweet).

But, for all the intimacies that remain, the road that divides Saket and Hauz Rani, the upper middle class and their civic experience from the working people that make it possible, has hardened into a border. And in that line is the tale of what is broken in our cities.

The dichotomy in the “development” of the Hauz Rani-Khirki belt in Malviya Nagar frames both the potential of Delhi — and India — as a cosmopolitan, global space and the tragic failure of governments and people towards that end.

More than the glitzy malls a kilometre away in Saket or the unaffordable eateries at the Eldeco complex, it is in the semi-legal, overcrowded, and unpretentious areas of Malviya Nagar that Delhi is the most global. Medical tourists (the gigantic Max Hospital complex is across the road) and some refugees from all over West Asia and beyond occupy many of the small apartments. African students and workers, many of them Muslim, have told me in the past that it is one of the few areas where they are given accommodation, and feel a sense of community. Scores of people who work in the homes of their neighbours across the road also rent rooms here.

The marketplace has responded to this diversity. Restaurants serving Afghan, Yemeni, Iraqi, and a host of other cuisines rise and fall. Search Instagram, and you’ll see yuppie influencers telling you about “food walks”. Small tailors and clothes shops carry the fashions favoured by the diverse clientele. Chemists offer discounts to medical tourists. And there are artists’ collectives and studios at the cutting edge of creativity.

But if the streets show you diversity, they are also proof of apathy. In the last two decades and more, a metro station has emerged, as has a world-class hospital. But the *galis* themselves have become more congested. The lane that was ablaze often floods, sometimes with rainwater but most times with a sourceless puddle that smells suspiciously like sewage. Open wires form the canopy between buildings, and on a sunny day, there is an oddly beautiful dapple on shop fronts that are now stained with smoke. The sheer lack of space and light between rooms and in them tells you the story of a government that has not paid attention for a long time.

Now, as the death toll climbs, there will be the predictable conversation around “accountability”. The hotel owner(s) will have the rulebook thrown at them. Perhaps the small shops will all be taken to task for not being up to code by the civic authorities, trying to show they are competent, after the fact. Many will bay for blood. But few of us will look at ourselves.

The road that divides Press Enclave-Max Hospital, the malls, and Hauz Rani-Khirki-Malviya Nagar was once more porous, physically and metaphorically. The fence on the divider had several gaps, and we could just walk across. We bought our vegetables, meat, and groceries from there. Now, most people on the right side of the tracks order in, with quick commerce replacing human interaction. The gaps have been blocked, the divider raised so that it is difficult for most people to cross over. Most of my friends no longer go to our Hauz Rani barber for a Rs 100 haircut-and-shave. The people who have to go back and forth every day — domestic workers, mostly — have no voice or power to change this. And the MLAs, corporators, councillors, politicians and journalists are more likely to listen to a debate about stray dogs and cats in a colony than a broken civic architecture.

Imagine, for a moment, if our neighbourhoods were more organic, more connected. Where Hauz Rani and Khirki were not merely places we visit as tourists to try out an exotic cuisine, but as people with stakes in a place. If the privileged spoke for their cities, not just their gated colonies, it is perhaps more likely that governments would take public housing and cheaper, planned markets and hotels seriously. And maybe we would elect leaders who don’t demonise either the people who live there or the “foreigners” here to learn and work.

Of course, that’s just a dream, a fantasy of a childhood that looks better than it was. Reality will see performative outrage, as it always does. Sometimes, that’s easier than crossing a road.

The writer is deputy associate editor, The Indian Express. aakash.joshi@expressindia.com

CHA₂DS₂-VASc Score: Strengths & Limitations



Dr. Aparna Jaiswal
Electrophysiologist, South Delhi

The CHA₂DS₂-VASc score remains the cornerstone for stroke risk stratification in NVAf, guiding anticoagulation decisions globally. Its strength lies in simplicity and strong validation across diverse populations. By incorporating clinical variables —

congestive heart failure, hypertension, age, diabetes, stroke history, vascular disease, and sex—it provides a practical bedside tool.

Importantly, it identifies truly low-risk patients (score 0 in men, 1 in women), where anticoagulation may be deferred. It also improves upon the older CHADS₂ score by better discriminating intermediate-risk individuals.

However, limitations exist. The score treats risk factors as binary, ignoring severity and control (e.g., well-controlled vs uncontrolled hypertension). It also lacks incorporation of dynamic variables such as AF burden, biomarkers, or imaging findings like atrial fibrosis.

Another challenge is modest predictive accuracy at the individual level. Patients with identical scores may have differing stroke risks. Additionally, the role of female sex as an independent risk modifier remains debated, particularly in younger women without other risk factors.

Despite these limitations, CHA₂DS₂-VASc remains central to decision-making. Future directions include integrating it with biomarkers and digital monitoring data to enhance precision. Until then, clinical judgment must complement scoring systems, especially in borderline cases.

CHA2DS2-VASc Score Calculator	
Score	Risk Group
0 points (male)	Low risk
1 point (male)	Moderate risk
2-3 points (any sex)	High risk



Recurrent Stroke Prevention in NVAf



Dr. Nityanand Tripathi
Electrophysiologist, North Delhi

Secondary prevention of stroke in NVAf is a clinical priority, given the high risk of recurrence and associated morbidity. Anticoagulation remains the cornerstone of therapy.

DOACs have become the preferred option due to their favorable safety profile and reduced risk of intracranial hemorrhage compared to warfarin. Ensuring adherence is critical, as interruptions significantly increase stroke risk.

In selected patients with contraindi-

cations to long-term anticoagulation, left atrial appendage closure offers an alternative strategy.

Risk factor management is equally important. Control of hypertension, diabetes, and lifestyle factors reduces overall cardiovascular risk.

Post-stroke patients require careful evaluation for AF, including prolonged monitoring to detect paroxysmal episodes.

A multidisciplinary approach involving neurologists and cardiologists is essential for optimal outcomes.

Gender Differences in Stroke Risk

Gender differences in atrial fibrillation and stroke risk have important clinical implications. Women with AF are generally at higher risk of stroke compared to men, particularly in older age groups.

The inclusion of female sex in the CHA₂DS₂-VASc score reflects this observation, though its role as an independent risk factor remains debated. Evidence suggests that female sex acts more as a risk modifier, amplifying risk in the presence of other comorbidities. Biological factors may contribute



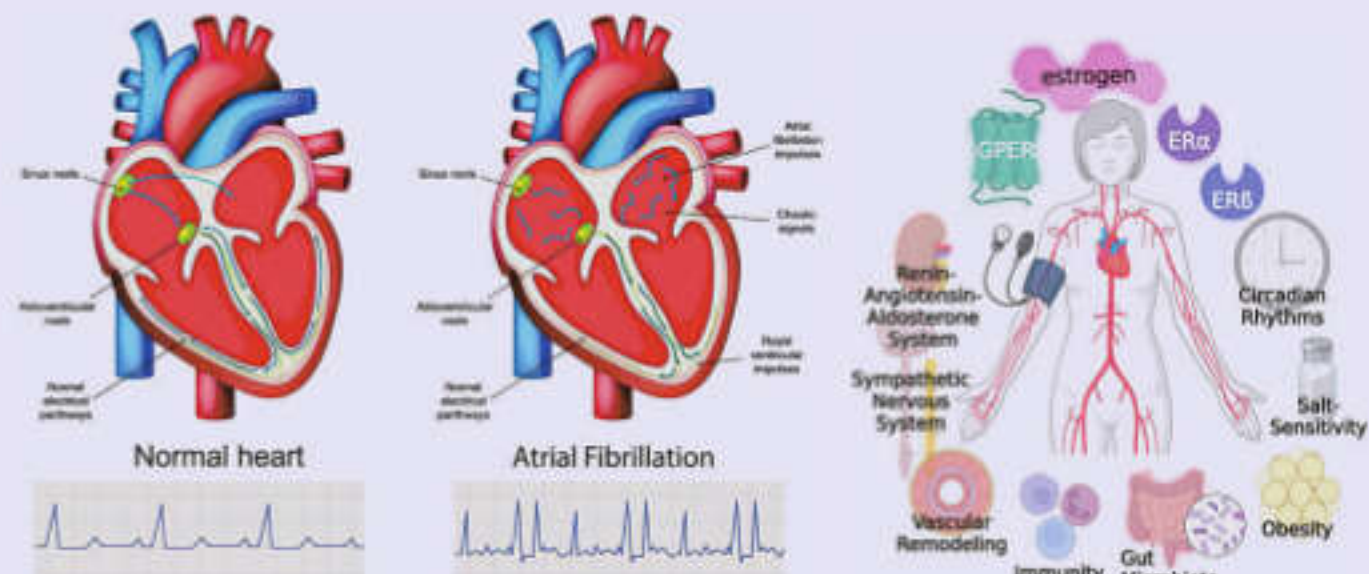
Dr. Gaurav Minocha
Cardiologist, East Delhi

to this disparity. Hormonal influences, differences in vascular biology, and a higher prevalence of certain comorbidities (e.g.,

hypertension) may play roles. Additionally, women often present later in the disease course and may receive less aggressive treatment.

There is also evidence of undertreatment, with women less likely to receive anticoagulation or rhythm control interventions compared to men.

Understanding these differences is critical for equitable care. Clinicians should ensure appropriate risk assessment and avoid underestimating stroke risk in female patients.



Lifestyle Risk Factors (Obesity, Alcohol, Sleep Apnea)



Dr. Ashwani Mehta
Cardiologist, Central Delhi

Lifestyle factors play a critical and modifiable role in the development and progression of NVAf. Among these, obesity, alcohol consumption, and obstructive sleep apnea (OSA) are particularly signi-

ficant.

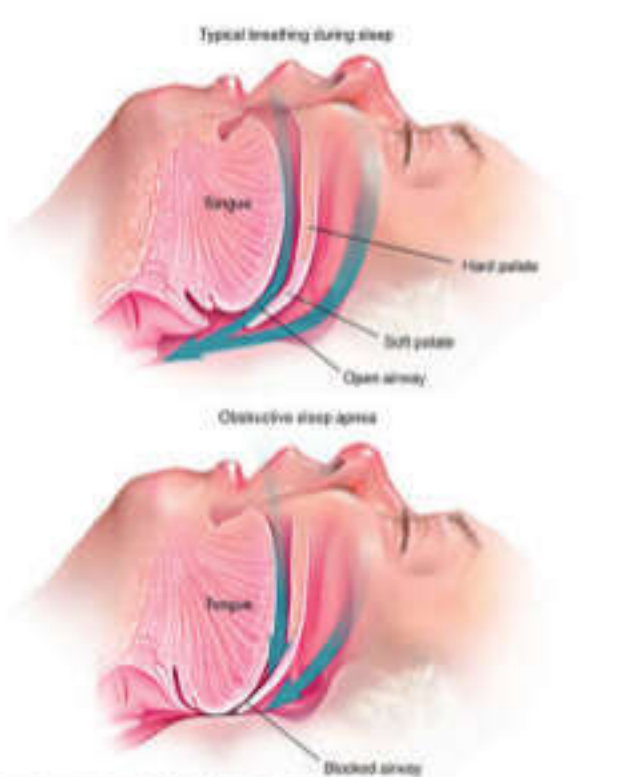
Obesity contributes to AF through multiple mechanisms, including increased atrial size, inflammation, and autonomic dysfunction. Epicardial fat secretes pro-inflammatory cytokines, promoting atrial remodeling. Weight reduction has been shown to significantly decrease AF burden and improve outcomes post-ablation.

Alcohol intake, especially in excess, is a well-known trigger for AF - often referred to as "holiday heart syndrome." Chronic alcohol use leads to direct myocardial toxicity, oxidative stress, and electrical instability. Even moderate consumption may increase AF risk in susceptible individuals.

OSA is highly prevalent in AF patients and is often underdiagnosed. Repeated episodes of hypoxia and negative intrathoracic pressure lead to atrial stretch, inflammation, and autonomic imbalance. Continuous positive airway pressure (CPAP) therapy has been shown to reduce AF recurrence.

These lifestyle factors often coexist, compounding their effects. Importantly, they represent actionable targets for intervention.

Comprehensive AF management should include structured lifestyle modification programs. Addressing these factors not only reduces AF incidence but also enhances the efficacy of pharmacological and interventional therapies.



Stroke Risk in Low-Score Patients



Dr. Pradeep Kumar Nayak
Cardiologist, East Delhi

Patients with low CHA₂DS₂-VASc scores are traditionally considered at minimal risk for stroke, yet emerging evidence suggests that risk is not negligible. Even individuals with scores of 0-1 may experience thromboembolic events, particularly in the presence of additional non-included risk factors.

Subclinical factors such as atrial fibrosis, left atrial enlargement, and high AF burden may contribute to stroke risk

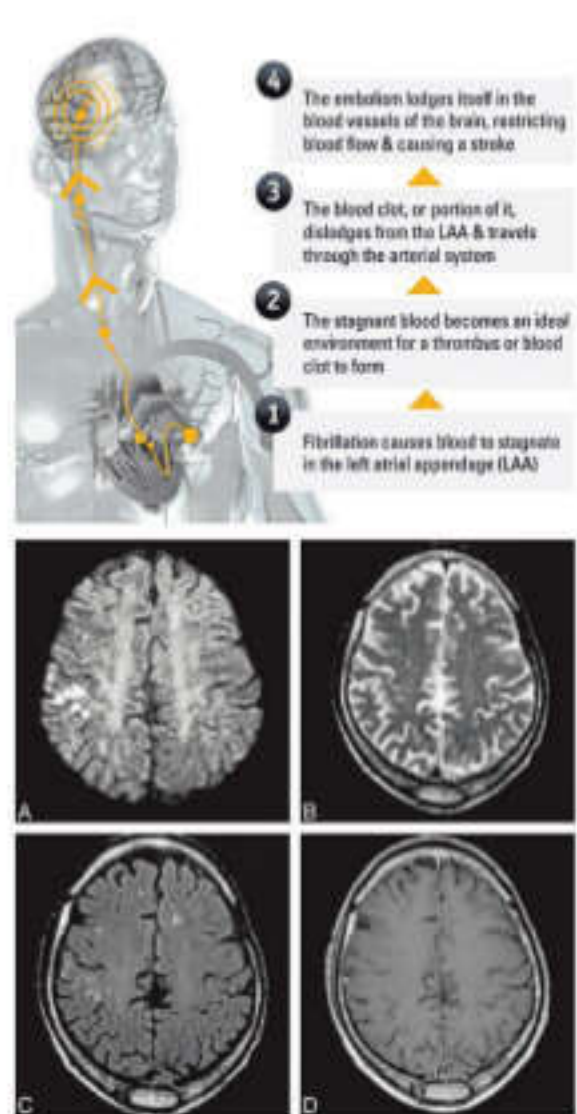
independent of traditional scoring systems. Imaging modalities like cardiac MRI and advanced echocardiography can identify these high-risk features.

Additionally, lifestyle and metabolic factors—such as obesity, sleep apnea, and systemic inflammation—may elevate risk but are not captured in standard scores.

Device-detected AF has further complicated risk assessment. Short, asymptomatic episodes may still carry thromboembolic potential, challenging the notion of "low-risk" patients.

Clinical decision-making in this group requires careful individualization. While routine anticoagulation is not recommended, close monitoring and periodic reassessment are essential.

Future strategies may incorporate imaging and biomarker data to better identify truly low-risk individuals versus those who may benefit from early intervention.



Natural History of Untreated NVAf



Dr. Dheeraj Kumar Gandotra
Electrophysiologist, Central Delhi

The natural history of untreated NVAf is characterized by progressive atrial remodeling, increasing symptom burden, and a rising risk of complications.

AF often begins as paroxysmal episodes that are self-terminating. Over time, these episodes become more frequent and prolonged, eventually progressing to persistent and permanent AF. This progression is driven by ongoing

electrical and structural remodeling.

One of the most serious consequences of untreated AF is stroke. The risk increases significantly over time, particularly in patients with additional risk factors. Without anticoagulation, stroke risk can be substantial and often results in severe disability or death.

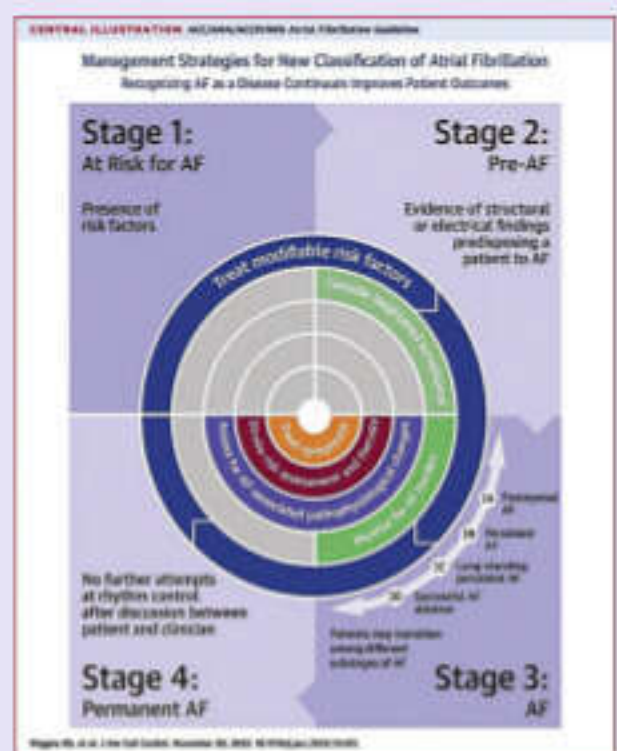
AF is also associated with heart failure, either as a cause or consequence. Rapid ventricular rates can lead to tachycardia-induced cardiomyopathy, while loss of atrial contraction impairs cardiac output.

Quality of life deteriorates due to symptoms such as palpitations, fatigue, and reduced exercise tolerance. Additionally, AF is associated with increased mortality.

Early diagnosis and intervention are crucial to altering this trajectory. Anticoagulation, rate or rhythm control,

and risk factor modification can significantly improve outcomes.

Understanding the natural history emphasizes the importance of timely and comprehensive management in NVAf patients.



Left Atrial Appendage Morphology & Risk

The left atrial appendage (LAA) is the primary site of thrombus formation in NVAf, and its morphology significantly influences stroke risk.

Imaging studies have identified distinct LAA shapes—such as chicken wing, cactus, windsock, and cauliflower—each associated with varying thromboembolic risk. Non-chicken wing morphologies are generally linked to higher risk.



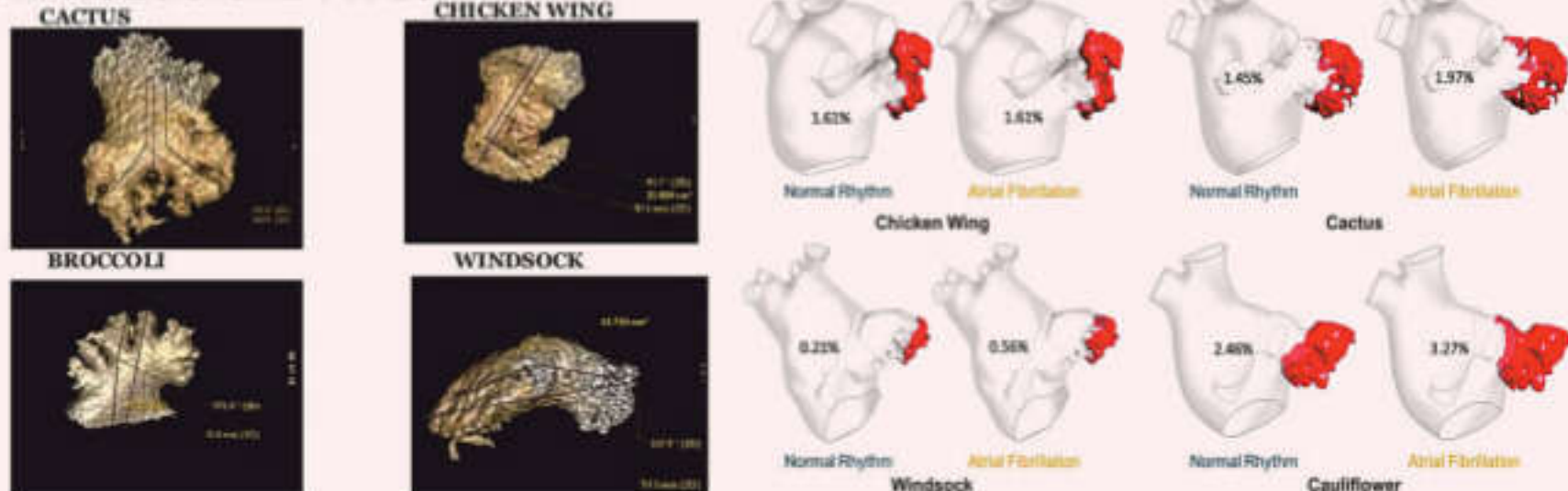
Dr. Pradeep Kumar Rustagi
Cardiologist, North Delhi

Complex anatomy, reduced flow velocities, and trabeculations contribute to blood stasis and thrombus formation.

Transesophageal echocardiography (TEE) remains the gold standard for LAA assessment, while cardiac CT provides detailed anatomical visualization.

Understanding LAA morphology may aid in risk stratification and guide decisions regarding anticoagulation or device closure.

4 MORPHOLOGICAL TYPES



Genetic Predisposition in Atrial Fibrillation



Dr. Ajay Kumar Sharma
Cardiologist, Central Delhi

its relevance in AF pathogenesis.

Other genes implicated include those encoding ion channels (e.g., KCNQ1, SCN5A), gap junction proteins, and structural components of the myocardium. Mutations in these genes can alter atrial conduction and refractoriness, predisposing to arrhythmia.

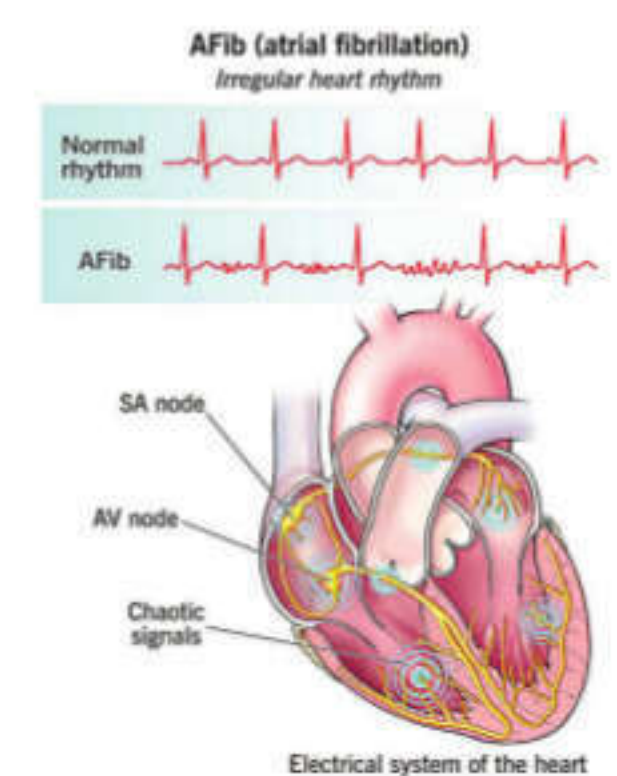
Familial AF, though relatively rare, underscores the importance of inherited risk. First-degree relatives of AF patients have a significantly increased likelihood of developing the condition.

Beyond monogenic mutations, polygenic risk scores are emerging as tools to identify individuals at higher risk. These may eventually guide screening and preventive strategies.

Gene-environment interactions are also crucial. Genetic susceptibility often manifests in the presence of modifiable risk factors such as hypertension or obesity.

While genetic testing is not yet routine in

clinical practice, it holds promise for personalized medicine. Future applications may include risk stratification, targeted therapies, and improved prediction of treatment response, particularly in electrophysiological interventions.



Imaging-Based Stroke Risk Assessment



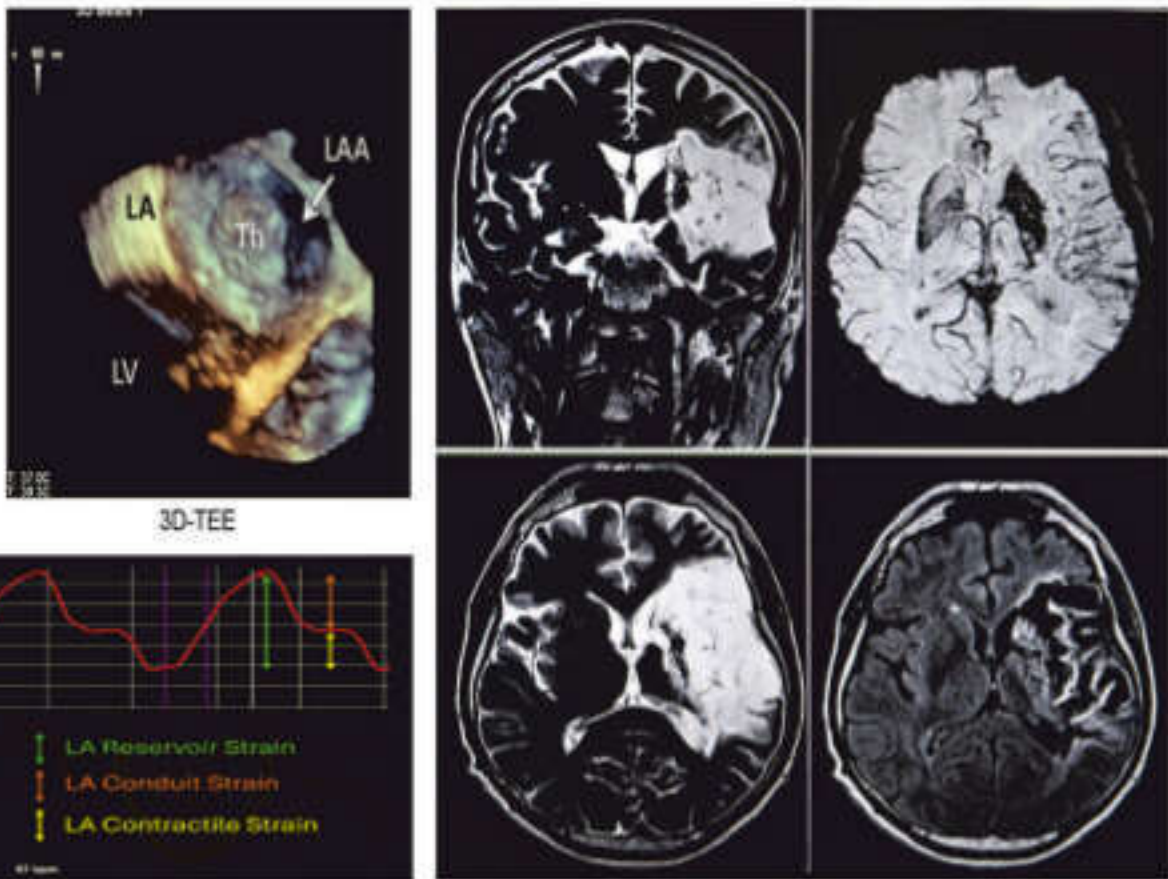
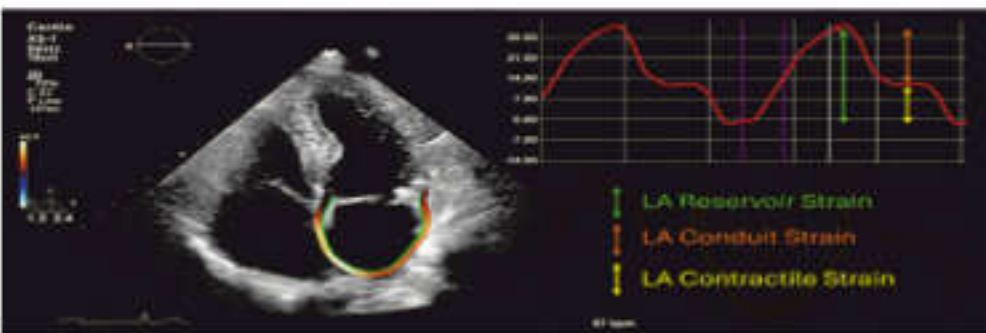
Dr. Sameena Khalil
Cardiologist, South Delhi

Advanced imaging techniques are increasingly used to refine stroke risk assessment in NVAf. These modalities provide structural and functional insights beyond clinical scores.

Cardiac MRI can quantify atrial fibrosis

using late gadolinium enhancement, which correlates with AF burden and stroke risk. Echocardiography assesses left atrial size, function, and strain, offering additional prognostic information.

TEE is essential for detecting LAA thrombus and assessing flow velocities. These tools may help identify high-risk patients who would benefit from more aggressive intervention, even if traditional scores suggest lower risk.



Stroke Risk Post-Ablation

Catheter ablation is an effective rhythm control strategy, but it does not eliminate stroke risk entirely. Even in patients with successful ablation and apparent sinus rhythm maintenance, thromboembolic risk persists.

Current guidelines recommend continuing



Dr. Arvind Dambalkar
Cardiologist, Faridabad

anticoagulation based on CHA₂DS₂-VASc score rather than procedural success alone. This is due to the possibility of asymptomatic AF recurrence & persistent atrial dysfunction.

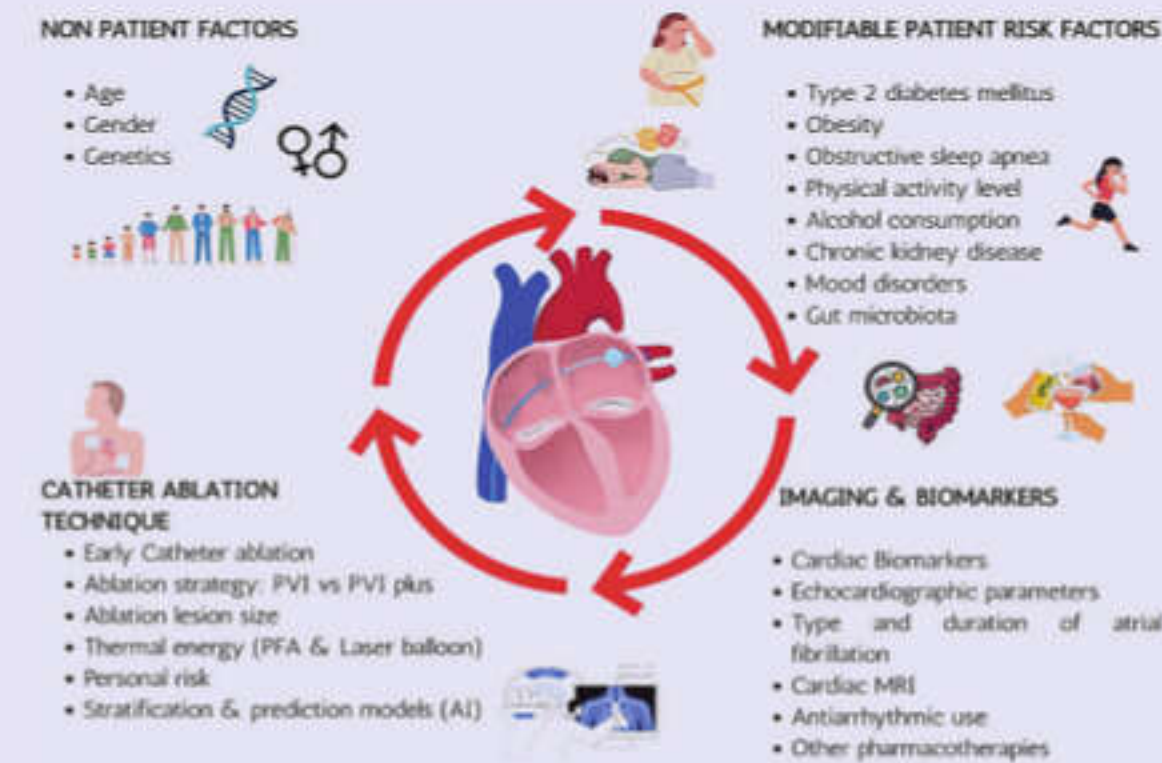
Careful follow-up with rhythm monitoring is essential to detect recurrence.



Research for Better Medicines

— Public Awareness Initiative —

Role of Biomarkers in Stroke Prediction



Dr. Dheeraj Garg
Cardiologist, East Delhi

Biomarkers are emerging as valuable adjuncts in refining stroke risk prediction in NVAf beyond traditional clinical scores. They reflect underlying pathophysiological processes such as myocardial stress,

inflammation, and endothelial dysfunction.

Cardiac biomarkers like NT-proBNP are particularly informative, indicating atrial stretch and hemodynamic stress. Elevated levels correlate strongly with stroke risk and AF burden. Similarly, troponin levels, even when mildly elevated, may indicate subclinical myocardial injury and increased thromboembolic risk.

Inflammatory markers such as CRP and IL-6 provide insight into systemic inflammation, which contributes to atrial remodeling & thrombogenesis. Elevated levels have been associated with higher AF recurrence and stroke risk.

Coagulation markers, including D-dimer, reflect ongoing thrombotic activity and may identify patients at higher risk despite low CHA₂DS₂-VASc scores.

Integration of biomarkers into risk models (e.g., ABC stroke score-Age, Biomarkers, Clinical history) has shown improved predictive accuracy compared to traditional scoring systems.

However, challenges remain, including variability in assay availability, cost, and lack of standardized thresholds. Biomarkers are not yet routine in clinical practice but represent a promising step toward personalized risk stratification.



AF Burden and Stroke Correlation

AF burden refers to the duration and frequency of atrial fibrillation episodes and is increasingly recognized as an important factor in stroke risk assessment.

Traditionally, AF has been treated as a binary condition—present or absent. However, emerging evidence suggests that stroke risk correlates with AF burden, particularly in patients with subclinical or device-detected AF.

Studies using implantable devices have shown that even brief episodes of AF can increase thromboembolic risk, although the threshold duration remains uncertain.



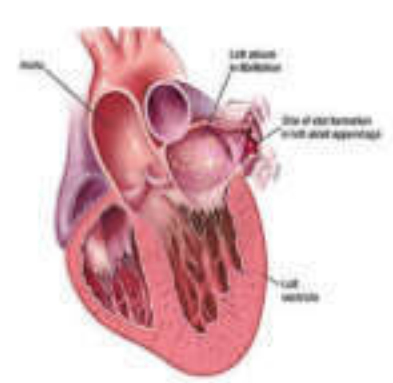
Dr. Yogendra Singh Rajput
Cardiologist, Gurugram

Longer and more frequent episodes are generally associated with higher risk.

The underlying mechanism involves atrial stasis and thrombus formation, particularly in the left atrial appendage. Increased AF burden leads to more sustained periods of impaired atrial contraction, promoting clot formation.

Despite these insights, current guidelines still base anticoagulation decisions primarily on clinical risk scores rather than AF burden alone.

Future strategies may incorporate continuous monitoring data to refine risk stratification and personalize therapy. This represents a shift toward precision medicine in AF management.



Epidemiology of NVAf in India vs Global Trends



Dr. Virbhan Balai
Cardiologist, West Delhi

Non-valvular atrial fibrillation (NVAf) represents the most common sustained arrhythmia worldwide, with prevalence rising steadily due to aging populations and improved survival from cardiovascular diseases. Globally, AF affects approximately 2–4% of adults, with projections suggesting a doubling in prevalence by 2050. NVAf constitutes

the majority of these cases, as rheumatic valvular disease declines in developed regions.

In India, the epidemiological profile differs significantly. While overall AF prevalence appears lower (~0.5–1%), this likely reflects underdiagnosis and limited screening infrastructure. Importantly, Indian patients tend to present nearly a decade earlier than Western populations, often in their 50s and 60s. This earlier onset is driven by a high burden of hypertension, diabetes, coronary artery disease, and untreated sleep apnea.

Urbanization has further accelerated risk factor clustering, contributing to a rising NVAf burden in metropolitan areas. Meanwhile, rural populations remain underdiagnosed due to limited access to ECG monitoring and cardiology care. Another notable

distinction is the coexistence of residual rheumatic disease, complicating classification.

Stroke risk in Indian NVAf patients is substantial and often under-recognized, with lower rates of anticoagulation compared to global standards. Registries highlight a significant treatment gap, particularly in the use of DOACs.

From a public health standpoint, India is likely on the cusp of a major AF epidemic. Early screening, risk factor modification, and improved access to anticoagulation are critical to mitigating future stroke burden. Understanding these regional differences is essential for tailoring guideline implementation and therapeutic strategies.

Silent AF and Its Clinical Implications



Dr. Vaibhav Jain
Cardiologist, Gurugram

Silent or asymptomatic atrial fibrillation represents a significant clinical challenge, as it often goes undetected until complications such as stroke occur.

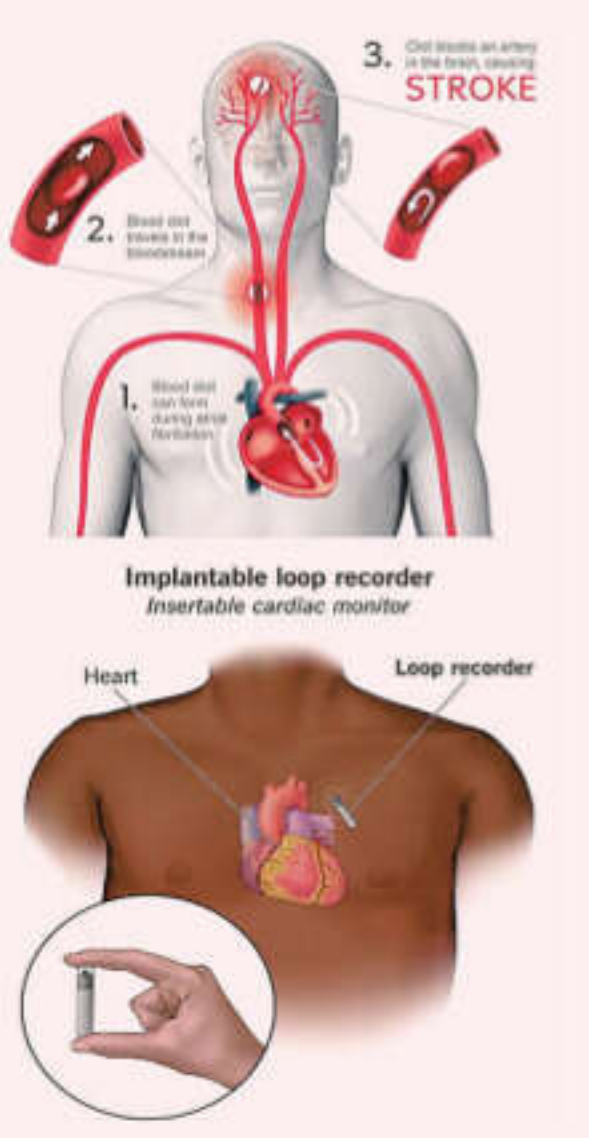
Studies suggest that a substantial proportion of AF episodes are asymptomatic, particularly in elderly patients. These episodes may be identified incidentally through routine ECGs, wearable devices, or implantable monitors.

Despite the absence of symptoms, silent AF carries a similar risk of thromboembolism as symptomatic AF. This underscores the importance of early detection and appropriate anticoagulation.

Technological advancements have improved detection rates. Wearable devices and mobile health applications now enable continuous rhythm monitoring, facilitating early diagnosis.

Screening high-risk populations—such as elderly individuals or those with hypertension and diabetes—has been shown to increase AF detection and reduce stroke incidence.

Clinicians should maintain a high index of suspicion, particularly in patients with cryptogenic stroke. Extended monitoring may reveal previously undiagnosed AF, guiding secondary prevention strategies. Silent AF highlights the need for proactive screening and a shift toward preventive cardiology.



Pathophysiology of Atrial Remodeling in NVAf



Dr. J.S. Khatri
Cardiologist, West Delhi

Atrial fibrillation is fundamentally a disease of atrial remodeling, encompassing electrical, structural, and contractile changes. These processes create a substrate that sustains arrhythmia and promotes its progression from paroxysmal to persistent forms. Electrical remodeling occurs rapidly, often within hours of AF onset. It is characterized by shortening of the

atrial effective refractory period due to altered ion channel expression, particularly reduced L-type calcium current. This facilitates re-entry circuits, allowing AF to perpetuate itself—captured in the concept “AF begets AF.”

Structural remodeling evolves over weeks to months and involves atrial dilation and fibrosis. Fibroblast activation, collagen deposition, and extracellular matrix expansion disrupt normal conduction pathways, promoting conduction heterogeneity. Fibrosis is strongly associated with AF persistence and poor ablation outcomes.

Inflammation and oxidative stress play pivotal roles in driving these changes. Elevated inflammatory markers such as CRP & interleukins correlate with AF burden. Addi-

tionally, neurohormonal activation, particularly via the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system (RAAS), contributes to fibrosis and remodeling.

Contractile dysfunction is another key component, resulting in reduced atrial transport function and stasis within the left atrial appendage, increasing thromboembolic risk.

Understanding atrial remodeling is critical for therapeutic intervention. Early rhythm control strategies may prevent irreversible structural changes, while upstream therapies targeting fibrosis and inflammation offer emerging opportunities to modify disease progression.

The Impact of Caffeine on Atrial Fibrillation



Dr. Sanjay Sharma
Cardiologist, Noida

For decades, patients diagnosed with Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF) were routinely told to give up their morning coffee. The logic seemed sound: caffeine is a

stimulant that raises the heart rate, so it must naturally trigger an irregular rhythm. However, modern research has largely debunked this "all-or-nothing" approach, offering a more nuanced view for coffee lovers.

Large-scale population studies have surprisingly shown that moderate caffeine consumption (about 2 to 3 cups of coffee per day) does not increase the risk of developing NVAF. In some cases, caffeine may even have mild antioxidant properties that are protective for the heart. For many patients, caffeine does not act as

a direct trigger for an AFib episode.

However, "moderate" is the keyword. High doses of caffeine, such as those found in concentrated energy drinks or excessive amounts of espresso, can lead to palpitations & increased blood pressure, which may push a vulnerable heart into an irregular rhythm. Furthermore, every patient's sensitivity is different. While one person can enjoy a latte with no issues, another may find that the slightest bit of caffeine makes their heart feel "jittery" or prone

to fluttering.

The best approach for an NVAF patient is self-observation. If you notice a direct correlation between caffeine intake and the onset of symptoms, it is wise to switch to decaf or reduce your intake. It is also important to consider what you add to your caffeine; high-sugar creamers and syrups can cause blood sugar spikes that stress the heart more than the caffeine itself. In short, while you may not need to banish coffee entirely, listening to your body's specific reaction is the most reliable guide.

Yoga and Mindfulness for Arrhythmia Control

In recent years, clinical studies have highlighted yoga as a surprisingly effective complementary therapy for Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF).

Unlike high-intensity workouts that might stress a sensitive heart, yoga combines gentle physical movement with controlled breathing and mindfulness, specifically targeting the balance of the autonomic nervous system.

The "Yoga MyHeart" study found that patients who practiced yoga twice a week experienced significantly fewer AFib episodes and lower levels of anxiety and depression compared to those who did not. The benefit likely comes from the focus on the breath. Slow, rhythmic breathing helps move the body from a sympathetic (stressed)

state to a parasympathetic (relaxed) state. This shift can lower the heart rate and reduce the "electrical noise" in the atria that leads to fibrillation.

Mindfulness—the practice of staying present and observing sensations without judgment—is equally valuable. It helps patients manage the "anticipatory anxiety" of wondering when the next episode will happen. By staying grounded, patients can often navigate an AFib

episode with less panic, which may even help the heart convert back to a normal rhythm more quickly. Integrating these practices into a weekly routine offers a non-invasive, low-risk way to enhance medical treatments and improve your overall quality of life with NVAF.



Dr. Sujeet Narain
Cardiologist, Noida

Alcohol and NVAF: Understanding "Holiday Heart Syndrome"



Dr. Dharendra Singhania
Cardiologist, Ghaziabad

The relationship between alcohol & Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF) is one of the most well-documented lifestyle links in cardiology. Even in individuals with no history of heart disease, excessive alcohol consumption can trigger a sudden episode of AFib, a phenomenon famously dubbed "Holiday Heart Syndrome." This term was coined because emergency rooms often see a spike in

arrhythmia cases following holidays or weekends associated with heavy drinking.

Alcohol affects the heart in several ways that promote NVAF. First, it acts as a direct toxin to the heart's muscle cells, potentially altering the electrical properties of the atria. Second, alcohol can stimulate the autonomic nervous system, which controls heart rate, leading to sudden spikes that "trip" the heart out of its normal rhythm. Furthermore, alcohol is a diuretic, which can lead to dehydration and the loss of essential electrolytes like magnesium and potassium—minerals that are vital for maintaining electrical stability in the heart.

Recent studies have shown that even moderate, regular

drinking (as few as seven drinks per week) can increase the risk of AFib recurrence. For patients who have undergone procedures like catheter ablation, continuing to drink alcohol can significantly decrease the likelihood of the procedure's long-term success.

While many heart-healthy guidelines suggest a glass of red wine may be beneficial for the arteries, this does not necessarily apply to the electrical system of the heart in NVAF patients. For many, the safest "dose" of alcohol is none at all, or at the very least, strict moderation. Discussing your specific triggers with a doctor is essential, as some patients find that even a single drink can initiate a multi-hour episode of palpitations.

Thyroid Disorders and Heart Rhythm Outbursts



Dr. Aayush Goyal
CTVS, Ghaziabad

The thyroid gland acts as the body's primary thermostat, regulating metabolism and energy use. When the thyroid produces too much hormone (hyperthyroidism), it essentially puts the entire body—including the heart—into overdrive. This metabolic

surge is a classic and potent trigger for Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF).

Excess thyroid hormone increases the sensitivity of the heart to adrenaline. This makes the heart beat faster and more forcefully, but it also makes the electrical cells in the atria "irritable." This irritability often manifests as paroxysmal AFib. In many cases, an unexplained first episode of AFib is the very first clue that a patient has an overactive thyroid. Conversely, an underactive thyroid (hypothyroidism) can also contribute to heart issues, though it is less commonly a direct cause of AFib

than hyperthyroidism.

Because of this strong connection, a blood test to check Thyroid Stimulating Hormone (TSH) levels is a standard part of every NVAF diagnostic workup. If a thyroid imbalance is found, treating the thyroid issue with medication, radioactive iodine, or surgery can often cause the AFib to disappear entirely. If you have been diagnosed with NVAF, it is important to have your thyroid levels checked periodically, as keeping your metabolism stable is a key component of keeping your heart rhythm steady.

Hypertension: The Number One Driver of NVAF



Dr. Manoj Kumar Sharma
Cardiologist, Noida

Hypertension, or high blood pressure, is the single most common risk factor for developing Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF). While aging and genetics play their parts, chronically elevated blood pressure acts as a cons-

tant mechanical stressor on the heart's anatomy. When the heart has to pump against high pressure in the arteries, the pressure inside the left atrium rises significantly.

Over several years, this internal pressure causes the thin walls of the atrium to stretch, enlarge, & eventually develop microscopic scarring. This "remodeling" disrupts the heart's electrical pathways, creating the perfect environment for the chaotic signals of AFib to take root. For patients already diagnosed with NVAF, uncontrolled hypertension makes episodes more frequent

and harder to stop.

The good news is that blood pressure is manageable. Clinical guidelines suggest that for NVAF patients, maintaining a blood pressure below 130/80 mmHg is ideal. Managing salt intake, exercising, and strictly adhering to prescribed antihypertensive medications can actually slow down the structural changes in the heart. By controlling the pressure, you reduce the physical "stretch" on your atria, which is often the most effective way to keep your heart in a normal, steady rhythm.

Hydration and Electrolytes: Magnesium and Potassium



Dr. Partha Prateem Chowdhury
Cardiologist, Noida

The heart's electrical system relies on a delicate balance of minerals called electrolytes to function correctly. For patients with Non-Valvular Atrial

Fibrillation (NVAF), maintaining the right levels of magnesium and potassium is one of the most effective, yet under-discussed, ways to keep the heart in a normal rhythm.

Potassium and magnesium act as the "conductors" of the heart's electricity. Potassium helps the heart cells reset after each beat, while magnesium helps regulate the movement of other electrolytes across cell membranes. When these levels drop—even slightly—the heart becomes "irritable." This irritability makes it

much easier for a rogue electrical signal to trigger an AFib episode.

Dehydration is a common culprit for electrolyte imbalances. When you are dehydrated, your blood volume drops, and your heart has to work harder and beat faster to pump blood through the body. This extra strain, combined with the loss of minerals through sweat or diuretics (common blood pressure medications), can easily "trip" a patient into NVAF.

Many NVAF patients find that their episodes correlate with periods of poor hydration or low

mineral intake. While it is tempting to reach for supplements, it is vital to consult a doctor first, especially for potassium, as levels that are too high can be just as dangerous as levels that are too low. Instead, focus on a diet rich in these minerals: bananas, oranges, spinach, and potatoes for potassium; and nuts, seeds, dark chocolate, and leafy greens for magnesium. Staying consistently hydrated and ensuring your diet is mineral-dense provides a natural "buffer" that helps keep your heart's electrical system stable and resilient.

Weight Loss: The Most Effective Lifestyle Intervention

For patients with Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF) who are overweight, weight loss is not just a general health goal—it is a potent clinical treatment. Recent medical studies, such as the LEGACY trial, have demonstrated that significant, sustained weight loss can lead to a dramatic reduction in AFib symptoms and, in some cases, can even reverse the progression of the disease.

Obesity contributes to NVAF in several ways. Excess body fat, particularly around the mid-section, releases inflammatory markers that irritate the heart



Dr. Deepak Basia
Cardiologist, Modinagar (Ghaziabad)

tissue. Furthermore, carrying extra weight forces the heart to pump harder, leading to an enlarged left atrium. This stretching creates the "short circuits" necessary for AFib to thrive. Obesity is also the primary driver of obstructive sleep apnea, which is one of the strongest

triggers for an irregular heart-beat.

The data suggests that losing even 10% of your body weight can lead to a six-fold increase in the likelihood of remaining in a normal heart rhythm without the need for surgery or heavy medication. For many, weight loss improves the success rate of procedures like catheter ablation. By reducing the physical and inflammatory strain on the atria, weight loss treats the root cause of the arrhythmia rather than just masking the symptoms, offering a rare opportunity for patients to "self-treat" their condition.

Smoking Cessation as an NVAF Management Tool



Dr. Sugandha Gupta
Cardiologist, Noida

Smoking is one of the most potent, yet modifiable, risk factors for Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF). While most people associate smoking with lung cancer or clogged arteries, its impact on the heart's electrical system is equally devastating. For a patient already diagnosed with NVAF, continuing to smoke is akin

to pouring gasoline on a fire.

Nicotine is a powerful stimulant that immediately increases heart rate and blood pressure, creating an unstable environment for the atria. More significantly, the carbon monoxide and other toxins in cigarette smoke cause systemic inflammation and "oxidative stress." This leads to the scarring and stiffening of the heart tissue, known as fibrosis. As the atria become scarred, the electrical signals can no longer travel in a smooth, organized fashion, making NVAF episodes more frequent and harder to treat.

Research shows that smokers are twice as likely to develop AFib compared to non-smokers. For those already living with the

condition, smoking significantly increases the risk of the most feared complication: stroke. Smoking thickens the blood and damages the lining of the blood vessels, making it much easier for a clot to form and travel to the brain.

The good news is that the heart is remarkably resilient. Quitting smoking can slow the progression of atrial scarring and improve the effectiveness of rhythm-control medications and ablation procedures. Within just a few years of quitting, the excess risk of AFib begins to decline. Smoking cessation is not just a general health recommendation; it is a critical, foundational component of any successful NVAF management plan.

Blood Thinners in Older Adults: What You Should Know



Dr. Vikas Goyal
Cardiologist, Bhopal

Older adults are at higher risk of both stroke and bleeding, which can make treatment decisions seem difficult. However, studies clearly show that older patients benefit greatly from

blood thinners, as their risk of stroke is significantly higher. Modern blood thinners are often preferred because they are safer and easier to use. Even concerns like fall risk should not automatically stop treatment—because the risk of stroke is usually greater. The key is individualized care. Doctors consider overall health, kidney function, and lifestyle before choosing the right treatment. Family support, regular follow-up, and proper medication use can ensure safe and effective treatment.



When to Go to the Emergency Room with NVAF

While NVAF is often manageable, certain symptoms require immediate medical attention. Knowing when to seek emergency care can be life-saving. Patients should go to the emergency room if they experience severe chest pain, sudden shortness of breath, fainting, or symptoms of a stroke such as weakness on one side, difficulty speaking, or facial drooping. These may indicate serious complications like heart attack or stroke. A very rapid heart rate (especially above 150 beats per minute), persistent palpitations, or dizziness that does not resolve should also prompt urgent evaluation. These symptoms may indicate uncontrolled AFib or other dangerous arrhythmias.



Dr. Brijesh Srivastava
Cardiologist, Bhopal

Additionally, if a patient on anticoagulants experiences unusual bleeding—such as heavy nosebleeds, blood in urine, or black stools—they should seek immediate care. Early intervention can prevent complications & stabilize the condition. Emergency care may include medications to control heart rate or rhythm, or procedures like cardioversion. Patients with NVAF should be educated about warning signs and have a clear action plan. Keeping emergency contact numbers and medical history readily available can also help healthcare providers respond quickly. Prompt recognition and action can significantly improve outcomes in acute situations.



Palpitations Explained: What NVAF Feels Like



Dr. Abhishek Rathore
Electrophysiologist, Indore

Palpitations are one of the most common symptoms of NVAF and are often described as a sensation of a racing,

fluttering, or irregular heartbeat. Patients may feel as though their heart is “skipping beats” or beating out of rhythm. These sensations occur due to the irregular electrical activity in the atria, which leads to an inconsistent ventricular response. The intensity and frequency of palpitations can vary widely among individuals. Some people experience brief, occasional episodes, while

others have persistent symptoms. Palpitations may be triggered by stress, caffeine, alcohol, or physical exertion. In addition to palpitations, patients may feel fatigue, dizziness, or shortness of breath. However, some individuals may not notice any symptoms at all. It is important not to ignore palpitations, especially if they are new, frequent, or associated with other symptoms.

Medical evaluation, including ECG monitoring, is essential to determine the cause. Treatment focuses on controlling heart rate, restoring normal rhythm when possible, and preventing complications. Lifestyle modifications can also help reduce episodes. Understanding what palpitations feel like helps patients recognize early signs of NVAF and seek timely care.

Understanding Non-Valvular Atrial Fibrillation (NVAF): What It Is



Dr. Suyash M Tated
Cardiologist, Indore

Non-valvular atrial fibrillation (NVAF) is a common heart rhythm disorder where the upper chambers of the heart (atria) beat irregularly and often rapidly, without involvement of significant valve disease such as rheumatic mitral stenosis or mechanical heart valves. In NVAF, electrical signals in the atria

become chaotic, leading to ineffective contractions. As a result, blood may pool in the atria, increasing the risk of clot formation and stroke. NVAF differs from other types of atrial fibrillation because it is not primarily caused by structural valve abnormalities. Instead, it is often associated with conditions such as hypertension, diabetes, obesity, or aging. Many patients may not even realize they have NVAF, as symptoms can be mild or absent. Common symptoms include palpitations, fatigue, breathlessness, and dizziness. However, some individuals remain asymptomatic until complications like stroke occur. Diagnosis is usually made through an electroc-

ardiogram (ECG) or heart monitoring devices. The importance of identifying NVAF lies in its complications, particularly stroke. Blood clots formed in the atria can travel to the brain, causing serious damage. Therefore, treatment often focuses on preventing clot formation using anticoagulants and controlling heart rate or rhythm. Lifestyle changes such as managing blood pressure, reducing alcohol intake, and maintaining a healthy weight play a crucial role in managing NVAF. Early diagnosis and proper treatment significantly improve outcomes and quality of life.

From Blood Thinners of the Past to Today's Safer Options



Dr. Ankur Goel
Cardiac surgeon, Indore

Atrial fibrillation (AF) is a common heart rhythm problem that increases the risk of stroke. To reduce this risk, doctors prescribe “blood thinners,” which help prevent dangerous clots from forming in the heart. For many years, warfarin was the most commonly used blood thinner. While effective, it required frequent blood tests (INR checks), strict diet control, and careful monitoring because its effect could vary

widely. Today, newer medicines—called DOACs or NOACs—have made treatment simpler and safer. These include drugs like apixaban and rivaroxaban. They work in a more predictable way, so most patients do not need regular blood tests. They also have fewer food restrictions and lower risk of serious brain bleeding compared to older medicines. However, not every patient can switch to these newer drugs. Some people, especially those with artificial heart valves or certain valve diseases, may still need warfarin. If you have AF, the most important thing is not to avoid treatment out of fear. Stroke caused by AF can be severe and life-changing—but it is largely preventable with the right medication. Always talk to your doctor about which blood thinner is best for you. Taking it regularly, without missing doses, is key to staying protected.



Changing From One Blood Thinner to Another

Sometimes, your doctor may recommend changing your blood thinner. This could be due to side effects, convenience, cost, or better treatment options. Switching must be done carefully to avoid gaps in protection or increased bleeding risk. Doctors follow specific steps to ensure a smooth and safe transition.



Dr. Kshitiz Mavade
Cardiologist, Bhopal

For patients, the most important thing is to follow instructions closely during the switch. Do not stop one medicine or start another without guidance. With proper planning, switching can improve comfort and safety while maintaining protection against stroke.



Medicines That May Interfere With Blood Thinners

Even modern blood thinners can interact with other medicines. Certain drugs—like some antibiotics, antifungals, or herbal supplements—can increase or decrease the effect of blood thinners. This is why it is important to



Dr. Ayush Jain
Cardiologist, Bhopal

inform your doctor about all medicines you are taking, including over-the-counter drugs and herbal products. Never start or stop a medicine without medical advice if you are on a blood thinner. A simple rule: keep your doctor informed, and you stay protected.





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• HISTORY

Mountbatten Plan at 79: How it redrew the subcontinent

Nikita Mohta
New Delhi, June 3

LORD LOUIS Mountbatten arrived in Delhi on March 22, 1947, to assume office as Viceroy with a clear mandate: Transfer power to Indian hands no later than June 30, 1948. He entered a country gripped by escalating communal violence. The Calcutta killings of August 1946 were followed by riots in Noakhali and Bihar, while tensions had spread to Bombay and other parts of the country.

Mountbatten swiftly concluded that the idea of Pakistan had become unavoidable. Following consultations in India and a visit to London in mid-May, he returned to unveil the Partition Plan on the evening of June 3, 1947.

On this day, the principal political actors of the day prepared to announce the fate of the subcontinent: Lord Mountbatten, the British Viceroy; Jawaharlal Nehru, representing the Congress; Muhammad Ali Jinnah, representing the Muslim League; and Baldev Singh, speaking on behalf of the Sikhs. The announcement they delivered came to be known as the June 3 Declaration.

What did the plan propose?

At its core, the plan accepted the division of British India. It proposed that the Assemblies of Punjab and Bengal would vote on whether their provinces should be partitioned; Sindh's Assembly would decide whether to join India or Pakistan; and referendums would be held in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district to determine their future. If partition occurred, a Boundary Commission would demarcate the borders, particularly in Punjab and Bengal. The plan also provided for the creation of two independent dominions, India and Pakistan, each with its Constituent

Assembly. Princely states were required to accede to one of the two dominions, and the transfer of power was advanced to August 15, 1947.

How did the rival parties agree?

The Congress was driven to accept the plan out of the desire to contain spiralling communal violence. It also concluded that a smaller but more cohesive India with a strong central government was preferable over a united India in which the Muslim League could permanently obstruct governance. For the Muslim League, acceptance of the June 3 Plan guaranteed the creation of Pakistan, the fulfilment of its central political objective. The League feared that Muslims would be politically marginalised in a united, Hindu-majority India. Partition, therefore, offered what it saw as a path to political self-determination.

The unanswered questions

Crucial questions remained unanswered. Would people be expected to migrate? Where exactly would the borders be drawn? Which districts would fall within Pakistan and which would remain in India? Mountbatten was repeatedly pressed on whether the plan would trigger large-scale migration. "Personally I don't see it," the Viceroy replied. Yet the tragic consequences soon became apparent to the world. In the weeks to come, violence would engulf large parts of the subcontinent, triggering one of the greatest mass migrations in history.



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• HEALTH

How new pancreatic cancer pill doubles survival rate



EXPERT EXPLAINS
ANANT RAMASWAMY

SPECIALIST IN GASTROINTESTINAL
CANCERS AND GERIATRIC ONCOLOGY,
TATA MEMORIAL CENTRE

A NEW experimental pill is offering hope for patients of pancreatic cancer, one of the deadliest and hardest-to-treat forms of the disease. Results from a large international trial presented at an American Society of Clinical Oncology meet showed that daraxonrasib, a once-daily oral drug, nearly doubled survival time in patients with advanced pancreatic cancer whose disease had progressed despite earlier treatment.

The drug works by targeting KRAS, a cancer-driving gene mutation found in the vast majority of pancreatic tumours — one that researchers have spent decades trying to effectively shut down. "For years, the average (median) survival for patients with advanced pancreatic cancers has hovered around one year. It was six months in the late 1990s and just about 9-12 months three decades later. Improvements in survival have been minimally incremental despite active research over the last two decades," says Professor **Anant Ramaswamy**, specialist in gastrointestinal cancers and Geriatric Oncology, Tata Memorial Centre, Mumbai.

"In such a scenario, the impact of an oral pill improving or rather doubling survival in pre-treated patients with pancreatic cancer is great news. Also, this is just the beginning for this new class of drugs. Patients and oncologists can expect more improvements in the times to come," he told **Rinku Ghosh** in an interview. Excerpts:

Why has pancreatic cancer remained so difficult to treat compared with some other cancers?

There are multiple reasons. First, a majority of patients (70-90%) are diagnosed at an advanced stage and that itself is a major limiting factor. Second, while a number of other cancers have had targeted agents and immunotherapy markedly improving survival, till date these have not shown signifi-

The deadliest form of the disease

• WHAT IS PANCREATIC CANCER?

Pancreatic cancer is an aggressive disease that forms when malignant cells develop in the tissues of the pancreas, which produces digestive enzymes and blood sugar-regulating hormones like insulin.

• WHY IS IT DIFFICULT TO DETECT IN ITS EARLY STAGES?

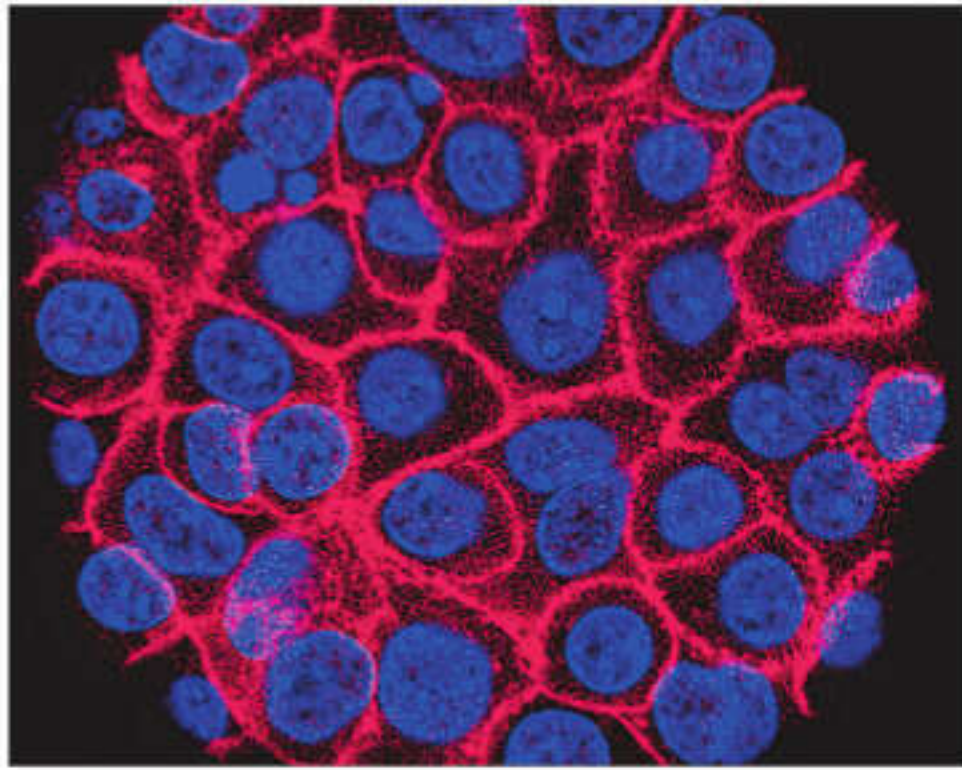
Symptoms usually do not appear until the tumour has grown large or has started to spread to surrounding organs. Common indicators include jaundice, pain, nausea, loss of appetite, unexplained weight loss & new onset diabetes.

• WHAT'S THE SURVIVAL RATE?

The overall five-year survival rate for pancreatic cancer is approximately 13%.

• HOW COMMON IS IT?

The annual incidence of pancreatic cancer in India is relatively low compared to Western countries, with approximately 23,000 new cases diagnosed each year. The crude incidence rate is about 1.6 per 100,000 people, affecting slightly more men than women.



A microscope image shows pancreatic cancer cells. AP FILE

It ranks 24th in overall cancer incidence but 18th in cancer mortality.

• INDIAN RISK PROFILE

Diabetes, tropical pancreatitis (such as in Kerala and Tamil Nadu), lifestyle and obesity

cant effects in pancreatic cancer. Third, and a bit technically, in pancreatic cancer, it's not just the tumour but also the surrounding tissue around it (called the stroma) that has been very resistant to available treatment approaches.

What role does the KRAS gene play in pancreatic cancer? The drug is described as 'locking onto' the mutated KRAS gene. In simple terms, how does it work?

RAS is a protein that is ubiquitously expressed in almost all cell types in the human body. It is encoded for by a gene called RAS gene. Mutations (damaging alterations in the gene which cause cancer) in the RAS gene family (of which KRAS is the most common) affect approximately 20% of all cancers. Approximately 80% of pancreatic cancers have alterations in the KRAS gene, which have made it a major area of research in pancreatic cancers.

Basically, when the KRAS gene is mutated, it becomes continually active (or 'ON' mode) by binding to some small molecules in the cells and then ensures that there is disruption of activity in normal cells. That's how

A ticking clock

In the late 1990s, the average survival time for patients with advanced pancreatic cancer was six months.

Three decades later, it is just about 9-12 months, despite active research.

• DIPLOMACY

Hormuz to nuclear issue: Rubio's testimony tempers expectations

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 3

A FIVE-hour-long testimony by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio to the US Congress Tuesday provided clues about where the West Asia war is headed amid a fragile peace and uncertain ceasefire talks with Iran.

Appearing before the Senate for the first time since the war began on February 28, a combative Rubio spoke about a range of issues linked to the conflict.

Nuclear talks

Rubio tried to project optimism about the ceasefire talks with Iran, claiming that Tehran was willing to discuss some aspects of its nuclear programme — previously a no-go area. The US wants Iran to cap its programme and give up its estimated 440 kg of highly enriched uranium.

He cautioned, however, that there was no guarantee that any agreement would be "acceptable to the Senate or acceptable to the American people". His open-ended assessment is an official acknowledgement that both sides still have wide differences on several issues.

Rubio's statement came a day after Iran's

state-affiliated *Tasnim News Agency* reported that Tehran would stop exchanging messages with Washington through intermediaries, pointing to Israel's military operations in Lebanon as a ceasefire violation.

Sanctions relief

Rubio said US negotiators have not offered sanctions relief to Iran in exchange for reopening the Strait of Hormuz. Any such relief, he said, was tied to Tehran giving up its nuclear programme.

Iran's main demand has been relief from the crushing economic sanctions imposed by the US, which had led to widespread protests in January. Its biggest leverage during the conflict has been its control over the Strait of Hormuz. Iran closed the narrow waterway, through which a fifth of the world's energy normally flows, in response to the US-Israeli attack.

Tehran is hoping that Trump, who faces midterm elections later this year, will buckle under the pressure of the spiralling gas and fuel prices and agree to its demands.

A rift with Israel?

Asked where the US stands on Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's goal

Mojtaba Khamenei's fate

• Rubio said he believes that Iran's Supreme Leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, is alive and is 'increasingly engaging' in leadership matters amid negotiations.

• By all accounts, however, the Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps is in control, and has access to the new Supreme Leader.

of seizing 70% of Gaza, Rubio said that was not part of President Donald Trump's 20-point plan to end the conflict between Israel and Hamas and rebuild the devastated territory.

This can be seen as a rebuke to the Israeli PM, who has consistently pushed the limits of the wars in Gaza as well as West Asia. Rubio's statement comes after Trump reportedly ripped into Netanyahu over his plans to attack Lebanon capital Beirut, for attacking Lebanon, and jeopardising the Iran peace talks.

China's role

Rubio said China hasn't provided help to Iran that "in any way impeded our operations". He told lawmakers that Iran has Chinese military equipment from their previous ties but said the US has seen no indication that anything provided has "changed the dynamic in the battlefield".

This is an important statement and assessment from the US Secretary of State and acting National Security Advisor, especially in the backdrop of US President Donald Trump's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping last week in Beijing. From India's perspective, this is an im-

portant lesson since China had provided live intelligence to Pakistan during Operation Sindoor in May last year. This shows that Beijing is mindful of its ties with the US, and worked accordingly. It did not do the same with New Delhi.

Which patients are most likely to be eligible for this treatment?

As of now, patients with pancreatic cancer, who have previously received chemotherapy and have worsening disease, are candidates for receiving daraxonrasib. However, clinical trials and studies are already exploring these drugs in patients who are treatment-naïve (meaning an individual has never received therapy or medication for a specific medical condition or disease). I think that these will possibly be used earlier rather than later in pancreatic cancers as well as other cancers in the coming times.

Can this drug have applications beyond pancreatic cancer?

Daraxonrasib as well as other drugs similar to it, which inhibit activity of RAS, are being explored in a number of cancers since RAS mutations are noted in about 20% of all cancers. They are actively being evaluated in lung and colon cancers since these are relatively common and have a high incidence of RAS mutations.

What about accessibility?

The drug is not available in India. But with the kind of scope it has, I think this class of drugs will soon make its way to the country. Everyone is interested because of their potential to treat a number of cancers. Informally, we have heard that there is a long waiting list even to get into clinical trials evaluating RAS inhibitors. So we will have to wait and see with regard to accessibility of daraxonrasib.

What does this breakthrough tell us about the future of precision medicine in cancer treatment?

Precision medicine has already transformed the management of certain cancers like lung cancers. With more research, oncologists like me can hope for more personalised and precise treatments. At the same time, we also need to remember that the basics of cancer therapy — surgery, chemotherapy and radiotherapy — are very important and precision medicine has to work in tandem.

• ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

AI cracks an 80-year-old maths problem, marking a landmark in reasoning

Nameera Anjum
New Delhi, June 3

FOR GENERATIONS, mathematicians have tried and failed to solve an 80-year-old problem. In May, an artificial intelligence (AI) model successfully tackled it.

OpenAI, the maker of ChatGPT, said one of its internal models had made a breakthrough with the challenge first posed by Hungarian mathematician Paul Erdős in 1946 — the planar unit distance problem. The mathematician was known for creating such challenges, which are collectively known as "Erdős problems".

Claims of AI models solving maths problems are not new, attracting criticism as well as scepticism.

Experts, however, say this particular result stands out. Had a human carried it out, it would merit publication in a top math journal, they say. "No previous AI-generated proof has come close" to meeting those high standards, wrote Tim Gowers, a mathematician at the University of Cam-

bridge, in commentary for OpenAI.

Thomas Bloom, a researcher at the University of Manchester who maintains the website *erdosproblems.com*, told *The Indian Express* that he had ranked the 'unit distance problem' among his top 10 Erdős problems and expected that a solution was still a long way off. These breakthroughs, according to him, matter because they show that AI is capable of doing "real research".

The planar unit distance problem

The problem is deceptively simple. Take a piece of paper and place some dots on it. As you keep adding dots — even up to the millions and trillions — how do you ensure that you get the maximum pairs of dots that are at the same distance from each other?

Erdős posited that the best strategy to get the maximum number of equal-distance pairs is to arrange them in a shape roughly resembling a square grid.

For decades, mathematicians thought that this was indeed the best way but could

not find a proof. "Like most people, I was expecting a proof," said Bloom, who is among nine mathematicians who have verified this result.

But the OpenAI model, instead of solving the problem, disproved the square-grid assumption, "discovering an entirely new family of constructions that performs better", according to OpenAI.

This means that it essentially found a new pattern — one that is difficult to represent visually — drawing from different fields of mathematics to show that it was possible to get even more equal-distance pairs.

Maths and AI models

AI models that once struggled with basic arithmetic are now solving SAT problems and tackling Olympiad-level benchmarks. Some of these claims, however, have attracted scrutiny.

In October 2025, OpenAI's former Chief Product Officer Kevin Weill said on X that GPT-5 had found solutions to 10 Erdős problems. He later deleted this post.

At that time, Bloom had described the claim as a "dramatic misrepresentation", saying it only found existing literature.

This is exactly why the new result is so significant. Rather than simply drawing on existing data, it shows that the AI model was able to "read academic papers and understand them well enough to apply them in new ways", said Bloom.

Days after Open AI's announcement, Google DeepMind said its AlphaProofNexus model had solved nine Erdős problems.

So why is solving maths problems so important in the field of AI? According to Bloom, with creative writing, people can argue about whether something is well-written or not. "With a mathematical proof, it's either right or wrong, and everyone who's read and understood it can agree on which."

Disproving the conjecture

"Modern mathematics is very specialised, and people tend to have depth rather than breadth... a powerful technique from another field might have applications in a

completely different field that all humans have missed," said Bloom.

But unlike humans, AI systems are less constrained by assumptions about which fields connect naturally.

What makes the Erdős result specifically striking is how the AI model drew from multiple domains. Sayan Ranu, a professor at the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi, told *The Indian Express*. "The model solved a problem in discrete geometry using tools from algebraic number theory, branches of mathematics that experts had not previously connected to this question."

By gathering literature and synthesising information across vast domains, AI models can appear more efficient in certain fields than an expert working in a single field. It can dig for solutions tirelessly.

Why these results matter

These results in pure mathematics may have little effect on most people's lives. But, Bloom said, "once AI can do that with maths papers, it could start to do the same with bi-

ology, physics, medicine, engineering."

According to Ranu, the models are already arriving at original scientific reasoning in a meaningful way, though a gap remains between these systems and the physical world. This, he said, is the next frontier where real progress will be seen.

The result, he believes, settles a common misconception that LLMs are essentially a more powerful Google search, retrieving answers from a giant database.

But Ranu points out that these models are not yet better than the very best specialists in a given field, such as a leading mathematician working on a problem for decades. AI models also tend to hallucinate or give incorrect answers confidently.

This Erdős problem, thus, became a test of whether AI has moved beyond simple retrieval of information, like search engines do. "This problem had no answer to retrieve. The model produced a new construction that humans had not found in eighty years of trying. That is reasoning and creation, not search," Ranu said.



JUNE 11-JULY 19

48 TEAMS, 16 CITIES, 3 COUNTRIES

The 2026 FIFA World Cup, spread across the United States, Mexico, and Canada, is the biggest the sport has ever staged. There are the personalities — the players and powerbrokers who have shaped the four years since Qatar. There is the geography — Mexico and the United States have hosted this tournament before — and the nostalgia — of what happened on those pitches. And in this edition, there are some things happening for the first time.

When the Samba Boys made magic under the Azteca sun

Brazil's fourth goal, scored by Carlos Alberto, in the 1970 World Cup final against Italy was an ensemble performance where each participant played a starring role

{ NOSTALGIA }

Sandip G

THE MOST fascinating part of Brazil's fourth goal against Italy in the 1970 World Cup final is not its scorer, the strike or the symphony of touches, passes, nudges and swerves involved in the build-up. It's how every viewing embellishes its beauty, unravels a hidden layer, and unearths a different protagonist. It was at the same time an orchestra and a solo concert, each performer in a world of his own, yet producing a collective, soulful crescendo.

The strapping and commanding Carlos Alberto, nicknamed Capitano even before he became one, strummed the end note, a shot with such velocity that he was airborne in the follow-through, but the first beat was struck by a short and balding forward nicknamed Tostao, or Little Coin.

He was semi-blind in his left eye, yet would later become an eye specialist. He was ambling near the opponents' box — as were his teammates as Brazil, 3-1 up with four minutes left on the clock, were in time-saving mode — when he spotted Italian midfielder Antonio Juliano scurrying along the right flank. Something seized him, he sprinted 40 yards under the skin-peeling Azteca sun, the colours vivid because it was the first World Cup televised in technicolour.

Tostao tugged and pulled at Juliano's shirt, tackled him from the side, robbed the ball and passed it to centre-back Wilson Piazza. Had the slide been half a second late, he would have clattered onto Juliano's shin, received a yellow card and conceded a free kick.

He pounced into the final frame of the goal too, just behind Italy's centre-back Roberto Rosato in the middle of the box, diverting attention. Before Johan Cruyff's Total Football, a forward performed a left-back's duties.

Among the eight men who touched the ball in the 37-second sequence, the most routine was Piazza's. He received the



When the ball left Pele's feet, Alberto was not in the television frame. But Pele knew Alberto would come. Just as Alberto knew the pass would.

ball and passed it to Clodoaldo, who raised the concert's tempo. But Piazza's role was important too; rather the decision to not pass the ball to erratic goalkeeper Felix, who once smoked through a full game. He throws a sideways glance and almost shifts his body to Felix, before changing his mind and ping-ponging the ball to Clodoaldo, the defensive midfielder, whose blundered back-heel had assisted Italy's lone goal.

The latter was on shutter mode, and brushed the ball to Pele, tracking back to help his teammates out.

In a more inspired mood, Pele would have turned back and launched a quick counter-attack. Or slithered the ball to Jairzinho lurking in the wings. The Italians were defeated in mind and body. Instead, he found the wandering Gerson, who clipped it back to Clodoaldo, completing a neat short, passing triangle.

The game was crawling. And then Clodoaldo decided to raise the metre in a 10-second passage of pure ingenuity. It



Carlos Alberto holds the trophy during its unveiling ceremony at Copacabana beach in 2010. REUTERS

originated from a falsetto note, a heavy touch that drew the pressing Italians to hunt for the ball. "Italy was putting a lot of pressure and pressing us so when I was able to dribble four or five Italians, space opened up and I simply passed the ball to Rivellino," he would say later.

Magic made simple

It wasn't simple, even though he made it look disturbingly simple. Clodoaldo dropped his shoulders and wove past Gianni Rivera, spun through Angelo Domenghini and Giancarlo de Sisti, dummed Juliano, veered to his left and laid the ball off to Rivellino on his left. The man with the furry moustache didn't waltz

along the flank as he is wont to, but darted a 40-yard pass down the line to Jairzinho, the right winger who was fizzing on the left.

He was not playing out of position, or filling up a hole left by the left winger. Coach Mario Zagallo had instructed him to interchange flanks in between games so that he would drag Italy's captain and left-back Giacinto Facchetti into him, thus carving space for full-back Alberto's upfield thrusts.

The goal, in that sense, was not a pure accident, but choreographed to perfection in training and played out when an opportunity arrived. Throughout the tournament, Zagallo sent his assistants to

spy on their opponents. To Italy's training camp, he had commissioned future World Cup-winning manager Carlos Alberto Perreira, the team's physical trainer.

"We knew before the game it could happen, because we knew how the Italian team played. They played man-to-man on the central line. They followed our forwards," Alberto later revealed.

Jairzinho's touch and turn were gorgeous, he was prone to tricks, had perfected the exotic step-over variant called elastico, but was more direct here. He teased and cut inside Facchetti, danced to the edge of the box and slipped the ball inside to Pele past an onrushing Cera.

Pele had two yellow shirts and cobalt blue shirts in front of him. Tostao, in front of him with the goal behind his back gestured with his eyebrows at Alberto's arrival. Pele pranced around, shuffling the ball between his feet, took three touches and rolled the ball to his right. When the ball left his feet, Alberto was not in the television frame.

But Pele knew Alberto would come. Just as Alberto knew the pass would. "Pelé knew I was coming. We had spoken about it before the game," he later said.

His run was precise, fast and angled. Alberto is the godfather of Brazil's thrusting full-back legacy. The ball broke sublimely for him, sat up, thanks to a bobble off the surface, furnishing him the perfect launchpad to propel his right-footed rocket.

He watched it a millions times, but couldn't fully fathom its beauty. "The emotion, of course, when I scored that goal was incredible, but after the game, and still today, I realise how beautiful and how important that goal was because everybody is still talking about it," he said in 2014, two years before his death.

The goal symbolised everything beautiful about Brazilian football, its maddening fusion of vision, power, skill and energy. And each viewing unravels a different layer and impression, like an Azteca Mona Lisa, timeless and infinite in its splendour.



Captain Kylian Mbappe (L) and coach Didier Deschamps. REUTERS

Les Bleus ready to go all guns blazing

France coach Deschamps has decided to give his forward line more creative freedom in quest for trophy

Shashank Nair

FRIGHTFULLY ABUNDANT in attacking talent during a period that has the makings of a dynasty but is peppered with the inability to win a slew of major trophies, France could have been the Brazil of 1958-70.

The South American giants carved out a legacy falling only once, to the Italians, in a 12-year cycle of dominance. As France head coach Didier Deschamps prepares for his swansong, his charges have to show they know how to get the job done.

Kylian Mbappe is now 27 and France's leading man. Captain, central striker, bereft of any defensive responsibilities, the Frenchman is where he would like to be. The last visual of him from a World Cup was one of singularity: three goals in 120+ minutes of football, followed by one of three in the penalty shootout in the 2022 final against Argentina.

Mbappe joined Geoff Hurst as scorers of hat-tricks in a final, but came out on the wrong end of the result. Qatar would forever be a scar.

Two years removed from that night, the phenom found himself facing Spain in the 2024 European Championship semifinal, when La Roja chose to splash cold water on French aspirations. Les Bleus lost 1-2 but it was the Spanish dominance that forced France to acknowledge what was happening. A decade with arguably the greatest assembly of talent to choose from had 'only' a World Cup to show for it — great for most teams, middling for the riches at Deschamps's disposal.

The 2024 setback seemed to have finally struck Deschamps that his wards needed to be given a bit more creative freedom. The next significant encounter was a heavyweight 'You-hit-me-I-hit-you-harder' 4-5 defeat, again to Spain, in the 2025 Nations League semifinal. The French lost but emerged with the knowledge of what they needed to be.

It has taken France some rare, yet notable losses across this decade — to Portugal on penalties in Euro 2016, to Argentina on penalties in 2022

and to Spain in 2024 — three defeats that have come to teams that didn't have as much overall talent, but knew how to harness their resources better.

Accused of defensive rigidity for much of the decade, France's World Cup-winning coach plans to go out all guns blazing.

Attacking riches

At the heart of it is the most unlikely of heroes: Michael Olise. More English than French, born to a Nigerian father and a French-Algerian mother, Olise is from Hamersmith, West London and speaks English while understanding a smattering of French. Playing his way through the English Championship, then Crystal Palace and now Bayern Munich, he has been asked by Deschamps to be his Antoine Griezmann.

The left-footed winger operates on the right and cuts into the centre of the pitch for his club.

For France though, he sits behind the trio of Mbappe, Ousmane Dembele and Désiré Doué, becoming the all-important link of balance and clarity between midfield and offence.

Around the central attacking spine of Mbappe and Olise lie Ballon d'Or winner Ousmane Dembele and one of Doue or Bradley Barcola — players who can put a shift up-and-down the pitch and allow France to get the ball back fast — a gift from Champions League winners PSG and their head coach Luis Enrique.

"There's more talent and potential than in 2022," Mbappé said earlier this year. "Is it a stronger team? We'll have to see the results..."

Are there any weaknesses? Hardly any for a French team that played their B-team against a Colombia that had been better in qualification than the Selecao, beating them 3-1.

Is it too late for them to be the Brazil of yore? Possibly. They've gone through too many tournaments where they have reached the final stages, but don't know what to do when they get there.

{ FIRST TIME }

With hydration breaks, football won't be a game of two halves at the World Cup

'Four quarters' allow football to become more like hockey and basketball with coaches getting the chance to regroup

Mihir Vasavda

FOOTBALL HAS always been a sport of halves. Two periods of 45 minutes, separated by a 15-minute interval. At the 2026 FIFA World Cup, that will change.

For the first time, every match will feature mandatory hydration breaks midway through each half.

The breaks will take place at around the 22nd minute in the first half and 67th in the second, and will be compulsory regardless of weather conditions.

NUMBER BOX

624

The World Cup has 104 matches. Each match will have two mandatory hydration breaks, one in each half. Each break will last three minutes. That adds up to 624 extra minutes across the tournament — or 10.4 hours, enough time to play nearly seven full football matches.

Consequently, football this summer will begin to resemble sports such as hockey, basketball and American football, where coaches routinely get opportunities to regroup players during the game.

FIFA's reasoning is straightforward.

With matches spread across the United States, Mexico and Canada during the northern summer, heat management and player welfare have become a central concern. Rather than leave the decision to individual referees, FIFA has opted

for a uniform approach.

Four quarters

The change effectively turns football into a four-quarter game. Instead of playing uninterrupted for 45 minutes, teams will now get a pause midway through each half. Hockey players are familiar with the concept. Coaches use quarter breaks to alter pressing patterns, reorganise defensive structures and stop momentum swings.

Football managers now have something similar.

Three minutes may not sound like much, but at an elite level, it is enough time to issue fresh instructions, settle players under pressure or react to tactical

• EXPERT SPEAK



RUDI GARCIA, BELGIUM COACH

"I like (them) because this is an opportunity for us coaches to speak with the team, to speak about strategy and plan. It was very good and interesting to speak with the team during these breaks."

cal problems developing on the pitch.

Laptops on touchline

The hydration breaks could also change how coaching is done. While players can't step beyond the touchline, USA coach Mauricio Pochettino

gathered his team around a laptop on the pitch to review tactical footage during a recent game. Instead of waiting until half time, coaches can now deliver visual feedback in real time.

So, analysts sitting behind the bench become more in-

fluent than ever. And the days of managers relying purely on instructions shouted out from the touchline, may be fading.

More ad-breaks

FIFA has allowed broadcasters to show commercials during the mandatory stoppages. The rules are carefully structured. If broadcasters use split-screen coverage and keep the match visible, only FIFA partners and official World Cup sponsors can advertise.

If they leave the match feed entirely, broadcasters can sell the slot to other advertisers. Moreover, the ads should not start within 20 seconds of the referee blowing for the start of

the hydration break, and broadcasters must return to the action more than 30 seconds before play resumes.

Super Bowl twist

For the World Cup final, at MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, FIFA has announced a Super Bowl-style halftime show produced alongside Global Citizen. To accommodate the performance, the traditional 15-minute half-time interval is expected to be extended significantly, almost to 30 minutes.

For generations, football's showpiece event has been built around the match itself.

The 2026 final will place entertainment at the centre of the occasion as well.

Cool Ayush comes from behind to beat World No. 15

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, June 3

AYUSH SHETTY allowed the cacophony of sound that Indonesia's Gen Z have become known to produce at the Istora Senayan arena this year, to become ambient noise to his own raised pitch on Wednesday. And Weng Hong Yang, the World No. 15 from China, disintegrated, terribly angry and error-prone, especially after the Indian picked up pace after trailing 8-21, 11-15 in the second. He lost 8-21, 22-20, 21-15.

The source of the ruckus was Indonesian mens doubles pair Raymond Indra- Nikolaus Joaquin playing on Court 2. But given the number of Indonesian doubles pairings - 18 across three categories, which is 6 times their singles participation of 3 - the noise streaming out of badminton's most iconic arena tends to be endless with one or another always on one of the courts.

Ayush led early in the match and then nosedived to lose the opener 8-21. Weng still searching for revenge after Ayush showed him up at the Thomas Cup, would've imagined he had secured a turnaround as the Indian flatlined from 7-14 to lose the opener 8-21. It looked tricky for the Indian at 11-15, but he went on a 6-point run to reach 17-15, like an express train. There were belligerent net attacks, monster down-the-line smashes, and an intent to snap at the heels, exacerbated by the noise heavily enveloping even the sequestered Court 3.

The Chinese can be a hard nut to crack if allowed to dictate the tempo. But except for Shi Yuqi, Ayush has shown the ability to take out every other Chinese. He knew Weng could be put under pressure, and Ayush did what was needed clinically, clutch in big points.

THE SECOND KICK

Tahsin's journey: Dream born in Kerala, realised for Qatar

Jamshid Thachankandy left Thalassery for Doha in 1996; his son will now play at the World Cup

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, June 3

WHEN TAHSIN Mohammad Jamshid was four years old, he would sit by the dug-out at local stadiums in Doha and watch his father play football on Fridays.

That was where it started. Jamshid Thachankandy, from Calicut, had immigrated to Doha in 1996 with his wife Shyma, who is from Valapattanam, leaving behind a timber business and a football career cut short by injury. Fridays in Qatar are holidays. Jamshid spent his at local stadiums with friends and co-workers, and his younger son came along. "He used to sit near the dug-out area," Jamshid remembers. "Later he would ask me and my friends to dribble with him, to make him learn football. That was his first step."

In 1992, Jamshid had been chosen for the India youth football camp. He did not go. Calicut University needed him for the Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee Shield, he had a degree to finish, a life to build. He made his choice. He played alongside Jo Paul Anchery, Kerala's finest of that era, but the national call-up was the one that got away.

More than thirty years later, Jamshid's 19-year-old son is in the 26-man Qatar squad for the FIFA World Cup. It is the first time a player of Indian origin has been at the tournament since Vikash Dhorasoo played for France in 2006.

"When we won the Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee Shield, it was

like winning a World Cup for each one of us," Jamshid says from Doha. "Now to see my son Tahsin play in the FIFA World Cup for Qatar feels like achieving my dream."

He pauses. "It's a special moment for each one of us."

From the dug-out to the Sheikh Faisal Bin Qasim Sports Academy. From there to the sub-junior team of Al-Duhail SC in 2017. Then the Aspire Academy, Qatar's elite football development programme, where most of the national team's current players were shaped. The club bus would pick Tahsin up in the morning and drop him back in the evening. "All he talked about was football," his father says. "Apart from a forward, he also played as a left winger as well as right winger." The coaches at Sheikh Faisal had spotted something early — two Algerian instructors who spent hours on his attacking runs, his angles, his movement off the ball.

He made his U17 debut for Qatar in 2023 and U19 debut the following year. In 2024, Tahsin made his professional senior debut for Al-Duhail SC in the Qatar Stars League, coming on for former Premier League midfielder Ibrahim Diallo. Two months later, he was called into the Qatar senior squad.

In September 2024, at 17 years, 11 months, and 21 days, Tahsin started for Qatar against Afghanistan in a World Cup qualifier in Saudi Arabia — the same campaign in which Qatar also faced India. The match



Indian-origin player Tahsin Mohammad, 19, will play for Qatar at the World Cup. QATAR FOOTBALL ASSOCIATION



Tahsin Mohammad (L) with his parents Jamshid Thachankandy and Shyma, and elder brother Mishal. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ended 0-0. Jamshid was in the stands.

"We went to watch him play and cheered for him and the Qatar team," he says. That is all he says about it.

Since then, Tahsin has featured in friendlies against Zimbabwe and Ireland, and played for the Qatar U23 team. He was born in Doha, grew up in its stadiums, trained in its academies. He also holds an Indian passport — his father's country,

To see my son Tahsin play in the FIFA World Cup for Qatar feels like achieving my dream. It's a special moment for each one of us."

JAMSHID THACHANKANDY
TAHSIN'S FATHER, WHO WAS ONCE CALLED UP FOR AN INDIA YOUTH CAMP, BUT LATER MOVED TO DOHA

a place he has never lived. Next year, as per law, he will need to choose.

"Possibly, he will be opting for a Qatar passport then," Jamshid says.

Tahsin grew up watching the 2022 World Cup from those same stadiums — a huge Cristiano Ronaldo fan, he followed every Portugal match. He also cheered for Qatar in the group stage, before they went out.

This time, Tahsin will be on

the pitch.

Qatar open against Switzerland on June 13 in San Francisco, then face Canada and Bosnia and Herzegovina to complete their group. They qualified last October with a 2-1 win over UAE and are coached by Julien Lopetegui.

"We have been getting a lot of messages and calls from Kerala," Jamshid says. "People are telling us they will pray for Tahsin."

Jamshid watches from Doha now. His son dribbles from wide areas, carries the ball at defenders, spent afternoons at Al-Duhail with Marco Verratti and Philippe Coutinho — and watched every Ronaldo match he could during that last World Cup, from the same stands where his father once played on Fridays.

On June 13, in San Francisco, Tahsin Mohammad Jamshid will play in a FIFA World Cup.

His father will be watching.

Shnaider stuns top seed Sabalenka to reach semis

Reuters
Paris, June 3

RUSSIAN OUTSIDER Diana Shnaider battled from a set and a double break down to shock world number one Aryna Sabalenka 3-6 7-5 6-0 in blustery conditions and charge into the French Open semi-finals on a windswept Wednesday.

In a tournament that has witnessed several shocks including the exits of defending champion Coco Gauff and four-times winner Iga Swiatek, Sabalenka's defeat sent another jolt through the wide-open women's draw.

Shnaider reached her maiden Grand Slam semi-final after an inspired battle in which she won the last 10 games having been two points away from defeat, and she takes on Polish qualifier Maja Chwalinska in the last four.

"Obviously, the first time playing Aryna, I was super nervous. The first set, I was trying to adjust to her game, trying to figure out how to play," Shnaider said. "I feel like I was trying to focus point by point, not thinking about the score. She's the world number one, so I just tried to do my best. I just had to fight for every point."

"It's definitely a super special win. I feel in the third set I finally found my rhythm and how to play and where to be a bit more. The third set was the one I should be aiming for from the beginning. Super happy to finish on a good note."

The conditions on Court Philippe Chatrier proved a massive challenge for both players as they affected precise shot-making, but Sabalenka found her groove to open up a 5-1 advantage before she dropped serve when the wind began to really swirl.

"I don't know why would they keep the roof open when it's crazy windy," Sabalenka told reporters.

"But how can I complain, if



Russia's Diana Shnaider beat Aryna Sabalenka 3-6, 7-5, 6-0 in their quarterfinal. AP

for almost the whole match everything was working okay for me, but then it just slipped away. I feel like it was getting crazy maybe just because mentally I wasn't really okay."

Chwalinska through

Polish qualifier Maja Chwalinska continued her dream run at the French Open on Wednesday, reaching the semi-finals with a 7-6(3) 6-3 victory over Russia's Anna Kalinskaya on a windswept Court Philippe Chatrier.

The 24-year-old absorbed the power of the 22nd seed superbly, repeatedly forcing Kalinskaya into errors by extending rallies and making her hit one extra shot as she became only the second qualifier in the Open era to reach the Roland Garros semi-finals - and the sixth to achieve the feat at a Grand Slam.

"Every single match here is kind of crazy for me, I'm very grateful," said Chwalinska, who has only dropped one set on her way to the last four.

"Inside I'm nervous and stressed. I try to focus on my game and I'm happy I managed that. Honestly I just try to win every match, I'm not focusing on confidence, I'm not comparing myself (with the top players).

Pragg beats Carlsen, but insists Norwegian is 'still the best'

Amit Kamath
Oslo, June 3

MAGNUS CARLSEN jumped in his chair before leaning so far ahead towards the board that he could have whispered in the ears of his king. Trouble was brewing in the air for the crownless king of chess and his wooden king on the board. In a tense endgame, Carlsen had one move that could have ensured survival: king to e2. The clock had run down to 14 seconds when Carlsen made the 48th move — king to f4 — which lost him the game instead. Because once he had made the move, all his opponent, R Praggnanandhaa, had to do was march Carlsen's king to its death in seven moves.

For the first time since Viswanathan Anand at Linares 2007 and Veselin Topalov in the 2008 Grand Slam Chess Final in Bilbao, a player — of any nationality — defeated Magnus Carlsen twice in the same classical tournament. Praggnanandhaa defeated the World No. 1 from Norway for the second time in a week at the Norway Chess tournament being held at Oslo's Deichman Bjørkvik. He had also defeated him at the 2024 Norway Chess, before drawing their second game that year.

A win over Carlsen, that too in classical chess, is a badge worn proudly in this sport. But if he was feeling celebratory on Tuesday, Praggnanandhaa did a good job of concealing his emotions.

When asked if his wins over Carlsen across two Norway Chess editions, and Gukesh's infamous win from last year, mean there is a change of guard in the sport, the 20-year-old brushed it aside as an "exaggeration".

Facing Carlsen on the board in classical chess, even though he plays little of the format these days, has always carried an intimidation factor. Carlsen, even when not at his best, had felt invincible not too long ago. Over the years, has Carlsen's aura as an opponent eroded?

"I wouldn't say I felt intimidated (facing Carlsen). I always felt more excited playing him



Magnus Carlsen (L) was defeated by R Praggnanandhaa for the second time at his home tournament. MICHAL WALUSZA/NORWAY CHESS

than being intimidated," Pragg told Indian media in Oslo. "So these games always bring out my best. I don't think that affected me. In all my games with him, I was always playing at least decent quality chess."

A true measure of how significant a win over Carlsen in classical was came from Pragg's coach, grandmaster Vaibhav Suri.

"Against Magnus, you can never have enough wins," Suri told The Indian Express. "But this result shows that Magnus is great, but maybe he is not invincible."

Carlsen struggles

It was Carlsen's fourth classical loss at this year's Norway Chess tournament, one that saw him drop to fifth spot in the six-player standings. The only player below him in the standings is world champion Gukesh D.

With two more rounds to go at Norway Chess, Praggnanandhaa finds himself in third spot in the standings, just two points behind leader Wesley So.

Praggnanandhaa seemed to dismiss the significance of beating Carlsen, by saying that getting three points was more crucial, because it kept him in the race to win the title.

"Beating Magnus in any format is good," said Praggnanandhaa. "...but more than that, I think winning at this stage of the tournament is more important because when you win in classical, you get three points which are more impor-

tant for the standings."

There is something about Praggnanandhaa vs Carlsen encounters that end up being no-holds-barred brawls on the board.

"Today it was more of me who took the risk," said Praggnanandhaa. "We usually end up getting fighting games. I think we both want to beat each other, so we end up creating something out of nothing."

Surprise element

In a game that started with the Indian pulling out the French Defence with black pieces, Carlsen seemed to be surprised by the opening choice. He used up 20 more minutes of his time compared to Pragg by the seventh move. Carlsen ended up using up almost half his time by just the 10th move, an indicator that he was caught off guard.

Suri said that the opening idea that they used against Pragg had been concocted just before the Candidates, but only now had the opportunity arisen to use it.

Just before he headed back to his hotel room on Tuesday, Praggnanandhaa chose to give his nuanced take on the result.

"If you take Carlsen's tournaments from last year, he has won everything that he has played in. This is just one tournament where a few moments haven't gone his way. I think he is still the best."

(The writer is in Oslo at the invitation of Norway Chess)

Stokes defends decision to rest Archer for first Test against Kiwis

Associated Press
London, June 3

ENGLAND CRICKET captain Ben Stokes leapt to the defense of Jofra Archer on Wednesday, insisting the fast bowler is "committed" to the national team despite his absence for the start of the test series against New Zealand.

Archer will miss the first Test at Lord's starting Thursday because he has been playing in the Indian Premier League with Rajasthan Royals, who reached the playoffs and were beaten by Gujarat Titans last week.

On Tuesday, England coach Brendon McCullum also cast doubt on Archer's availability for the second Test, which starts June 17, saying he is having "a little bit of a break at the moment" and needs to be assessed.

Archer has faced criticism from some pundits and former players for not prioritizing England, with whom he has a central contract. Stokes said he understood the frustrations around Archer's unavailability but believes it's a sign of the times with the proliferation of franchise leagues around the world.

"A lot of the points that people would be making around Jof and that situation I think are to do with the landscape back when they were playing," Stokes said, in a nod to former players. "It's completely different now. There's opportunities for cricketers now that there wasn't 10, 15, 20 years ago. Yes, in an ideal situation, it would be unbelievably great to have everyone who you want available every single opportunity. But it's not the way of cricket at the moment. There's so much more out there for players." Stokes said England doesn't want to run the risk of losing talented players like Archer.

"There is a situation where it could get messy and players like Jofra might not play for England again if you handle it a different way," Stokes said, "and that's not good for anyone. Jof, I think, has shown that he is committed and loves playing for England. Just because he's not available for this first Test match does not change that."

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TO SHIELD AIRLINES, OMCs FROM GLOBAL FUEL PRICE SURGE

Centre clears Rs 10,000 cr to keep ATF prices stable

Price stabilisation fund mechanism will provide more predictability in fuel costs

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, June 3

THE CENTRE on Wednesday approved a one-time budgetary support of Rs 10,000 crore to public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) to provide stable fuel pricing for scheduled Indian airlines as it sought to cushion the blow from soaring jet fuel prices in the international market.

The government expects this arrangement, which will be in place for three years, to ease the pain for the OMCs as well as Indian airlines in the prevailing environment of extreme fuel price volatility. It also expects the move to rein in runaway airfares due to fuel price pressure. According to the government, this price stabilisation fund mechanism will provide greater predictability in fuel costs by adopting a fixed-price arrangement, thereby reducing the airlines' exposure to sudden fuel price spikes.

The facility will only be available to Indian airlines, and not to foreign carriers.

It will be implemented through an agreement between the airlines and the OMCs, under which the carriers will have to procure aviation turbine fuel (ATF) exclusively from the OMCs for up to three years, "subject to annual review or until the advance amount is fully recovered, whichever is earlier". Jet fuel prices have gone up significantly in the international market due to the West Asia war and the consequent closure of the Strait of



The price strain forced Air India to substantially curtail its international flight operations. REUTERS

Hormuz. The OMCs have been selling ATF at a loss for domestic flights, which is adversely impacting their financial health.

They are also bearing losses on other fuels like petrol, diesel, and cooking gas sold to households. On the other hand, Indian airlines have also been struggling, particularly in international flight operations, as they are required to pay the full market-linked price for overseas operations.

The strain forced Air India to substantially curtail its international flight operations for the June-August period. The airline has also reduced domestic flights due to the impact of high international fuel prices on its overall operations.

Indian airlines had made repeated pleas to the government to stabilize jet fuel prices, while also seeking parity between fuel prices for domestic and international flights.

Usually, ATF accounts for about 40% of Indian airlines' operational costs. The price surge had led to a further increase to 55-60%, according to an Indian airline association.

• FUND MECHANICS

THE CORPUS shall compensate OMCs for losses arising from elevated international ATF prices whenever the prevailing Import Parity Price exceeds the benchmark price determined under the approved mechanism

WHEN INTERNATIONAL ATF prices moderate, the differential amount will be recovered from OMCs and returned to the Consolidated Fund of India, said the Centre

THE FACILITY will only be available to Indian airlines, and not to foreign carriers. The OMCs have been selling ATF at a loss for domestic flights, which is adversely impacting their financial health

The hike in jet fuel prices resulted in most major airlines increasing fuel surcharges, particularly for international flights, even as they claimed that the surcharges would set off only a part of the cost escalation.

The government said that the West Asia crisis pushed up international jet fuel prices to Rs 142 per litre in May from Rs 60.50 per litre in March, an increase of 135%.

"The budgetary support shall be in the form of interest-free advances to OMCs through the Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. The support shall be provided to OMCs to facilitate stable ATF pricing for airlines during the ongoing period of exceptional fuel price volatility arising from the West Asia crisis," the government said in a release.

"The corpus shall compensate OMCs for losses arising from elevated international ATF prices whenever the prevailing Import Parity Price exceeds the benchmark price determined under the approved mechanism...When international ATF

prices moderate, the differential amount shall be recovered from OMCs and returned to the Consolidated Fund of India. The arrangement shall continue until the entire support amount is fully recovered and settled," it added. The implementation will be overseen by a monitoring committee of the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA), Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas (MoPNG), and the Department of Expenditure.

This committee will also oversee claim verification, reconciliation, and settlement, and all claims and recoveries shall be subject to audit.

On Monday, in their monthly revision of ATF prices, the OMCs kept the price unchanged for scheduled domestic flights for the second month in a row. Additionally, relief also came for Indian carriers in the form of a 27% cut in jet fuel price for international flights. With this cut, the price of jet fuel for international flights came down to levels similar for domestic flights.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Why fresh US tariffs turn talks into carrot-&-stick game for India

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, June 3

THE ANNOUNCEMENT of Section 301 tariffs on India and 59 other countries has yet again turned the trade deal negotiations into a familiar carrot and stick game for the Indian trade negotiators, as concessions offered by the Indian side would now determine the level of tariffs that the US would impose next month.

The US has launched two Section 301 investigations on India, one for not restricting imports of products produced through forced labour and the second on excess capacity. While 12.5% tariffs have already been announced, the current tariff level could go up when the probe on excess capacity is released.

This would then serve Washington the same purpose as reciprocal tariffs did, which is to coerce countries into accepting uncomfortable US demands that have gone well beyond trade and have sought to forcefully align with American trade goals. For a developing country like India, these demands have resulted in a breakdown of negotiations multiple times that resulted in steep tariffs.

The pressure of upcoming steep tariffs resembles past negotiation tactics that aimed at extracting market access commitments across sectors, including agriculture, right before negotiations were set to take place.

• TRADE MOVES

● The pressure of upcoming steep tariffs reminds of past negotiation tactics that aimed to extract market access commitments across sectors, including agriculture, right before negotiations were set to take place

● Negotiations had broken down over access to agricultural products, where India offers support to its farmers

Negotiations had broken down over access to agricultural products, where India offers support to its farmers.

While signing a deal could mean giving up more control of its sovereign trade policies to the US, an absence of the deal could accelerate the weakening of the domestic currency and flight of foreign capital that had begun since late last year.

The war in the Gulf region and higher oil prices have further weakened India's macroeconomic conditions.

More tariffs could add to India's fiscal worries.

Coercion after trade deal

Till just days before the trade talks with the US resumed, the considered view in New Delhi's policy circles was that the status quo was the best outcome for India — with penal tariffs gone and the

average tariffs of 18% broadly in line with peers and better off vis-a-vis China. "This is the best case scenario — tariffs being rationalised and without a trade deal in place. A trade deal brings with it multiple extraneous pressures. For us, the status quo is a good outcome," a top official told *The Indian Express*.

That situation has changed, with an American trade team in Delhi and some of the extraneous pressures suddenly kicking in. The proposed tariffs, set to come in by next month, would exert pressure on the Indian negotiators. India is already experiencing an exodus of foreign investments and a fast-depreciating currency. A hiccup in trade talks could make matters worse, but a successful deal will give more control to the US on sovereign matters such as the purchase of oil and its digital trade policy.

Senior government officials have said that an agreement with the US might leave India in a difficult position, particularly in its relationship, as the US has been nudging countries to wean away from their dependence on China.

Indian imports across sectors have crossed \$112 billion. Restrictive measures on China at America's behest could also create security-related challenges for India.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI finds \$158 bn of misreported revenue at Rajesh Exports

New Delhi: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) in an order on Wednesday alleged that jewellery maker Rajesh Exports inflated its revenue scale over years, largely via unverified overseas entities, to the tune of Rs 15.15 trillion (\$158.30 billion). SEBI has barred the firm and its owner from the securities markets till its probe is complete.

Rajesh Exports and its owner did not immediately respond to a *Reuters* request for comment.

SEBI said 97-99% of Rajesh Exports' consolidated revenue came from overseas subsidiaries, particularly Switzerland-based Valcambi SA. But the firm systematically failed to disclose its subsidiaries' financials in the public domain. Valcambi SA was projected as the principal operating entity, but disclosed negligible standalone revenues in its audited financial statements.

By doing so, Rajesh Exports misrepresented approximately Rs 15.15 trillion, which represented 99.80% of its revenues from subsidiaries between FY21 and FY25.

As per the order, Rajesh Exports recorded Rs 114.87 billion in sales and Rs 114.88 billion in purchases with an entity, Affluence Shares and Stocks Pvt Ltd, but Affluence denied any such transactions. SEBI alleged these were non-genuine entries linked to owner Rajesh Mehta's personal derivative trades, used to inflate turnover without real economic activity. REUTERS

• MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold	US Dollar
74,346.17	23,405.60	₹1,55,036	₹95.71
-303.67	-77.95		
-0.41%	-0.33%	Silver	Oil
		₹2,61,575	\$96.12

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 2, 2026

Rate hike to forex deposits: What does 'undervalued' rupee really need

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 3

THE RESERVE Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee began its three-day meeting on Wednesday. And while the committee is widely expected to retain the policy repo rate at 5.25%, a small but vocal segment is predicting an interest rate hike on Friday due to the tremendous pressure the rupee has been under and to "pre-emptively" stamp out upside risks to inflation.

Back in 2013, the RBI had raised interest rates to defend the rupee. But that did not work. What did work was quickly raising Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) Deposits. Of course, such a scheme, wherein banks get a subsidy of sorts from the RBI on the interest they pay on these deposits, would be far more expensive now as global interest rates are much higher than they were in 2013.

Moreover, as Nomura economists point out, "if large rate hikes are used to defend FX, then weaker growth prospects will trigger more capital outflows." Another option is a subsidised window to encourage

public sector enterprises to borrow more from abroad.

Whatever route the authorities choose, the amount that needs to be raised is substantially more than the \$26 billion mobilised in 2013 through the FCNR(B) scheme.

"It has to be \$50-60 billion at least," said an economist, requesting anonymity.

"Considering the size of the Indian economy has increased in the last decade, the money that is raised should be sufficient to change the thinking of investors. The narrative around the rupee needs to be changed very quickly and a big sum of foreign capital can do that."

The rupee narrative

Having fallen by more than 10% against the US dollar over the last year, the RBI thinks the rupee is now undervalued, with Governor Sanjay Malhotra saying as much in an interview last week, pointing at the currency's Real Effective Exchange Rate, which fell to 90.96 in April — the lowest since September 2013.

The REER measures the rupee's value against a basket of

40 currencies, affording weights to each depending on India's non-service trade in that currency. But is the rupee undervalued in the first place?

As has been pointed out by economists repeatedly, the current currency weakness episode is rooted in the subdued capital inflows — since April 2024, net inflow from Foreign Direct Investment and Foreign Portfolio Investors is (-)\$18.4 billion. But FDI inflows have been slowing down for years now. As

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran himself wrote in this paper last month, the 10 years prior to 2022 saw extraordinarily low interest rates and "produced an artificial compression of risk premia globally, flooding emerging markets with capital that was, in effect, seeking any yield whatsoever".

India was one of the beneficiaries of this low-interest rate era: when US interest rates were near zero, net FDI into India rose. But what's more important is what happened before 2010: according to Sajjid Chinoy, Head of Asia Economic Research at JPMorgan, it is only between 2005 and 2010 that net

FDI into India has meaningfully diverged from US bond yields. "This should not be a surprise because these were the years when India saw a large private capex cycle which was pulling in strong FDI flows. What all this points to is that FDI is, unsurprisingly, governed both by 'pull' and 'push' factors," Chinoy said.

If the value of the rupee, and the REER, in the decade prior to 2022 was due to the near-zero interest rates abroad, should it really be deemed undervalued when monetary policies have normalised?

"If this is a case of a structural fall in the BoP, then a weaker currency is the correct outcome. But if the currency weakness has been substantial and pointing towards undervaluation, authorities may want to push the value higher, towards equilibrium. The truth is that it is hard to tell for sure in the immediate how much of the fall is due to a change in the equilibrium level, and how much is due to overshooting," HSBC economists led by Pranju Bhandari said in a report on Wednesday.

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Corporate Identity No. (CIN): L28920MH1919PLC000567
Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Horni Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: +91 22 6665 8282 email: tatapower@tatapower.com Website: www.tatapower.com

NOTICE OF THE 107th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the 107th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of The Tata Power Company Limited (the Company) will be held on **Tuesday, July 7, 2026 at 10:30 a.m. (IST)** through Video Conference (VC)/Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM), to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of the AGM, in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (the Act) and rules made thereunder, pursuant to General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, 02/2022 dated May 5, 2022 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, (collectively referred to as MCA Circulars).

In compliance with the above Circulars and provisions of Regulations 36(1), 44(4) and 58(1) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (SEBI)(Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (Listing Regulations), the Company will be sending the electronic copy of the Notice of the 107th AGM along with the link for the Integrated Annual Report of the Company for FY26 to the Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ MUFIS Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) - Registrar to an issue and Share Transfer Agent (RTA)/ National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) and/or Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), (NSDL and CDSL collectively referred to as Depositories). In addition, a letter will be sent to the Members whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depositories/Depository Participants(DPs), providing the weblink where the Annual Report will be uploaded on website. The Company shall send the physical copy of the Annual Report for FY26 only to those Members who specifically request the same at investorcomplaints@tatapower.com by mentioning their Folio numbers/DP ID and Client ID.

The Integrated Annual Report along with the Notice of the 107th AGM will also be available on the website of the Company at <https://www.tatapower.com/investor-resource-center/annual-reports-tab>, the websites of BSE Limited (BSE) at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) at www.nseindia.com, and on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

Members can attend and participate in the AGM through the VCI/ OAVM facility ONLY. Members attending the AGM through the VCI/ OAVM shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Act. The detailed instructions for joining the AGM are provided in the Notice of the AGM. Members may also view the live webcast of the AGM provided by NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

REMOTE E-VOTING:
The detailed instructions pertaining to (a) Remote e-voting before the AGM and (b) e-voting on the day of the AGM will be provided in the Notice of the AGM. The remote e-voting facility would be available during the following period:

Commencement of e-voting	Friday, July 3, 2026 from 9:00 a.m. (IST)
End of e-voting	Monday, July 6, 2026 at 5:00 p.m. (IST)

REGISTRATION OF EMAIL ADDRESSES AND UPDATION OF BANK DETAILS:
Eligible Members who have not registered their email addresses with the RTA, are required to provide the same to the RTA, **on or before 5:00 p.m. (IST) on Tuesday, June 30, 2026**, to receive the Notice of the AGM and the Integrated Annual Report for FY26 by clicking the link https://web.in.mpmg.mufg.com/EmailReg/Email_Register.html and completing the registration process as guided therein. The email addresses registered through the above process shall be used solely for the purpose of sending the Notice and other communications relating to the current event.

To register email address for all future correspondence and update the bank details, please follow the process given below:

Physical Holding	Register/Update the details in the prescribed Form ISR-I and other relevant forms with RTA and the said forms are available on the website of the RTA at https://web.in.mpmg.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html
Demat Holding	Register/Update the details in your demat account, as per the process advised by your DPs.

Those Members who have already registered their email addresses are requested to keep their email addresses validated/updated with the RTA/DPs/Depositories to enable receipt of notices, documents, Integrated Annual Reports and other communications electronically, in future.

MANDATORY UPDATION OF KYC DETAILS FOR DIVIDEND PROCESSING
In compliance with the SEBI Master Circular the Company shall pay dividend to Members holding shares in physical form only through electronic mode and upon their folio being KYC compliant. Shareholders are requested to update their PAN, Contact Details (Postal Address with PIN and Mobile Number), Bank Account Details, Specimen Signature, etc., for their corresponding physical folios with the Company or its RTA. For detailed process, please visit the website of the Company at <https://www.tatapower.com/investor-resource-center/investor-services-forms-tab> and of RTA at <https://web.in.mpmg.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html> and follow the prescribed process. The same is also included in 'Notes' section of the Notice of the AGM.

For Members holding shares in dematerialised form, we request you to please ensure that your electronic bank mandate is updated with your DP by **Monday, June 22, 2026**. The Company will not be able to accede to any direct request from such Members for change/addition/deletion in such bank details.

Please note that instructions, if any, already given by Members in respect of shares held in physical form will not be automatically applicable to the dividend paid on shares held by the same shareholders in electronic form.

RECORD DATE AND DIVIDEND:
The Record Date for determining the entitlement of Members to receive dividend for FY26 is **Tuesday, June 23, 2026**. The dividend of ₹ 2.50 per equity share of ₹ 1 each (250%), if approved by the Members at the AGM, will be paid subject to deduction of tax at source (TDS), on or after **Friday, July 10, 2026**.

TAX ON DIVIDEND:
Pursuant to the Finance Act, 2020, dividend income is taxable in the hands of the Members. Accordingly, the Company is required to deduct tax at source (TDS) on dividend payments as per the rates prescribed under the Income-tax Act, 2025 (IT Act).

To facilitate accurate TDS deduction, Members are requested to update their Residential Status, PAN, and Category under the IT Act with their respective DP (in case of dematerialised holdings) or with the Company/RTA (for physical holdings) by submitting the requisite documents via email by **Monday, June 22, 2026**.

For detailed guidance, Members may refer to the Company's website at <https://www.tatapower.com/investor-resource-center/tds-on-dividend-tab> and the email communication sent on May 25, 2026 to registered email addresses.

For The Tata Power Company Limited
Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS No.: 7021

Place: Mumbai
Date: June 3, 2026

RBI rate pause likely to stabilise growth: Setty

Mumbai: State Bank of India (SBI) Chairman CS Setty on Wednesday said the growth momentum in the economy is likely to stabilise if the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) maintains the status quo on policy rates amid lingering inflation concerns.

Speaking at the Citi 2026 India Conference, he said market expectations are largely aligned towards a pause in interest rates. The RBI's Monetary Policy Committee is scheduled to announce its monetary policy decision on June 5.

"Growth and inflation dynamics are more important. I

think a pause will definitely help us to stabilise in terms of ensuring that smooth growth rates are achieved," he said. To reach the status of a developed economy, the focus must shift to rural prosperity, urban transformation, human capital investment (leveraging India's demographic dividend), and globally competitive manufacturing, he said.

As India targets infrastructure and innovation-led growth, banks must evolve by leveraging AI for hyper-personalization, integrating ESG considerations, and maintaining high governance standards, Setty said. ENS

SML MAHINDRA LIMITED
(Formerly SML ISUZU Limited) | CIN: L60101PB1983PLC005516
Regd. Office & Works: Village Asron, Distt. Shahid Bhagat Singh Nagar, (Nawanshahr) Punjab -144 533, Phone: 01881- 270155.
Corporate Office: 1st Floor, T7 Tech Park, C-119, Industrial Area Phase-7, Sector 73, Mohali, SAS Nagar, Punjab-160055. Phone: 0172- 2647700-02; 0172-4155901
Email: investors@smlmahindra.com | Website: www.smlmahindra.com

NOTICE
Second 100 Day Campaign- "Saksham Niveshak" - for KYC and other related updation and shareholder engagement to prevent Transfer of Unpaid / Unclaimed dividends to Investor Education and Protection Fund ("IEPF")

Notice is hereby given to the Shareholders of SML Mahindra Limited ("the Company") that pursuant to Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority ("IEPFA"), Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") vide communication dated 27th March, 2026, has directed Companies to initiate second 100 day campaign "Saksham Niveshak" from 1st April, 2026 to 9th July, 2026. During this campaign all the shareholders who have not claimed their dividends or have not updated their KYC & nomination details or face any issues related to unclaimed dividends and shares may write to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent ("RTA") i.e. M/s MCS Share Transfer Agent Limited at their address 173-180, DSIDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase -1, New Delhi - 110020 or at Email Id - helpdeskdelhi@mcsregistrars.com or to the Company at e-mail Id: investors@smlmahindra.com.

The shareholders may further note that this campaign has been started proactively and specifically to reach out to the shareholders to update their KYC, bank mandates, Nominee and contact information etc. and claim their unpaid/ unclaimed Dividend in order to prevent their shares and dividend amount from being transferred to the IEPFA.

For SML MAHINDRA LIMITED
PARVESH MADAN
Company Secretary | ACS-31266

Place: Mohali, Punjab
Date: 03.06.2026



KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

(CIN : U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No. CEE/T&P/SE-1/2026-27/2174-86 Date : 02.06.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL ONLY)

KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Partial Turnkey basis**.

Sl No.	Enquiry numbers & Name of the Works
1	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_IDENT3808 Establishing 2x12.5MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Paduvalahippe Village with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of 1.520kms in Holenarasipura Taluk, Hassan District.
2	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_IDENT3809 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Kumbenahally Village with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of 0.07kms in Channarayapatna Taluk, Hassan District.
3	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_IDENT3810 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Guddenahalli (Kodagihalli) with associated 66kV LILO line for a distance of 6.663 kms in Alur Taluk, Hassan District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after **08.06.2026 at 15:00hrs**. **Last date & time for receipt of bids and any extension of due date for bid submission will be intimated in the KPP Portal.** Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.

All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the bids.

**Sd/- Chief Engineer (Electy.), Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL,
9th Floor, Indhana Bhavana, A.R Circle, Bengaluru-560 009.**

Indian travellers can make UPI payments in Cambodia

Mumbai: India and Cambodia have launched cross-border connectivity of their payment systems, enabling Indian travellers to make payments using Unified Payments Interface (UPI) at QR code-enabled merchant outlets across Cambodia. The facility was inaugur-

ated in Phnom Penh on June 2, marking the operationalisation of the first phase of collaboration between NPCI International Payments Ltd (NPCI) and Acleda Bank Plc. The initiative has been undertaken under the aegis of RBI and the National Bank of Cambodia. ENS

E-Tender Notice

No.-NGP/COM/Catering/E-Tender Dt.01.06.2026.

Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial), South East Central Railway, Nagpur for and on behalf of President of India invites bids through E-Auction System i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for the work of "Contract for setting up, operation, maintenance, and management of Premium Brand Catering Outlet" at various stations over Nagpur Division, for a period of 05 (five) Years, as detailed under:

Sr. 1. Station Name : NSB Itwari (Nagpur, MS) **Location** : Between PMJBK and Salon, Near Exit Gate, North Side, NSB Itwari, **Area** : 220 Sqft

Sr. 2. Station Name : Gondia (Nagpur, MS) **Location** : Between RCR (Rail Coach Restaurant) and MFC (Multi-functional Complex), circulating area, South Side, Gondia,, **Area** : 1500 Sqft **Time and Date for Closure for submission of E-Auction** : Upto 13:25 Hrs on 12.06.2026, through online www.ireps.gov.in portal only.

Details of location, Eligibility Criteria, Financial Criteria, Annual Turnover, Technical Criteria, Legal Status of the Bidder, Experience, Mandatory Requirements, all the instructions, etc. are available on e-tendering portal <http://ireps.gov.in>. The intending Bidder(s) must be registered on e-tendering portal <http://ireps.gov.in>. Those who are not registered on the e-tendering portal shall require to get registered beforehand. Only after registration Bidder(s) can participate in e-auction process.

Div. Railway Manager (Commercial)
AAA/25/97 S.E.C. Railway, Nagpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Email: dycmmgkpd@gmail.com
Website:

www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & www.tenders.gov.in

Tender Notice No. 02
Date: 01.06.2026

Invitation of Tenders through E-procurements system

Dy. Chief Material Manager/North Eastern Railway/ Gorakhpur and on behalf of the President of India, invites tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items. Complete description of the item and other condition are available on www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & www.tenders.gov.in; **Sr. No.: 1; Tender No. & Due Date:** 10266337; **DI. 22.06.2026; Brief Description of Stores:** Supply and Commissioning of Micro Controller Based Electronic Speed Indicating etc.; **Qty. Required:** 21 Set; **Earnest Money(₹):** 1,23,410/-; **Sr. No.: 2; Tender No. & Due Date:** 10249774D; **DI. 23.06.2026; Brief Description of Stores:** Supply, Installation and Commissioning of CO2 Welding Machine etc.; **Qty. Required:** 25 Nos.; **Earnest Money(₹):** 3,03,520/-; 1. Above Tenders are available on IREPS site i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in> the firm desirous in participating against e-tender are advised to electronically regd. themselves on the above website for which they would required to obtain class-III digital certificate (if already not obtain) from certifying agencies authorized under govt. of India IT Act. 2000. Manual offers will not be accepted. 2. Advertised tender and bulletin tenders of DY.CMM/ Depot office/NER are being opened through EPS (E-procurement System) only. Firms desiring to participate in DY.CMM/Depot. Tenders should obtain necessary digital certificate and get themselves registered with CRIS/New Delhi. Necessary details in this regard can be obtained from the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. 3. In case of difference between English and Hindi version of the Tender notice the English version shall prevail. 4. Head of allocation towards cost of S D Money is 00844517 & Earnest Money is 00084506. 5. The tender cost & EMD will be accepted through online payment on IREPS portal only for the tender published on or after 01.09.2016 against all the DY. CMM/Depot/NER/GKP tenders except Global tender.

Dy. Chief Material Manager/Depot CPRO-5/20 Gorakhpur
DO NOT SMOKE BID/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

FORM NO.14
[See Regulation 33(2)]
OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER - I/II
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DELHI (DRT 3)
4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001
DEMAND NOTICE

NOTICE UNDER SECTIONS 25 TO 28 OF THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS & BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993 AND RULE 2 OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961.
RC/14/2026 01-06-2026

STATE BANK OF INDIA
Versus
ARISE INDIA LIMITED AND ORS

To,
(CD 1) **MR. AVINASH JAIN D-2 S/o Shri Naresh Chand Jain**
A-3 71, Janakpuri, New Delhi – 110058 Also At: B-38, Jain Chowk, Mangla Puri, Palam, New Delhi – 110045
(CD 2) **MR. NARESH CHAND JAIN D-4 S/o Shri Choti Lal Jain**
A-3 71, Janakpuri, New Delhi – 110058 Also At: B-38, Jain Chowk, Mangla Puri, Palam, New Delhi – 110045
(CD 3) **MS KEMFLOW POWER PVT. LTD D-9**
B 29 Jain Chowk, Maglapuri, Palam Colony, New Delhi – 110045
(CD 4) **MS JAINEX TECHNO POWER PVT. LTD. D-10**
9, Library Face 3 Extension, Ishwar Colony, Village-Bawana, New Delhi – 110039

This is to notify that as per the Recovery Certificate issued in pursuance of orders passed by the Presiding Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DELHI (DRT 3) in **TA/320/2022** an amount of **Rs. 2556245273.89 (Rupees Two Fifty Five Crores Sixty Two Lakhs Forty Five Thousands Two Hundred Seventy Three And Paise Eighty Nine Only)** along with pendente lite and future interest @ 13% Simple Interest Yearly w.e.f. **20/10/2018** till realization and costs of **Rs. 150000 (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousands Only)** has become due against you (Jointly and severally/Fully/Limited).

2. You are hereby directed to pay the above sum within 15 days of the receipts of the notice, failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 and Rules there under.

3. You are hereby ordered to declare on an affidavit the particulars of yours assets on or before the next date of hearing.

4. You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on **13.07.2026 at 10:30 a.m.** for further proceedings.

5. In addition to the sum aforesaid, you will also be liable to pay:
(a) Such interests as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the certificate / execution proceedings.

(b) All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and warrants and other processes and all other proceedings taken for recovering the amount due.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: **01.06.2026**

Sd/- Recovery Officer
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DELHI(DRT 3)

उद्यान विभाग, हरियाणा
पुष्प एवं बीज उत्पादन तकनीकी उत्कृष्टता केन्द्र,
मुनीमपुर (झज्जर)-124105
ई-मेल: coemunimpur@gmail.com

शुद्धिपत्र:- 2

फूलों के सर्वश्रेष्ठ उत्पादक के नामांकन आमंत्रित हेतु सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि पुष्प एवं बीज उत्पादन तकनीकी उत्कृष्टता केन्द्र, मुनीमपुर, झज्जर के उद्घाटन के अवसर पर हरियाणा राज्य से फूलों के सर्वश्रेष्ठ उत्पादक को इनाम दिए जाएंगे। इसके लिए किसान अपना नामांकन निम्नलिखित निर्धारित फार्म में भरकर दिनांक 05/06/2026 तक संबंधित जिला बागवानी अधिकारी के कार्यालय में जमा करवा सकते हैं।

क्र०.स०.	किसान एवं उसकी खेती से संबंधित जानकारी	किसान द्वारा भरा जाना है विवरण क्षेत्रफल है०./बंर
1	किसान का नाम	
2	पिता का नाम	
3	पता, ब्लॉक, जिला, मोबाईल नंबर इत्यादि	
4	खुले क्षेत्र में फूलों का क्षेत्रफल (है०.)	
5	सरक्षित सचनानाओं में फूलों का क्षेत्रफल है०.)	
6	सूक्ष्म सिंचाई विधि का नाम व क्षेत्रफल (है०.)	
7	तुड़ाई उपरांत प्रबंधन सुविधाएं (शेड, पैक हाउस, ग्रेडिंग, पैकिंग)	
8	प्रशिक्षण का विवरण एवं संख्या (राष्ट्रीय / अंतरराष्ट्रीय / राज्य स्तरीय)	
9	बिक्री व्यवस्था, ब्रांडिंग, ऑनलाइन आदि	
10	मूल्य संवर्धन (Value Addition)	
12	बीज उत्पादन	

किसान के हस्ताक्षर

नोट :

- विजेता किसान का चयन विभागीय कमेटी द्वारा किया जाएगा, जोकि सर्वमान्य होगा।
- उपरोक्त नामांकन को संबंधित जिला उद्यान अधिकारी से सत्यापन करवाना अनिवार्य है।

हस्ता/-
परियोजना अधिकारी कम विषय वस्तु विशेषज्ञ
पुष्प एवं बीज उत्पादन तकनीकी उत्कृष्टता केन्द्र,
मुनीमपुर, झज्जर
No. 45854/HRY

**भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड**
Container Corporation of India Ltd.
(Public limited company) (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
NSIC New MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Indl. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110026

INVITATION FOR E-TENDER
CONCOR invites E-Bids for **Open e-Tender (Single Bid System)** for "Annual maintenance contract for Operation & Maintenance of Firefighting and Fire Alarm Systems at DCT/KHDB (Khodiyar) Gandhi Nagar, Gujarat."

Tender No.	CON/FP/0&M/DCT-KHDB/A-IU/E-99747/2026
Total Estimated Cost	₹ 63,60,932.68/- (Intd. GST)
Period of the contract	24 Months (02 Years)
Cost of Tender documents (Non-refundable)	₹ 1,120/- (inclusive of all taxes and duties through e-payment)
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	From 3,540/- (inclusive of 18% GST) through e-payment which is Non- refundable)
Earnest Deposit Money	₹ 1,27,219/- (through e-payment)
Date of sale of tender (online)	From 04.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. To 24.06.2026 up to 12:30 Hrs.
Last Date & Time of submission	24.06.2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. (E-Tendering Mode Only)
Date and time of Opening Tender	24.06.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

The complete Tender Document for eligibility criteria and other details can be viewed & downloaded only from the website (www.tenderaward.com/CCIL). The tender notice is also available on the website www.concorindia.co.in and website of Public Procurement Portal (<http://eprocure.gov.in>). Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.

Group General Manager/P&S/Area-II

GOVERNMENT OF NCT OF DELHI DEPARTMENT OF WOMEN AND CHILD DEVELOPMENT (STATE CHILD PROTECTION SOCIETY) ISBT Building, Kashmiri Gate, Delhi-110006

F.- No. DWCD-E021/15/2026-CPU-HQ-WCD-/

ADVERTISEMENT

Applications are invited for vacancies in State Child Protection Society, District Child Protection Units, Juvenile Justice Boards, Child Welfare Committees & Special Juvenile Police Units constituted under Mission Vatsalya Scheme for the following posts purely on contractual basis initially for period of one year as per provisions laid down by Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India: -

S.NO.	POST NAME	REMUNERATION PER MONTH (CONSOLIDATED)	NO. OF VACANT POSTS
STATE CHILD PROTECTION SOCIETY			
1	Programme Officer	34,755/-*	UR-01
DISTRICT CHILD PROTECTION UNITS, JUVENILE JUSTICE BOARDS, CHILD WELFARE COMMITTEE AND SPECIAL JUVENILE POLICE UNITS			
1.	District Child Protection Officer	44,023/-*	OBC-01. ST-01
2.	Protection Officer (Institutional Care)	27,804/-*	UR-04, OBC-03, SC-01
3.	Protection Officer (Non-Institutional Care)	27,804/-*	UR-04, OBC-03
4.	Legal cum Probation Officer	27,804/-*	UR-02, EWS-01
5.	Counselor	24,356/**	UR-01 OBC-02, ST-01
6.	Social Worker	24,356/**	UR-03, SC-01, ST-03, EWS-04
7.	Accountant	24,356/**	UR-04, EWS-01, OBC-01
8.	Data Analyst	24,356/**	OBC-01, SC-01, ST-01, EWS-01
9.	Assistant cum Data Entry Operator	22,411/-**	UR-03, SC-02, ST-02, EWS-02
10.	Out Reach Worker	22,411/-**	UR-03, OBC-02, SC-02

*Consolidated remuneration as per Mission Vatsalya Scheme.

**Consolidated remuneration as per Minimum Wages.

The application process shall commence from [05/06/2026, 12:01 AM] and the last date for submission will be [26/06/2026] by 11:59 PM.

The terms of references (TORs), essential qualification, eligibility criteria, experience required, job details are available on the Department website: <https://www.wcd.delhi.gov.in> and refer link <http://cams.wcdcln.in> for apply online.

Candidates may apply online from the date of publication of this advertisement. The recruitment is purely on a contract basis, initially for a period of one year. This is not a permanent job with either the Government of NCT of Delhi or the Government of India.

After scrutiny of applications the list of eligible candidates will be displayed on the website of the Department. The candidates are advised to regularly check the official website of the department to know the latest updates in this regard.

Only shortlisted candidates will be called for interview and decision of selection committee shall be final and binding. In this regard, the department's notice board and official website may be referred at: <https://www.wcd.delhi.gov.in>. The shortlisted candidates will be informed through E-mail also.

Reservation will be applicable as per the rules of the State government. The applicant must meet the age requirement specified in the Terms of Reference for each post and should not exceed this age as of the application closing date.

Further age relaxation will be provided to the applicants already working in the Department of WCD, GNCTD on the basis of their departmental experience.

Note: Only online applications shall be entertained by the Department of WCD. The department also reserves the right to decrease or increase number of posts in each category mentioned in the table at any stage / point of time. Department further reserves the rights to terminate this contract work at any stage/point of time. A candidate shall be eligible to apply for only one post. In case a candidate applies for more than one post, all applications submitted by the candidate shall be summarily rejected.

By Order
Secretary & Chairperson (SCPS)
Department of Women and Child Development, GNCTD
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0094/26-27

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाल प्रथम जोधपुर
क्रमांक: 2299 दिनांक: 25-05-2026

निविदा संशोधन सूचना-1
(निविदा सूचना संख्या ०३/2026-27)
NIB Code No.PWD2627A0589

इस कार्यालय द्वारा जारी निविदा सूचना संख्या 3/2025-26 दिनांक 18.05.2026 में क्रम संख्या 3 पर अंकित कार्य **"सड़क चौड़ाकरण कार्य कालनी जवाहरपुर से 1/4 बसुआल"** की अंतिमस्त निविदा प्रस्तुत किये जाने को दिनांक 15.06.2026 यानि 6.00 बजे तक अपरिहार्य कारणों से बढ़ाई जाती है एवं तकनीकी निविदा 16.06.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। इस कार्य की अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 300.00 लाख के स्थान पर राशि रु. 310.33 पड़ी जाये।
निविदा में निर्माण अन्य सभी शर्तें यथवत रहेंगी।

3. PWD2627WS0802672
हस्ता/-
(एच.सी. शर्मा)
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता,
सानिधि, संभाल प्रथम, जोधपुर

DIPR/C/9376/2026

कार्यालय जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी, नूंह कुटेशन आमंत्रण

21 जून 2026 को 12वें अन्तर्राष्ट्रीय योग दिवस के जिला स्तरीय कार्यक्रम का आयोजन परेड ग्राउंड, पुलिस लाइन, नूंह में किया जाना है। इसके लिए निम्नलिखित साजो-सामान व सेवाओं के लिए कुटेशन आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

- सफेद टी-शर्ट लोगो सहित (Round Neck and Collor)
- टैट सर्विस के रेट (XL मेट, स्ट्रेज, टेबल विद पेपर, कुर्सी फोम, कुर्सी कवर, पाईप पंडाल, वाल पर्दा, छिडको, कडेदान, चादर सफेद, कुलर, कालीन, फोम गद्दा)
- साउड सिस्टम, जनेरेटर 20 के0वी0
- विडियोग्राफी, फोटोग्राफी, ड्रोन विडियो, स्क्रीन 12x8 फुट ।
- बैनर, होर्डिंग्स व फ्लैक्स साईट पर लगाने सहित।
- खाद्य सामग्री (बिस्कुट MRP-5, केला (Kg), जौरा पानी MRP-10)

नोट:- इच्छुक फर्म अपनी कुटेशन बंद लिफाफे में जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी, नूंह के नाम दिनांक 10.06.2026 को सांघ 03:00 बजे तक जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी कार्यालय, स्थित नंगली रोड, नजदीक एम-डी-ए-ऑफिस, नूंह-122107 में भिजवाए। सभी कुटेशन अतिरिक्त उपायुक्त, नूंह की अध्यक्षता में खरीद कमेटी के सदस्यों के समक्ष व फर्म के सदस्यों को मौजूदगी में दिनांक 11.06.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे अतिरिक्त उपायुक्त कार्यालय, नूंह में खोली जाएगी। वस्तुओं की मात्रा घटाई या बढ़ाई जा सकती है। कुटेशन के सम्वध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी के लिए जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी कार्यालय, नूंह में सभी कार्य दिवस में प्रातः 09 बजे से सांघ 05 बजे तक जानकारी प्राप्त कर सकते है।

हस्ता/-
जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी
नूंह।
No. 45864/hry

कार्यालय जिला आयुर्वेद अधिकारी, महेन्द्रगढ़ स्थित नारनौल। कोटेशन आमंत्रित

12वें अन्तर्राष्ट्रीय योग दिवस 21 जून 2026 के जिला स्तरीय कार्यक्रम का आयोजन 21 जून 2026 को आईटीआई ब्रॉय नारनौल में मनाया जाएगा। इसके लिए निम्नलिखित वस्तुओं व सेवाओं के लिए कुटेशन में आमंत्रित की जाती है-

- टैट सर्विस चादर प्रूफ व सामान्य दोनों के रेट्स, कुर्सियां सामान्य व गद्दे वाली, सोफा सैट सेंटर टेबल-5, कारपेट, कालीन, मैटिंग, स्पीच स्टैंड, प्रवेश द्वार इत्यादि।
- साउंड सिस्टम व जनेरेटर (62 केवी) इत्यादि।
- एल-ई-डी-ए स्क्रीन व विडियोग्राफी / फोटोग्राफी एचडी विडियोग्राफी, एडिटिंग सहित।
- टी-शर्ट (लोगो सहित), सभी साईज।
- बैनर, होर्डिंग व फ्लैक्स साईट पर लगाने सहित।
- खाद्य सामग्री (बिस्कुट, नमकीन, मिठाई, नारियल पानी, फल, फ्रूट ड्रिंक, चाय-पानी आदि) ।
- निर्माण कार्ड, प्रशस्ति पत्र व औषधीय पौधे साईज सहित।
- फूल मालाएं व फलों की टोकरी व स्ट्रेज सजावट सामग्री।

नोट:- इच्छुक फर्म अपनी कुटेशन बंद लिफाफे में जिला आयुर्वेद अधिकारी, नारनौल के नाम दिनांक 12-06-2026 को दोपहर 01.00 बजे तक चाचा खेतानाथ राज-0 आयुर्वेदिक अस्पताल, पटीकरा नारनौल के प्रांगण में स्थित जिला आयुर्वेद अधिकारी, नारनौल, के कार्यालय के प्रथम मंजिल पर कमरा नंबर 107 में भिजवाए। कुटेशन में नाराधीश, नारनौल की अध्यक्षता में गठित कमेटी सदस्यों के समक्ष व फर्म सदस्यों की मौजूदगी में दिनांक 12-06-2026 को दोपहर बाद 3 बजे उपायुक्त महोदय महेन्द्रगढ़ स्थित नारनौल के कार्यालय में खोली जाएगी। वस्तुओं की मात्रा में कमी या बढ़ोतरी की जा सकती है। निविदा के संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी तथा शर्तें जिला आयुर्वेद अधिकारी के कार्यालय से दिनांक 12-06-2026 को दोपहर 1.00 बजे तक प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

हस्ता/-
जिला आयुर्वेद अधिकारी
महेन्द्रगढ़ स्थित नारनौल
No. 45863/hry

**बिहार सहस्र शिक्षा**

प्राचार्य का कार्यालय
दरभंगा चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, लहेरियासराय
वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 के अन्तर्गत निविदा का नियम एवं शर्तें

दरभंगा चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, लहेरियासराय के लिये वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 हेतु विभिन्न विभागों के लिए विविध सामग्री, स्टेशनरी, मशीनों की मरम्मत, लकड़ी एवं स्टील उपकरणों की मरम्मत वाईडिंग एवं प्रीटिंग, दवा किट आदि के कम्प / कार्य / मरम्मत के लिये दर अनुमोदन हेतु मुहर बंद लिफाफे में बिहार वाणिज्य कर में निबंधित सरकारी / गैर सरकारी निर्माता फर्म या प्राधिकृत आपूर्तिकर्ताओं से निबंधित डाक / स्पीड पोस्ट द्वारा निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। इस संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय में कार्यरत दिन में निविदा प्रकाशन के पश्चात सम्पर्क स्थापित कर सकते हैं। प्रथम प्रकाशन की तिथि से 21 दिनों के अन्दर निविदा / सामानों कार्यों की सूची, शर्तें एवं नियम तथा अद्यतन राशि की विवरण महाविद्यालय के **Website www.dmc.edu.in** पर देखा जा सकता है, तथा उसे डाउनलोड कर निविदा समर्पित कर सकते हैं। साथ ही किसी भी कार्य दिवस के दिन निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि से 21 दिनों तक कार्यालय से निविदा / सामानों / कार्यों की सूची, शर्तें एवं नियम आदि आवेदन देकर निःशुल्क प्राप्त किया जा सकता है। प्रथम निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि से 21वें दिन के अपराहन 5:00 बजे तक निविदा स्वीकार्य किया जायेगा। यदि 21वें दिन किसी प्रकार की छुट्टी रहती है, या अपरिहार्य कारण से प्राचार्य कार्यालय बंद रहता तो उसके अगले दिन डाक विभाग से 21वें दिन को प्राप्त निविदा को ली जायेगी। उपर्युक्त दिए गए अवधि के पश्चात् प्राप्त निविदा पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि के उपरांत तीन दिनों के अन्दर कम्प समिति के समक्ष निविदा कार्यालय अवधि में अपराहन में खोला जायेगा, जिसमें निविदादाता या उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत व्यक्ति उपस्थित रह सकते हैं। इसके लिए अलग से सूचना नहीं दी जायेगी। बैठक में भाग नहीं लेने वाले द्वारा किसी प्रकार की दावा मान्य नहीं होगा। बैठक की तिथि कार्यालय के सूचना पट अथवा कॉलेज के वेबसाइट पर पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

प्राचार्य
दरभंगा चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, लहेरियासराय
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

**बिहार सहस्र शिक्षा**

उत्पाद न्यायालय, वरीय उप समाहर्ता
पटना जिला विधि शाखा, पटना
(पटना समाहर्णालय, गॉँधी मैदान, पटना-800001)

बिहार मद्यनिषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित 2018 एवं 2022)
के अन्तर्गत जब्त वाहनों के मालिकों के लिए नोटिस
(अति अत्यकालीन)
एवं द्वारा निम्नलिखित वाहनों के मालिकों को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्यनिषेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित 2018 एवं 2022) के अन्तर्गत साहायक **आयुक्त मद्यनिषेध, पटना** द्वारा उच्च शराब के परिहर्तन के आरोप में आपके वाहन को जब्त कर अधिहरण हेतु समर्पित प्रस्ताव के आलोक में अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में वाहन उत्पाद अधिहरण वाद संचालित है, जिसकी सुनवाई पटना जिला समाहर्णालय के प्रथम तल पर कमरा संख्या-101 में दिनांक-16.06.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे निर्वाचित की गई है।

क्र० सं०	अधिहरण वाद सं०	थाना कांड सं०	जब्त वाहन / निबंधन सं०	वाहन मालिक का पूर्ण पता
1	2	3	4	5
01	153/2025-26	उत्पाद थाना कांड सं०-4080 / 25, दिनांक-11.12.2025	क्रिटा कार निबंधन सं०- D19CAM-5204 चेविस संख्या- MALC381ULHM215713 इंजन संख्या- D4FBHM253230	श्री शिवानी त्यागी, पिता-श्री अंकुर मुनजाल सालो-H.NO.-14, 11nd FLOOR ROAD NO-6, EAST PUNJABIBAG, NEW DELHI पिन-110026

उत्पाद वाहन अधिहरण वाद से उक्त थाना कांड में जप्त वाहन स्वामी अथवा अन्य कोई दावेदार को निदेश दिया जाता है कि वे अपने उपर लगे आरोप को संबंध में न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर स्वयं / अपने प्राधिकृत अधिकृत के माध्यम से निर्धारित तिथि को कारण पृथक् प्रस्तुत करें अन्यथा आपके अनुपस्थित पाये जाने पर एकापक्षीय कार्रवाई करते हुए राज्यसत्ता आदेश जारी कर दिया जायेगा।
(नोट- यदि वाहन स्वामी वाहे तो बिहार मद्यनिषेध और उत्पाद निगमवाली 2021 के नियम 12(क) के उपनियम (2)(उत्पाद-निति-01-03 / 2021 / 3671-31.05.2023) के तहत जिसमें शारिरी की राशि मात्र के बीमाकृत मूल्य के 10 प्रतिशत से कम और 05 (पाँच) लाख से अधिक नहीं होगी। यदि वाहन स्वामी अपने वाहन को विमुक्त कराना चाहते हैं तो प्राप्र-IV में आवेदन दाखिल कर वाहन को विमुक्त करा सकते हैं।)
इसे सख्त ताकीद समझे।

वरीय उप समाहर्ता
जिला विधि शाखा, पटना
PR- 004834 (DST) 2026-27
विस्तृत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार
New Delhi

Classifieds

PERSONAL

It is for general information that I, SUEJET MAHTO S/O JAY JAY RAM MAHTO, R/o Qtr. No. 15/6, Type-1, Block-15, Railway Colony, Sarojini Nagar, PO: Sarojini Nagar, Dist. South West Delhi, Delhi-110023, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as SUJIT KUMAR MAHTO in my minor son SAHIL KUMAR, aged about 8years in his school record. The actual name of mine is SUEJET MAHTO, which may be amended accordingly.

I, **Zarnigar Begum**, W/o, Mohd. Idris, R/o-332-D/1 (D-7), Flat-No. G-1, Ground-Floor, Block-B, Barkat Nishan-Apartment, Gali-No.2, Batla-house, Jamia-Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Zarnigar for all purposes.

I, **Vimlesh W/o Ram Niwas**, R/o 1958, Type -B, Maruti Kunj, Bhondisi(168), Gurgaon (Haryana)-122102, have changed my name to Vimlesh Bhardwaj.

I, **Vashnavi kumari**, d/o-Vipin Singh, R/o F-223, 4th floor, mangal bazar-road Iaxmi-Nagar Guru Nanak pura, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Vaishnavi Kumari.

I, **VARUN S/O SUSHIL KUMAR** R/O A-2/30, Sector-18, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have changed my name to VARUN MATHUR.

I, **Rahul Sharma**, S/o Ravinder Kumar Sharma, R/o-359 Kucha Ghasi Ram Chandni Chowk, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Rahul Kumar Sharma.

I, **Pulakit Gupta** S/o Rajendra Prashad Gupta, R/o-Mata Wali, Gali Dankaur, Greater Noida (U.P.)-203201, have changed my name to Pulkit Gupta, for all purposes.

I, **PRIYANKA SINGH**, D/o Dr. SURENDER SINGH, R/o-D-14,1 3rd-Floor, Saket, New Delhi-110017, have changed the name of my minor daughter NYRA MANJUNATHI POL aged-9-years and she shall hereafter be known as NYRA POL.

I, **NITU SINGH**, W/O-RAVI RANJAN SINGH, R/O-228-D, POCKET-C SFS FLATS, SIDDHARTH EXTENSION, NEW DELHI-110014, have changed my name from NITU SINGH, to NEETU SINGH, for all purposes.

I, **NIRMAL YADAV**, W/O-DHIRENDER YADAV, R/O HOUSE-NO-R-14/201, RAJ NAGAR, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201002, have Changed My Minor Son's Name ANANT TO ANANT YADAV Permanently

I, **Mohd. Shaukeen** S/o Shri Sakur Ali, R/o C-14, Gali No.3, Village-Kotla, Delhi-110091, have changed my name to Mohd. Sokin for all puros.

I, **LOVELEEN KAUR MEHROTRA**, D/O VEER SINGH, R/O-RZ-110 UPPER, GROUND FLOOR, INDRA-PARK, MOHAN GARDEN, UTTAM NAGAR, DELHI-110059, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO LOVELEEN KAUR.

I, **LALITA W/o MOHD AFJAL**, R/O-C-303, BHIM NAGAR, NANGLOI, DELHI-110041, have changed my name to AFREEN in kotak mahindra bank

I, **KM. DOLLY RAWAT**, W/o-Rajender Singh, R/o House No.66, 1st Floor, Type-3, Income Tax Colony Pitampura, Delhi-110034 have changed my name to DOLLY RANA.

I, **KAVITA D/O GAJAY NEGI**, R/O-D-15/674, GALI NO.-4, NEAR KRISHNA MANDIR GANESH NAGAR SHAKARPUR DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KAVITA NEGI.

I, **Amrit Lal**, s/o-Jagan nath Aggarwal, R/o- House no 301-C QU-Block, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to Amrit Lal Aggarwal.

I, **Divyanshu Sangal** alias Divyanshu Singhal, S/o Vivek Sangar, R/o Pundrik Vihar, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, declare both names are of one and the same person and I shall be known as Divyanshu Sangal for all purposes.

I, **DOLLY GODWIN** alias DOLI KUMARI, D/o-Dharam Bahadur, W/o Deepak Godwin, R/o-GS/48, Secomd Floor, Near- VSPK School Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to DOLI GODWIN.

I, **Avnash Chandra Garg**, S/o-Harish Chand Garag, R/o-4221, Gali Ahiran, Pahari, Dhiraj Sadar bazar, Delhi-110006, Have changed my name to Avinash Chander Garg for all purpases

I, **Arvind Sharma**, S/o Anil Kumar Sharma, R/o 6 B-1 A Sector-10, Noida (U.P.)-201301, have changed my name to Arvind Kumar Sharma for all purposes.

I, **Akash Daljit Singh Sihag** S/o Daljit Singh, 43-D, Begampur Village, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-17 have changed my name to AKASH SIHAG.

I, **Akansha D/o Amod Kumar**, R/O A-105, Kalyani Apartments, Sector-6, Vasundhara, Distt. Ghaziabad, h ave changed my name from Akansha to Akansha Tyagi.

I, **Ajay Kumar**, S/o amrit lal Aggarwal, R/o- House no.301-C Block-QU VS, Pitampura Delhi-110034, have changed my name to Ajay Kumar Aggarwal.

I, **AJAY KUMAR SETHI**, S/o Sh.Nabin Sethi, R/o-B-18, Kalpana Villa, Gali No.1, Rajiv-Nagar, Mandoli, Delhi-110093, have changed the name of my minor daughter ARNAPURNA SETHI age-11 years and she shall hereafter be known as AADITRI SETHI.

I, **ABDUL WAHID**, S/O-ABDUL HAMEED, R/O-H.NO.9063, RAM BAGH ROAD, NEAR BAGICHI PEER JI AZAD MARKET, DELHI-110007, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ABDUL WAHEED, FOR FUTURE.

I, **(Army No.3207623Y** Posting HQ-77 MTN BDE C/O 99 APO), S/o Sh. Mahabir H.No.Village Mandauthi, Tehsil-Bahadurgarh Distt-Jhajjar (Haryana)-124506, Subject: Correction of Name and Date-of-Birth of My Mother in Service Record in My Service Record. My Mother Name & Date-of-Birth is Wrongly entered. Krishna Devi and 01/01/1959 in Future my Mother name and D.O.B is known as Krishna and 01/01/1958 Due to Aadhar Card. (Vide Affidavit No.in JCA2026F104 dated-01/01/2026).

I, **YUVAKKSHI GROVER** C/o Shipra Grover, Flat No-UG2, Plot No-290, Sector-4, Vaishali, I.E. Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, UP-201010 have changed my name to YUVAKKSHI.

I, **Vakhong David Thotngam** S/o Vakhong Albert Shngai R/o Khamasom Khullen, Khamasom, PO: Ukhrul, Manipur- 795142, have changed my minor son's name from Thotyo Vakhong Aged 11 Years to Ethan Thotyo Vakhong forever

I, **VARUN SHEKHAR** S/o Vijay Kumar Singh, D-48, Sector-56, Noida, UP-201301 have changed my name to VARUN SHEKHAR SINGH.

I, **Shristi D/o Santa Kumar Sarki** R/o Hosue No-170, Gali No-5, uttranchal Colony, Burari, Kamal Pur, Majra Burari, North Delhi-110084, have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Shristi Roka Sarki

I, **Ruchi D/o Narender Kumar Dabas**, R/o Flat No. 5D, DDA SFS Flats, Pocket-1, Sector-10, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075, have changed my name to Ruchi Dabas.

I, **Satender Kumar**, S/o Harpal Singh, R/o D-332, Svaroop Nagar, Pansali, P.O. Pehlal Pur, North West Delhi, Delhi-110042, hereby declare that my name in all documents is Satender Kumar, which is correct. However, in my bank account, my name is mentioned as Satender Singh. Both names refer to one and the same person.

I, **Santa Kumar** S/O Ranshor Sarki, R/o Hosue No-170, Gali No-5, uttranchal Colony, Burari, Kamal Pur, Majra Burari, North Delhi-110084, have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Santa Kumar Sarki.

I, **SUKHMANI SINGAL** d/o AMAR PREET SINGH SOHAL W/o AKASH SINGH R/o S-288, 3rd Floor, Panchsheel Park, Delhi-110017 have changed my name as SUKHMANI KAUR SOHAL permanently. SUKHMANI SINGAL and SUKHMANI KAUR SOHAL both are one and same person.

I, **Renuka W/o Radhey Shyam**, R/o Flat No. 106, 3rd Floor, Bannu Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changes my name to Renuka Sharma

I, **Ramesh Chawla** S/o. Ishwar Das Chawla R/o H.No. 1, /7256-C, ST. No. Shivaji Park Ext. East Delhi-110032 have changed my name to Ramesh Dutt Chawla

I, **REHANA KHATUN**, W/O MOHAMMAD SARVAR, R/O H.No.-6, Khasra No.-165, Main Chauhan Patti Road, Chauhan Patti Sabha Pur, Delhi-110094, have changed the name of my minor son ZAMEER aged 15 years and he shall hereafter be known as MOHAMMAD ZAMEER.

I, **Pradeep Malik** S/o Shivdan Singh Malik R/o C-9 Sec-33, Noida, Gautam Badh Nagar, UP-201301 has changed my name to Pradeep Singh Malik for all future purposes.

I, **PERVESH GUPTA** R/o-1106, Purn Enclave Colony, Link Road, Kheri Kalan(113), Faridabad-121001, have changed my name to PARVESH KUMAR.

I, **Nupur**, D/O Prem Swaroop R/O Flat No -45, Plot E - 10A, Millennium Sekhri Awas Samiti Ltd, Sector -61, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 201301, have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Nupur Mahamana

I, **Chanda Devi** W/O Gore Lal Jaiswal R/O Kalna, P.O.- Haripur, Marro, Dhanupur, Allah abad, Handia, Uttar Pradesh-221503, have changed my name to Chandrakali.

I, **N K Goyal**, s/o Madan Mohan Goyal, R/o ED 9C, Pitampura, Delhi - 110034, have changed my name to Naval Kishor Goyal.

I, **Mohammad Nasir** S/o Mohammad Bashir, alias Mohammad Basheer R/o R-175, 1st Floor, Gali No-6 Jogabai Extn, Jamia Nagar Delhi, Delhi-110025, inform that in some of my documents the name of my father has been mentioned as Mohammad Basheer instead of Mohammad Bashir. Both Mohammad Basheer and Mohammad Bashir is same and one person

I, **MEENAKSHI VERMA** R/O A-57, Gali No-4, Anarkali Garden, Jagatpuri, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-51, have changed my name to MEENAKSHI VARMA..

I, **Daljit Singh Sihag** alias Daljit Singh Hajarilal Sihag S/o Hajari Singh, 43-D, Begampur Village, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-17 have changed my name to DALJIT SINGH.

I, **Asha Rana** W/o Sh. Sanjay Singh Jaswal, R/O B-87, Gali No.7, Joshi Colony, I.P. Extension, Delhi-110092, Inform that Asha, Asha Devi and Asha Rana is the name of one and same Person.

I, **Arun Kumar**, S/o Sh. Bindeshwari Prasad Sharma R/O Qtr.No.1273, Type-IV(S), Sector-12, R.K. Puram, New Delhi-110022, have changed my minor son name from harsh to harsh sharma for all future purposes.

I, **Sanjay Siddhartha** S/O Ramesh Paramahansa R/O 22 Sardar Patel Marg, Delhi -21, have changed my name to Sanjay Siddharth for all purposes.

I, **Anupama daughter of Late Shri Rajvir Singh** and wife of Shri Pramendra Kumar, residing at House No. D2-292, Vinay Marg, Near Amrit Bhavan, VTC-Chanakypuri, Post-& Police Station- Chanakypuri, District-New Delhi, Delhi-110021, hereby declare that I have changed my name from Anupama to Anupama Pramendra for all future purposes.

I, **Anupama daughter of Late Shri Rajvir Singh** and wife of Shri Pramendra Kumar, residing at House No. D2-292, Vinay Marg, Near Amrit Bhavan, VTC-Chanakypuri, Post-& Police Station- Chanakypuri, District-New Delhi, Delhi-110021, hereby declare that I have changed my name from Anupama to Anupama Pramendra for all future purposes.

I, **RAZAD S/O Dhanram**, 336, Block-14, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, Delhi-62, have changed my name to AZAD SINGH.

I, **Shresth S/o Shri Sudesh Pal**, R/O D-403, Plot No.9, Chitrakoot Apartments, Sector-22, Dwarka, Amberhali, P.O. Dwarka Sector-6, South West District, New Delhi-110075, have changed my name to Shresth Singh for all purposes.

I, **Sanjay Sharma Darmor** R/o Plot No. 9/F Pocket 1, Ramprastha Greens Sector 7, Vaishali I.E. Sahibabad Ghaziabad -201010 Uttar Pradesh have changed the name of my minor daughter aged 13 yrs form Vinaaya Sharma to Vinaaya Sharma Darmor

I, **Sanjay Sharma Darmor** R/o Plot No. 9/F Pocket 1, Ramprastha Greens Sector 7, Vaishali I.E. Sahibabad Ghaziabad -201010 Uttar Pradesh have changed the name of my minor daughter aged 10 yrs from Hrutvi Sharma to Hrutvi Sharma Darmor.

I, **Rajeev Dutt** S/o Rameshwar Dutt, R/O D-56, VTC: Vikas Puri, District: West Delhi, Delhi-110018 have changed the name of my minor son Harshit Dutt age about 17 years and he shall hereafter be known as Harshit Dutt.

I, **RAM KISHOR GAUR** R/O 5490 GALI NO 2 OLD SEELAMPUR GANDHI NAGAR DELHI 110031 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO RAM KISHOR SHARMA FOR ALL PURPOSES

I, **Pratibha Sharma** W/o Sanjay Sharma Darmor R/o Plot No. 9/F Pocket 1, Ramprastha Greens Sector 7, Vaishali I.E. Sahibabad Ghaziabad -201010 Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name to Pratibha Sharma Darmor.

I, **Malti Yadav**, W/o Amar Pal Yadav, R/o Gali No.5, Surender Colony Part-2, Jharoda Mazara, Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Malti Devi for all purposes.

I, **Has Mila** W/o Mohd Shami Hussain R/O R-35, Front Gali No.-3, Chanakya Place Part-2, Uttam Nagar, D.K.Mohan Garden, West Delhi, Delhi - 110059, have changed my name to Hashmeela Khatoon

I, **Aanchal D/o Shri Ramesh Lal**, R/O D-403, Plot No.9, Chitrakoot Apartments, Sector-22, Dwarka, Amberhali, P.O. Dwarka Sector-6, South West District, New Delhi-110075, have changed my name to Aanchal Singh for all purposes.

I, **Vijay Jindal** S/O Sardara Mal Jindal R/O KP-35, Ground Floor, Pitampura, Delhi-110088, have changed my name to Vijay Kumar Jindal.

I, **Prashant Kumar Sadh** S/O Late Shri Vijay Prakash Sadh R/O Flat No.102, Tower-9, Sunworld Vanalika, Sector-107, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name to Prashant Sadh for all future Purposes.

It is for general information that I, **Laxmi D/o Khetpal R/o House No. A-924, Street No.20, Part-4, Pusta, Sonia Vihar, Saba Pur Delhi, North East Delhi, Delhi-110094**, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Kshetrapal in my all educational documents. The actual name of my father is Khetpal, which may be amended accordingly.

LOST & FOUND

Original chain of 2 GPA documents of Shop-No.2 GF, Portion of Plot-No.76, Deep-Vihar, Vikas-Nagar, Uttam-Nagar, New-Delhi-110059, has been lost. I found, contact: Maya Devi, W/o, Ram Singh R/O-A-85, Gali-No.5, Second-Floor Flat-No.8, East Nathu-Colony, Saboli Delhi-110093, Mobile-No. 9891398446.

PUBLIC NOTICE

BE IT KNOWN TO ALL THAT my client Shri Harish Arora S/O Sh. Suraj Bhan R/O K-1635-36, Jahangir Puri, North West Delhi-110033 is hereby severing all his relations, disowning and declaring his son namely Sh. Gaury Arora & his wife Smt. Anjali from any inheritance in his properties and estate with immediate effect. The said person shall have no concern, right, title or interest in any of his properties. Any person dealing with the above person in any manner shall do so at his own risk and consequences. Any act of the said persons shall not be binding on my client.

Sd/- (Sinit Dutt) Advocate (Enr. No. D/487/88) Ch. No. 727, 1st Floor, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

The public and specifically Smt. Kamlesh Shukla and Smt. Bharti Shukla (both of Sector 71, Noida) are notified on behalf of my client Shri Sandeep Shukla regarding the Flat No. 74, Block C-1, Ground Floor, Sector 55, Noida: 1. Property Status: Following the death of owner Late Sh. Bharat Bhushan Shukla on 12/02/2013, the flat devolved equally (1/3rd share each) among his wife, daughter, and my client (son). 2. Possession & Claim: My client holds exclusive possession since 1999 and has spent Rs.11.70 Lakhs on its cost and maintenance. 3. Legal Action: The addressees must cooperate to partition the property within 15 days, failing which law suits for Partition, Possession, and injunction will be filed. WARNING: The public is cautioned against buying, leasing, or transferring this property. Any transaction will be illegal and void. D.K. CHAUBEY & ASSOCIATES (Counsel for Shri Sandeep Shukla) Office: Sector 03, Noida Mob: 875026868 deepakchaubei.kumar@gmail.com Place: Noida Date: 03/06/2026

Public at large is hereby informed that Freehold Plot No. J-9/34, Ground Floor, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi, presently owned and possessed by Shri Jogender Singh Paschna by virtue of Sale Deed duly registered vide Regd. No. 2026/251/12233, dated 04.05.2026 and the same is offered as Bank Premises to State Bank of India and as per present owner's version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance. It is hereby notified that any person and/or Bank, financial institution having any claim, any charge, interest or lien or claim and /or objection to thereof, he/she/they may lodge/ notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof/ court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further/future claim / objection(s) shall be rejected.

SATINDER YADAV (ADVOCATE) Chamber no. 561, 5th Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi, Mob. 9711212421 E-mail: satender175@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Mr. Abhishek Bhasin and Mrs. Neera Bhasin, residents of J-20, Kirti Nagar, Delhi - 110015, hereby inform the general public that the original Tripartite Agreement dated 29.11.2023, executed between Max Estate 128 Pvt. Ltd., Mr. Abhishek Bhasin & Mrs. Neera Bhasin and Axis Bank, in respect of Unit No. 19B, Tower-2, Plot No. TS-02, Estate 128, Jaypee Greens Wshtown, Sector-128, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 201304, has been lost/ misplaced from the possession of Axis Bank and Mr. Abhishek Bhasin. If anyone finds or has any information regarding the said document, kindly contact at: abhi3bhasin@gmail.com

It is hereby notified to the general public that my clients Mrs. Meenu Aday & Manisha Kataly (herein after referred to as "the buyers") have entered into an agreement to sell dated 21.03.2026 with Manesh Mittal S/o Ashok Kumar Mittal, Ashok Kumar Mittal S/o Bri Lal Mittal, Suksham Mittal W/o Ashok Kumar Mittal, Mishi Mittal W/o Manesh Mittal, Rajneesh Mittal S/o Ashok Kumar Mittal, Mrs. Vibha Mittal W/o Rajneesh Mittal (hereinafter referred to as "the sellers") for property bearing APARTMENT NO. OMB-605, TOWER-B, DLF ONE MIDTOWN, MOTI NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110016, where the sellers have received substantial money from the buyers and thereafter the sellers are dishonestly trying to create third party rights over the above said property. That my clients have initiated appropriate legal recourse against the sellers. Therefore, any person intending to purchase, acquire, mortgage, lease or otherwise deal with the said property shall do so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences. The public is cautioned that any transaction concerning the said property shall be deemed to be having the knowledge of the above stated dispute. Any person having any query over the said property may contact me at: AMIT GUPTA (ADVOCATE) B-70, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi, Mobile: +91-8826567009 E-mail: amit.gadavamt.com

PUBLIC NOTICE It is publicly informed that my clients Intizar Ali Sh. Hassan Ali and Sameena W/o Intizar Ali both R/o T-Elthas No.12C/7399, Kirti Nagar, Ram Pratap Bagh, Delhi-110087 have debarred their son Jakin aged about 45 Yrs. and his wife Babiya Begum and their sons Sareen Ali, Aftab Ali and their wives and immovable properties and have severed all relations from Jakim and his wife Babiya Begum and their sons Sareen Ali, Aftab Ali, from all due to their misconduct, bad behaviour and bad intentions. Any person dealing with them shall be doing so at his/her own risk, cost and responsibilities. My Clients shall not be liable and responsible for their any civil or criminal activities.

PUBLIC NOTICE General Public is hereby informed that my client Mrs. Sarvesh W/o. Mr. Suresnder Singh, R/O C1-151 F. Holi Chowk, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110092 (Contact No. 9873597638) has agreed to purchase the property bearing No. C-52, measuring 100 Sq.yds., out of Khata No. 1525, situated at Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110062. The said property is currently owned and absolutely possessed by Mr. Suresh Kumar Prachha, S/o Manohar Lal, R/O C-152, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-62, who has represented himself as the sole and lawful owner and has expressed his willingness to sell the same to my client. My client (The Buyer) has already executed an Agreement to Sell (Bayana) and paid earnest money in respect of the said property. If any person, bank, financial institution, or authority has any right, title, interest, lien, mortgage, charge, dispute, or objection in the said property, they are hereby required to intimate the same in writing along with relevant documentary proof within 07 (Seven) days from the date of publication of this notice. If no objection is received within the stipulated period of 07 days, RAMESH KUMAR (Adv.) GF-12, Meghstod Building, Nehru Place, N.Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE General Public is hereby informed that my client Amita Arora W/o Sh. Ashok Kumar R/O WZ-767, Plot No-16, Vishnu Garden, New Delhi-110018. My client has disowned and debarred his son Amit Arora from his movable and immovable properties as they are out of control of my client. In future any body deals with them shall do so at their own risk and responsibility. My client shall not be responsible for their any acts and deed dealing done by them. Sd/- B.C.N.M.D.E. Advocate S.R.Ind.B. Campus, Janki Pur, ND-58

PUBLIC NOTICE Notice is hereby given in public at large that I, BHAWANA MALHOTRA, W/O. KULDEB MOHAN R/O H.NO.13, PCKET-21, SECTOR-24, ROHINI, DELHI, have severd all relations, separated and debarred, disowned my brother NISHAL MOHAN & his wife NEHA MOHAN alongwith their childrens out of my free will, to maintain distance from them socially and emotionally due to personal disputes, differences in relationship, I have decided to sever all social, personal, and financial relations with them. That any transaction, commitment, assurance, representation, or dealing made by them in my name shall not be binding upon me, and I shall not be responsible for any such transaction whatsoever. Further from the date of this Public Notice, I hereby disassociate my brother NISHAL MOHAN & his wife NEHA MOHAN alongwith their childrens from all my belongings and they shall have no concern whatsoever with my family during my lifetime.

Sd/- DINESH KUMAR Advocate Enr. No. D/5996/2017

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, formerly known as **Raj Kumar**, resident of Plot No. 6, Near Malik Hospital Mohna Road, Prem Nagar Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana 121004 hereby inform the general public that I have changed my name to **Raaj Kumar Sohnanpal Rawat** with effect from 02-11-2023. Henceforth, I shall be known as **Raaj Kumar Sohnanpal Rawat** for all purposes.

Raaj Kumar Sohnanpal Rawat Date: 07-04-2026 Place: Faridabad

PUBLIC NOTICE My clients Heera Lal S/o Late Har Dwarai Lal and Smt. Sushila W/o Sh. Heera Lal both R/o House No.330, Gali No.2, Chandan Colony, Saidulajab, South Delhi, New Delhi-110030, Presently at Flat No.6, Property No.21, Transfer Wali Gali, Village Neb Sarai, New Delhi-110088, have severed their all relation and disown/debarred their younger son Sonu from their all moveable-immovable properties and assets. My clients shall not be responsible for any acts and deeds done by him.

Ayub Ahmad (Advocate) Ch. No. 457, Saket Court New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE Public at large is hereby informed that our client Mr. RRAJ KUMAR NANGIA S/o Late GOBIND LAL NANGIA and Mrs. VEENA NAGIA W/o RRAJ KUMAR NANGIA both are residents of 40-A Hans Vihar Society Sector-13 Rohini New Delhi-110085 have disowned/ debarred their son namely Mr. AMEET KUMAR NANGIA & Daughter-in-law Mrs. ANKITA MALIK from all their moveable & immoveable properties/ assets/ business (including the above said property) and severed all relations with AMEET KUMAR NANGIA & ANKITA MALIK due to their misbehavior/ misconduct towards my clients RRAJ KUMAR NANGIA and Mrs. VEENA NANGIA. He and his wife are not in control of my client, if anybody deals with AMEET KUMAR NANGIA & ANKITA MALIK in any manner whatsoever, will do so at his/ her/their own risk and responsibility, my clients shall not be responsible for the same.

RAJNEET KUMAR (Advocate) Office: No.9 Basement Pocket F-3 Sector-11 Rohini Delhi-110085

COURT NOTICE

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI (Ordinary Original Civil Jurisdiction) Execution Petition No. 106/2019. SMT. SHAKUNTALA DEVI & ANR. ...DECREE HOLDER VS. SH. PRADEEP PALNIAL ...JUDGMENT DEBTOR To, JUDGMENT DEBTOR Pradeep Palnial S/o Sh. Ramesh Chand Palnial, R/o M-34 Ground Floor, Main Sharda, Near Muskan Chowk, Delhi. Whereas the decree-holders have made a petition to this Court for execution of the Decree dated 26.04.2019 passed in CS (Comm.) No. 1090/2018. And WHEREAS it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way, therefore, this notice is given by publication directed to you to make appearance before the Joint Registrar (Judicial) of this Court on 08.07.2026 at 11:00 AM. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the petition/ application will be heard and determined in your absence. Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, in terms of orders dated 18.05.2026. Assistant Registrar (Original) for REGISTRAR GENERAL

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI (ORDINARY ORIGINAL CIVIL JURISDICTION) CS (OS) No.508/2024 ARUN KUMAR RATHI Plaintiff VS. GURPREET SINGH & ORS. Defendants To, DEFENDANT NO.1 SH. ANKIT JAIN, S.O. AK. JAIN R/O H-22017, OLD MAHAVIR NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110018 MOB. 9820109109 Whereas the plaintiff above mentioned has instituted a SUIT FOR SPECIFIC PERFORMANCE OF THE AGREEMENT TO SELL AND PURCHASE DATED 14/08/2022 BETWEEN PLAINTIFF AND DEFENDANT NO.1 SH. GURPREET SINGH & ORS. IN COMPLIANCE WITH THE AGREEMENT TO SELL DATED 14/08/2022 BETWEEN PLAINTIFF AND DEFENDANTS NO.2 AND 3, NARAYAN SH. SANDHEEP MOB. 9820109109 against you, the above named defendant no. 6 and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of this Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way, therefore, this notice is given by publication directing you, the above named defendant no. 6 to make appearance before the Joint Registrar (Judicial) of this Court on 08.07.2026 at 11:00 AM. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the suit shall be heard and determined in your absence. Given under my hand and the seal of this court, in terms of orders dated 07/01/2026 & 08/05/2026.

Sd/- Assistant Registrar (Original) for REGISTRAR GENERAL

PUBLIC NOTICE BE IT KNOWN TO THE GENERAL PUBLIC THAT MY CLIENTS MOHD. SULEMAN KHAN S/O LATE MOHD. MOIN KHAN AND NASIMA KHAN W/O MOHD. SULEMAN KHAN, BOTH R/O KOC, LIG, DDA, FLATS, PCKET-12, JASOLA VIHAR, NEW DELHI 110025 HAVE DISOWNED THEIR SON IMRAN KHAN, DOB: (11.04.1979) AND HE SHALL HAVE NO RIGHT, TITLE OR INTEREST IN THEIR PROPERTIES AND MY CLIENTS SHALL NOT BE RESPONSIBLE FOR ANY OF HIS ACTS/ OMISSIONS AND CONDUCTS. ANY ONE DEALING WITH HIM SHALL DO SO AT HIS/HER OWN RISK. Sd/- Nand Kishor Paswan (Advocate) Enorll No. D/316/2012 Ch. No. 518, Patiala House Courts New Delhi

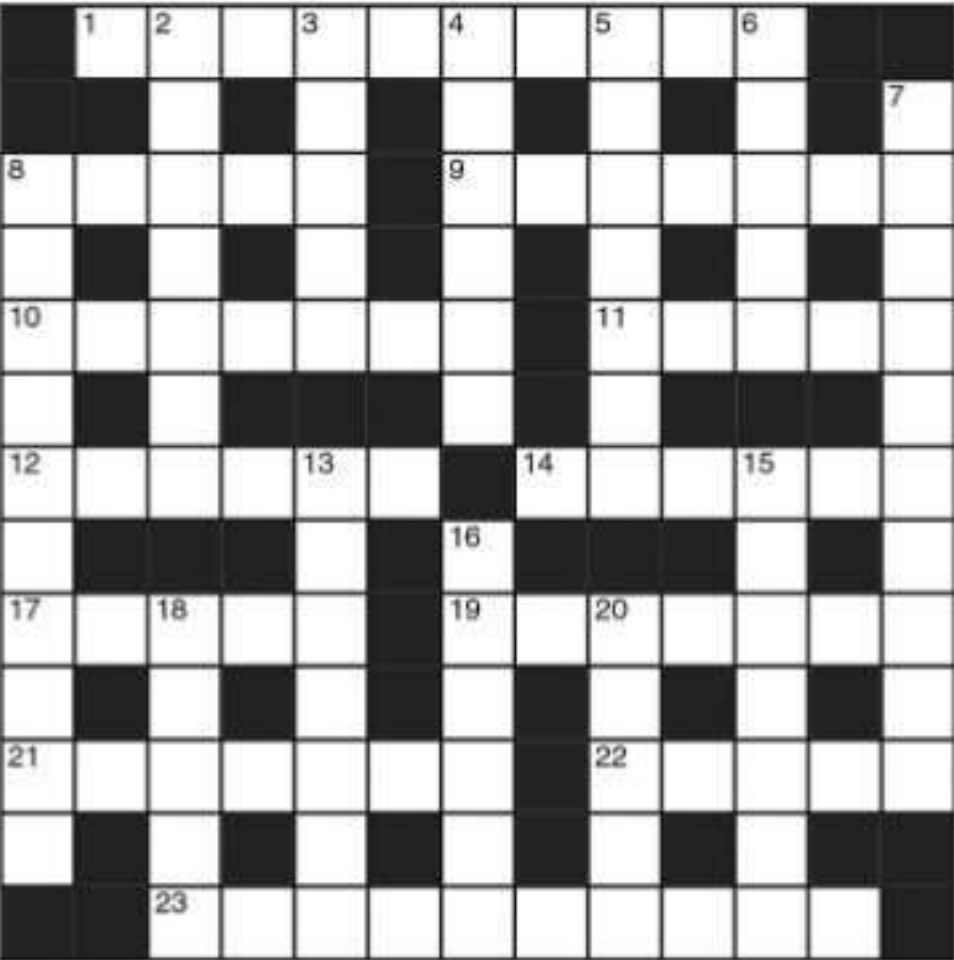
SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE FOR OVERHAULING (POH) WORK Sr. no. (1) Tender No.: SECR-TM-POH-128-2026-04. Date: 01.06.2026. Name of Work: Periodic cum major overhauling (POH) of T-28 portals (01 & 02) and (09 & 10) in Sector. Tender Value: ₹ 79,29,694.40/- Tender closing date & time: 15.00 Hours of 22.06.2026. Sr. No. (2) Tender No.: SECRHQ ENGGTM-TU-262702 Name of Work: Overhauling of tamping units of CSM/DOU, UNI-45, UNI-35, 09-3X/HOT-3X and MPT track machines. Tender Value: ₹ 12,52,73,238.89/- Tender closing date & time: 15.00 Hours of 29.06.2026. For full details of tender notice and tender documents, tenderer may login to the website: www.irops.gov.in. No manual tenders will be entertained against E-Tender. Executive Engineer/T.M./H.Q. CPR/10/163 S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur. South East Central Railway %@secrrail

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

NOTICE OF INVITING E-TENDER E-Tender Notice No. Carriage-19-2026 Dt. 01.06.2026 Dy. CME /Carriage Workshop, Ajmer North Western Railway acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites open E-Tender no. Carriage-19-2026 Date 01.06.2026 Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Details are as under -1. Name of work with its location : "Supply and Installation Work of Safety latches on Lifting Hooks of Electric Cables & Electric Hoists (As per scope of work)" 2. Approx. cost of the work : Rs. 306000.00/- 3. Tender

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Be successful and economical in use (2,14,3)
- 8 Badly cared for tree (5)
- 9 Possibly recalls stocks of wine (7)
- 10 Girls and men said to be different (7)
- 11 One who admits he doesn't have to pay the rent? (5)
- 12 Its beaches and scenery make it a hit (6)
- 14 Refined engine driver (6)
- 17 Growth of production (5)
- 19 Regains proper form using a rubber (7)
- 21 Leaps out of bed perhaps (7)
- 22 1 rose prepared to shoot (5)
- 23 Nonstop flights (10)
- DOWN
- 2 Unusual angle for a crank (3,4)
- 3 Not insignificant regal order (5)
- 4 Most delightful form of insect (6)
- 5 Pleasing reception (7)
- 6 Log time before the end of autumn (5)
- 7 Roger's a lot different now he watches the stars (10)
- 8 Happen to reach a gap in the hills (4,2,4)
- 13 Change it I can't — it's so big (7)
- 15 US volcano produces wetter weather (7)
- 16 Craft in which wives seldom excel (6)
- 18 Admit it's about being in time (5)
- 20 Choose to make a fuss over physical exercise (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6005 ACROSS: 1 Osprey, 4 Massif, 9 Funfair, 10 Baton, 11 Upset, 12 Elegant, 13 Coach driver, 18 Way over, 20 Rages, 22 Expel, 23 Ocarina, 24 Sister, 25 Ascend DOWN: 1 Offcut, 2 Pines, 3 Elastic, 5 Ambie, 6 Situate, 7 Finite, 8 Friend or foe, 14 Olympus, 15 Inroads, 16 Tweeds, 17 Island, 19 Valse, 21 Guise

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

It is our duty as men and women to proceed as though the limits of our abilities exist. Pierre Teilhard de Chardin (2,3,5)

NZEOO

AEILNT

TINGS

EJUNDX

our abilities do not exist. Pierre Teilhard de Chardin

SOLUTIONS: NZEOO = Ocean, AEILNT = Entail, TINGS = String, EJUNDX = Limited

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



SUDOKU 6339

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6338

	8		7	3		5		6
9								2
			1			4		
3	1		7	9				
7		3	4				1	
		2	1		8		3	
	4			3				
2								9
5	9		2	1		6		

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

BY BILL WATTERSON

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You have strong feelings about something (which you will no doubt share with a friend or a group) — that might relate to doing something spontaneously to express your desire for freedom. Tonight: Be friendly.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): A surprise interaction with anyone in authority might catch you off guard today. Tread carefully because feelings are strong today and some people will be adamant about what they want. Tonight: You're admired.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Steer clear of controversial subjects today as people are obsessed with their opinions. You might get caught up in a power struggle with someone. Yikes! Run away! Tonight: Learn and explore!

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Double-check banking details. Something unexpected could impact your wealth or something to do with shared property. You will be upset if something goes wrong. Tonight: Check your finances.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today you might attract someone to you who has strong opinions. This person could be a character or someone you suddenly just met. Don't let anyone bulldoze you with their ideas. Tonight: Be reasonable and cooperative.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Be careful you don't come on too strong with work colleagues today in your enthusiasm to make improvements. Your impulse to clean things might be misunderstood. People can feel threatened by change. Tonight: Work to get better organised.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): A romantic interest might suddenly develop today. It's passionate and irresistible. Others might have a similar surprise related to sports or something to do with your kids or the arts. Get grounded. Do you need some perspective? Tonight: Socialise.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Family discussions are intense today. It could relate to a sudden decision about inheritances, shared property, taxes or debt. Whatever the issue, there are strong feelings around it. Wait until things settle down before committing. Tonight: Rest at home.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You might get on your high horse today as you are convinced about something and you have very strong feelings about it. Don't overreact. Work hard today to get your balance. Tonight: Discussions.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Something might come up related to your job or something else that is unexpected, which causes you to have strong opinions about financial matters today. It could be anything. Let things settle down before you act. Tonight: Check your money.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You have strong feelings today about something that is related to a social outing. You might feel blindsided by something. Someone wants to do something and you don't agree. See how things look after the dust settles. Tonight: You win.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Something going on behind the scenes, possibly related to home and family, might catch off guard today. You have wonderful opportunities to socialise. Lighten up. Go with what works. Tonight: Privacy.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

87-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27

Electrical work in connection with, (i) Provision of Interlocking of 18 Nos. of LC gates having TVU > 20000 over Delhi Division. (ii) Provision of 13 L-xing gates having TVU more than 20000 and less than 50000 in Delhi Division.

Name of Work and its location

Address of the office

Earnest Money

Last Date & Time of Submission of Tender

Opening of Tender

Website & Notice Board

Rs. 1,21,64,561.37

Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi - 110055

Rs. 2,43,300.00

25.06.2026, 16:00 Hrs.

25.06.2026, 16:00 Hrs.

www.reps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.

1880/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Md. Irshad Khan, S/o Md. Sabir Khan R/o H.No.B-66, J.J. Colony Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.376/2019 Dated 07.07.2019 u/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Md. Irshad Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Md. Irshad Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Md. Irshad Khan** of **FIR No.376/2019 Dated 07.07.2019 u/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North Room No.06, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7239/ON/2026

JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand.
Ph No.: +91-651-2225878,
CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752, e-mail jd-juidcolimited@gmail.com

National Competitive Bidding Tender Notice
NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/RFP/UCIS/2026- 708 Date: 03.06.2026

1.	Name of the work.	Request for Proposal for Selection of Consultancy Firm for Identification, Feasibility Assessment, and Prioritization of Urban Corridors in Major Urban Local Bodies of Jharkhand.
2.	Tender Fee & EMD Amount (In INR) (to be submitted online only)	Cost of Tender Document: 25,000/- (Rupees Twenty-Five Thousand Only); EMD Amount: 2,00,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Only)
3.	Mode of Bid Submission	Online e-tendering (jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
4.	Date of starting of sale of online Tender	03.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
5.	Date of start of submission of online bids	03.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
6.	Date & time of Pre-Bid meeting	11.06.2026 at 15:00 Hrs
7.	Last Date/Time for submission of bids	24.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
8.	Date of online Bid Opening	25.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
9.	Tender fee submission address	Jharkhand Urban Infrastructure Development Company Limited, JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Chowk, Ranchi - 834001
10.	Helpline No. of e-Procurement Cell	0651 - 2225878

Further details are available on Jharkhand Government e-Procurement website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> Sd/-
PR 381403 (Urban Development) 26-27 (D) Project Director (Technical) JUIDCO Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vimal Gupta, S/o Ram Prakash Gupta R/o X-47B, Gali No.14, Bharampuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.1047/2014 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vimal Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vimal Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vimal Gupta** of **FIR No.1047/2014 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.07.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01, Room No.73, 5th Floor
DP/7319/NE/2026 North-East District, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Haider, S/o Rahisuddin, R/o H.No. 23, Gali No. 4, B-Block, Gamri Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 349/2024, U/s 25 A Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Haider** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Haider** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Haider** accused of **FIR No. 349/2024, U/s 25 A Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.07.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
North-East District, Room No. 73, 2nd Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/7322/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Chhitij Kumar S/o Manay Singh R/o D-31, Chhatarpur EXT, New Delhi**. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 171/15 U/S 279/338/465 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Chhitij Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Chhitij Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Chhitij Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 171/15 U/S 279/338/465 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ashish Kumar Meena
JMFC-01, Room No. 214
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi
DP/7298/SD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Badal, S/o: Vinod Kumar, R/o: Village-Janoli, Distt., Palwal, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 364/2022, Dated: 16.04.2022, U/s: 392/394/34 IPC, P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Badal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Badal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Badal** of **P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Priya Mahendra
Ld. ASJ-09, West Distt., Room No. 307,
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi
DP/7209/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajesh S/o Chhote Lal R/o H. No. 823, Gali No. 08, L-1st, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1472/2015 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Neb Sarai, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rajesh** of case **FIR No. 1472/2015 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Neb Sarai, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Nidhi Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
South District, Room No. 212
Saket Courts, Delhi
DP/7221/SD/2026 (Court Matter)

BHAKRA BEAS MANAGEMENT BOARD
PUBLIC NOTICE

Name of Line	Routed Via
220 KV Panipat-Narela - Delhi Double circuit line	Nangal Kheri, Dewana, Khalila, Manana, Samalakra, Kwana, Chulkana, Chhadia, Bhawara Rasulpur, Daparpur, Ahir Majara, Gumnad, Gannaur, Laiheri, Ladsoli, Rajpur, Bhigaan, Kuraad, Murthal, Rewali, Shahpur, Rajpur, Birla Industrial area, Jaat Joshi, Rai, Jathari, Pithopura, Nathapura, Saboli, Kundali, Narela (Delhi) Budhpur, Holambi Kalan, Ali Pur, Siras Pur, Rohini, Pitampura, Shakur pur J.J Colony, Lawrance Road, Shakur Basti 2
220 KV Panipat-Narela Single circuit line	Sewah, Pasinaa Khurd, Pasina Kalan, Jhatti Pur, Machhroli, Karhans, Garhi Chhaju, Juraashi khaas, Ponti, Patti Kalayanaa, Haldana, Bhakarpur, Chirashmi, Shahpur taga, Baddi, Pipil khera, Dhaturi, Hasanpur, Murthal, Kumash Pur, Dipaal Pur, Joshi Chauhan, Khewada, Asaw Pur, Badh khalasa, Nangal kalan, Bajid Pur saboli, Kundali, Narela

It is prohibited / Offence to construct the house, Building, Plantation of tree, Soil Excavation or any kind of activities under & adjacent the above said line i.e 5.5 meter (approximate 18 feet) left/right, up/down away from the line as per Indian Electricity Act -1910 (Rule No. -18, Su Rule No. -3) Read with Rule No. 80, sub-rule (1b, 2c) and 82 A of Indian Electricity act-1956 & Indian Electricity Act 2003 section (68) sub section (5). If anyone violate above said rule then legal action will be taken against him as per Indian Electricity act and he will be fully responsible for any kind of loss / damage to BBMB or any Third party. S.D.O., Transmission Line Sub-Division, BBMB, Delhi-110035

S.D.O. Transmission Line Sub-Division, BBMB, Delhi-110035
269-PR Board Sect-4 FOR YOUR BETTER TOMORROW SAVE ENERGY TODAY

KERALA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION
Transport Bhavan , Fort P.O, Thiruvananthapuram-695023
E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of Item	Last Date of Bid submission
Bus Mounted Vehicle Location Tracking Device (VLTD) for KSRTC Bus	18.06.2026, 06.00 PM
Daily Vehicle Log Sheet	15.06.2026, 06.00 PM

For the detailed tender document visit: www.etenders.kerala.gov.in Sd/-
Chairman & Managing Director
www.keralartc.com/tenders/purchase, e-mail: sr@kerala.gov.in
03.06.2026

JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand.
Ph No.: +91-651-2225878,
CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752, e-mail jd-juidcolimited@gmail.com

Corrigendum - 3

Name of Work: Construction of Giridih Bus Stand at Giridih Nagar Nigam, Jharkhand
NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/BS/GIRIDIHBUSSTAND/700
Tender ID: 2026_UDD_113298_1
Ref PR No.: 378169

Sl. No.	Particulars	As per Corrigendum - 2	As per Corrigendum - 3
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	01.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs	09.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
8	Date/Time of Opening of Bid	02.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs	10.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Further details available on: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

PR 381404 Urban Development(26-27).D Sd/-
Project Director (Technical) JUIDCO Ltd., Ranchi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No:-DRM/C/AGRA/PAY & USE/POLICY/2018 Dated:-03.06.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category:	Normal Pay & Use	Auction Catalogue No. :	PNU-2026-06
Asset Details			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at Achhnera Jn. (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at Rubbas RBS (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at GVH (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis JAB (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at DEEG (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at GDO (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at FTS (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at KLB (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at BBNR (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet and IRFC on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at IDH Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at RAH (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at VRBD (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at RKM (IRFC) Railway Station.			
Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at CHJ (IRFC) Railway Station.			

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:-19.06.2026 Time:-12:30

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:-19.06.2026 Time:-15:10

Note:-Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1257/26(DG)

@ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi